

The Book of Common Prayer

1559

The Church of England

The Elizabethan book, the Prayer Book of Hooker's church. From the Society of Archbishop Justus transcription; its Collects, Epistles, and Gospels section is not carried in that transcription.

Contents

The Preface, and Of Ceremonies	1
The Order for Morning Prayer	9
The Order for Evening Prayer	15
The Litany	18
The Order of the Administration of the Lord's Supper, or Holy Communion	24
The Ministration of Baptism	35
Confirmation, with the Catechism	41
The Form of Solemnization of Matrimony	46
The Order for the Visitation of the Sick	51
The Order for the Burial of the Dead	56
The Thanksgiving of Women after Child-birth	58
A Commination against Sinners	63
Certain Godly Prayers	67

The Preface, and Of Ceremonies

The Book of Common Prayer - 1559

¶ AN ACTE FOR THE UNIFORMITIE OF COMMON
PRAIER, AND SERVICE IN THE CHURCH, AND THE ADMINIS-
TRACION OF THE SACRAMENTES.

WHERE at the death of oure late Soueraigne lord King Edward the sixt, there remained one uniforme order of common service and prayer, and of the administracion of Sacramentes, Rites, and Ceremonies, in the churche of Englande, whiche was set furth in one booke entituled: The booke of common prayer, and administracion of Sacramentes, and other Rites and ceremonies in the churche of Englande, aucthorised by Act of Parliament, holden in the fift [fifth] and sixt yeres of our saied late Soueraigne lorde kyng Edward the sixte, intituled An acte for the uniformitie of Common prayer, and administracion of the Sacramentes, the which was repealed and taken away by acte of parliament, in the first yere of the raygne of our late Soueraigne Ladye Quene Marye, to the great decaye of the due honour of God, and discomfort to the professours of the trueth of Christes religion :

Be it therefore enacted, by the auctoritie of this present parliament, that the sayde statute of repeale, and every thing therein contened, onely concerning the sayde booke, and the Service, administracion of Sacramentes, Rites, and Ceremonies, contened or appoynted, in, or by the saide booke shalbe voyde and of none effecte, from, and after the feaste of the Nativitie of S. John Baptist,

next commyng. And that the sayde booke, with the ordre of service, and of the administracion of Sacramentes, Rites and Ceremonies, with the alteracion, and addicions, therein added and appoynted by this estatute [statute], shall stande, and be from and after the sayde feaste of the Nativitie of Saint John Baptist, in full force and effect, according to the tenour and effect of this estatute, any thing in the aforesayde statute of repeale to the contrary notwithstanding.

And further be it enacted by the quenes highnes, with the assent of the lordes and commons, in thys present Parliament assembled, and by auctoritie of the same, that all and synguler ministers, in any cathedrall, or paryshe church, or other place within thys realme of Englande, Wales, and the marches of the same, or other the quenes dominions : shall from, and after the feaste of the Nativitie of Saynct John Baptist next comming, be bounden to saye and use the Matins, Evensong, celebracion of the Lordes supper, and administracion of eche of the Sacramentes, and all their Common and open prayer, in suche ordre and fourme, as is mencioned in the sayde booke, so authorised by Parliament in the sayde .v. and sixte yere of the raygne of king Edward the Sixt, with one alteracion or addition of certayn Lessons to be used on every Sondag in the yere, and the fourme of the Letanie altered and corrected, and two Sentences onely added in the delivery of the Sacrament to the communicantes, and none other, or other wyse. And that if anye maner of persone [parson], Vicare, or other, whatsoever minister that ought or shoulde syng or saye common prayer mencioned in the sayde booke, or minister the Sacramentes, from and after the feaste of the Nativitie of Saint John Baptiste nexte commyng, refuse to use the sayde common prayers, or to minyster the Sacramentes in suche Cathedrall or paryshe Church, or other places, as he shoulde use to minister the same, in such ordre and fourme, as they be mencioned and set forth in the sayde booke or shall wilfully or obstinately standynge in the same, use anye other Ryte, ceremonye, ordre, fourme, or maner of celebrating of the Lords supper openly or prively, or Mattins, Evensong, administracion of the Sacramentes, or other open prayers, then is mencioned and set forth in the sayd booke : or shall wilfully or obstinately standynge in the same, use anye other Ryte, ceremonye, ordre, fourme, or maner of celebrating of the. Lords supper openly or prively, or Mattins, Evensong, administracion of the Sacramentes, or other open prayers, then [than] is mencioned and set forth in the sayd booke [*Open prayer in and throughout this Acte, is mente that prayer whiche is for other[others]to come unto, or heare, eyther in Common Churches, or privie Chappelles, or Oratories, commonlye called the Service of the Church*], or shall preach, declare, or speake any thyng in the derogacion or depraving of the sayd booke, or any thyng therein conteyned, or of any part thereof, and shalbe thereof lawfullye convicted, according to the lawes of this realme, by verdict of .xii. men, or by hys owne confession, or by the notorious evidence of the facte, shall lose and forfeyte to the Queenes hyghnesse, her heyres and successours, for hys fyrst offence, the profite of all his spiritual benefices or promotions, comming or arysyng in one whole yere next after this conviction. And also that the persone so convicted, shall for the same offence suffer imprisonment by the space of .vi. monethes [months], without baile or mainpryse. And if any suche persone, once convicte [convicted] of anye offence, concernyng the premysses, shall after hys fyrst conviction eftsones [=again] offende, and be thereof in fourme aforesayd lawfully convict [convicted]: that then the same person shall for his second offence suffer imprisonment by the space of one hole yere, and also shall therefore be deprived, *ipso facto*, of all his spiritual promotions. And that it shalbe lawfull to all patrons or donors of all and singuler the same spirituall promotions, or of any of them, to present or collate to the same, as though the person and persons so offending wer dead; and that if any such person or persons, after he shalbe twice convicted in fourme aforesayd, shal offend agaynst any of the premysses the thyrde time, and shalbe thereof in fourme aforesayd lawfully

convicted: That then the person so offending, and convycted the thyrd tyme, shalbe deprived, *ipso facto*, of all his spirituall promocions, and also shall suffer imprisonment during hys lyfe.

AND if the person that shall offend, and be convicte in fourme aforesayde, concernyng any of the premisses, shall not be beneficed, nor have anye spirituall promotion: That then the same person so offending and convict [convicted], shall for the fyrst offence suffer imprisonment during one hole yere next after his sayde conviction, without bayle or maynepryse. And yf anye suche person, not havynge anye spirituall promotion, after his firste conviction, shall eftsones [=again] offende in anye thyng concernynge the premysses, and shal in fourme aforesayd be therof lawfully convicted: That then the same person shall for his seconde offence, suffer imprysonment duryng hys lyfe.

And it is ordeyned and enacted by the auctoritie abovesayde, that yf any person or personnes whatsoever, after the sayde feaste of the Nativitie of Saincte John Baptyste nexte commynge, shall in any Enterludes, Playes, Songes, Rymes, or by other open wordes, declare or speake anye thinge in the derogation, depravyng or despysynge of the same booke, or of anye thyng therein conteyned, or anye parte thereof, or shall by open facte, deede, or by open threatnynges compell or cause, or otherwyse procure or mayntayne anye Pars [parson], Vonycar [Vicar], or other Mynister, in anye Cathedrall or paryshe Church, or in Chappell, or in anye other place to synge or saye anye comen [common] and open prayer, or to minister anye Sacramente otherwyse, or in anye other maner and forme then is mencioned in the sayde booke, or that by anye of the sayde meanes shall unlawfully interrupt or let [=prevent] any parson, vycar, or other minister, in anye Cathedrall, or paryshe Church, Chappel, or anye other place to synge or saye common and open praier, or to minister the Sacramentes or anye of them, in suche maner and fourme, as is mencioned in the sayde booke: That then everye suche parson [person] beyng thereof lawefully convicted in fourme above sayde, shall forfeyte to the Quene oure Soveraygne Ladye, her heires and successours, for the fyrste offence a hundredth markes. And yf any parson or parsons [person or persons], beyng once convicte [convicted] of anye suche offence eftsons [=again] offende againste anye of the laste recyted offences, and shal in fourme aforesayde be thereof lawfully convicted. That then the same parson [person] so offending and convicte, shall for the seconde offence forfeyte to the Quene oure Soveraigne Ladye, her heyres and successours, foure hundredth markes. And yf anye parson [person] after he, in forme aforesayde, shall have bene twyce convicte of anye offence, concernynge anye of the laste recyted offences, shall offende the thyrd tyne, and be thereof in forme abovesayde lawefully convicted: That then every parson [person] so offendynge and convicte, shall for his thyrd offence, forfeyte to oure Soveraygne Lady the Quene, all his goodes and catelles [chattels, =property], and shall suffer imprysonment duryng his lyfe. And yf anye person or persons that for his fyrste offence, concernynge the premysses, shall be convicte in forme aforesayde, do not paye the somme to be payde by vertue of hys conviction, in such maner and forme as the same oughte to be payde, within syxe wekes nexte after hys conviction, that then every person so convicte, and so not payinge the same, shall for the same first offence, instede of the sayde somme, suffer imprisonment by the space of syxe monethes, without bayl or maynepryse. And yf anye person or persons, that for his seconde offence concerning the premisses, shalbe convict in forme aforesayde, do not pay the sayed somme to be payed by vertue of his conviction, and this estatute, in suche maner and forme as the same oughte to be payde, within .vi. wekes nexte after hys said seconde conviction: that then every person so convicted and not so payng the same, shall for the same seconde offence, in the stede of the sayde somme, suffer imprisonment during .xii. monethes, without bayle or maynepryse. And that from and after the

sayde feaste of the Nativitie of S. John Baptyst next commynge, all and every person and personnes, inhabiting within this Realme or anye other the Quenes Majesties dominions, shall diligently and faythfully, havynge no lawefull or reasonable excuse to be absente, endevoure [exert] themselves to resorte to their paryshe Church or Chappel accustomed, or upon reasonable let thereof, to some usual place where common Prayer, and suche Service of GOD shalbe used in suche tyme of let upon everye Sondaye, and other dayes ordayned and used to be kepte as holye dayes. And then and there to abyde orderly, and soberly duryng the tyme of the common prayer, prechinges, or other service of GOD, there to be used and ministred, upon payne of punyshmet by the censures of the church. And also upon payne that everye persone so offendynge shall forfeite for every suche offence .xii. *d.* [twelve pence] to be levied by the Churchwardens of the paryshe, where suche offence shalbe done, to thuse of the poore of the same paryshe, of the goodes, landes, and tenementes of suche offendour, by waye of distresse. And for due execution hereof the Quenes moste excellent Majesty, the lordes Temporall, and all the commons in this present Parlyament assembled, dothe in Goddes name earnestly requyre and charge all the Archebyschoppes, Bishopes, and other ordinaries, that they shal endeavour themselves to the uttermost of their knowledges, that the due and true execution hereof may be had throughe houte their diocesse, and charges, as they wyll answer before God, for suche evylles and plagues, wherewith almyghty God maye justlye punyshe his people for neglecting this good and holsome lawe. And for theyr auctoritie in this behalfe, be it, further enacted by thauctoritie aforesayde, that all and singular the same Archebyschoppes, byschoppes, and all other their officers, exercising ecclesiasticall jurisdiction as wel in place exempt as not exempt, within their diocesse, shall have full power and auctoritie by this acte, to reforme, correcte, and pounyshe by censures of the church, all and singuler persons, which shall offende wythin any theyr jurisdictions or diocesse, after the sayde feaste of the Nativitie of Saint John Baptyst nexte commynge, againste this acte and statute. Any other lawe, statute, priviledge, lybertie, or provision heretofore made, had, or suifred to the contrary notwithstandinge.

AND it is ordeyned and enacted by the auctoritie aforesayde, that all and everye justices of Oyer and determiner, or Justices of Assyse [Assize], shall have ful power and auctoritey in every of their open and general Sessions, to enquire here and determine al, and all maner of offences that shalbe committed or done contrary to any article conteyned in this present act, within the lymites of the Commission to them dyrected, and to make processe for the execution of the same, as they may do againste any personne beinge indited before them of trespasse, or lawfully convicted thereof.

PROVIDED alwayes and be it enacted by thauctoritey aforesayd, that all and every Arch-bishoppe and Bishoppe, shall or may at al time and times at his libertie and pleasure, joyne and associate himselfe, by vertue of this acte, to the said justices of Oyer and determiner, or to the said justices of assise, at every of the sayd open and general Sessions, to be holden in any place within his diocesse, for and to the enquiry, hearing and determining of the offences aforesayde.

PROVIDED also and be it enacted by thauctority aforesaid, that the bokes concernyng the sayd Services, shall at the costes and charges of the paryshioners of everye paryshe, and Cathedrall Church, be attained and gotten before the sayd feast of the Nativitie of Saint Jhon Baptist next folowing, and that all suche paryshes and Cathedral Churches or other places, wher the said bokes shalbe attained and gotten before the said feaste of the Nativitie of Saint Jhon Baptist, shal within three wekes next after the said bokes so attained and gotten, use the said service and put the same in ure [=use] accordyng to this acte.

AND be it further enacted by thauctoritie aforesaid, that no parson or parsons [person or persons] shalbe at any time hereafter empeched or otherwyse molested of or for any of the offences

above mencioned, hereafter to be committed or done contrary to this act, onles he or they so offendynge, be therof indited at the next generall Sessions, to be holden before any such Justices of Oyer and determiner, or Justices of assise, next after any offence committed or done contrarye to the tenor of this act.

PROVIDED alwayes, and be it ordeined, and enacted by the auctoritie aforesaid, that al and singuler Lordes of the Parliament for the third offence above mencioned, shall be tried by their peres.

PROVIDED also, and be it ordeined, and enacted by thauctoritie aforesaid, that the Maior of London, and all other Maiors, Bayliffes, and other head officers of al, and singular Cities, Boroughes, and Townes Corporate within this Realme, Wales and the marches of the same, to the which Justices of Assise do not commonly repayre, shall have ful power and authority by vertue of this acte, to enquire, here, and determine the offences abovesaid, and every of them yerely, within .xv. daies after the feast of Easter, and S. Mighel [Michael] tharchaungell, in like maner and fourme as Justices of Assise and Oyer and determiner may doo.

PROVIDED alwayes and be it ordeined and enacted bythauctoritie aforesayd, that al and singuler Archbishops and Byshops, and every of their Chauncellours, Commissaries, Archdeacons, and other ordinaries, havynge any peculier ecclesiasticall jurisdiction, shal have ful power and authority by vertue of this act, as wel to enquire in their visitation, Synodes, and elsewhere within their jurisdiction at any other time and place, to take occasions and informations of al and every the thinges above mencioned, done, committed, or perpetrated within the limits of their jurisdictions and auctoritie, and to punish the same by admonicion, excommunication, sequestration, or deprivation and other censures and processe in like fourme as heretofore hath ben used in like cases by ye Queenes ecclesiastical lawes.

PROVIDED alwayes and be it enacted, that whatsoever person offending in the premisses, shall for the offence firste receyve ponishment of the ordinary, having a testimonial therof under the said ordinaries scale, shal not for the same offence eftsones [=again] be convicted before the Justices. And lykewise receivynge for the sayd fyrst offence ponishment by the Justices, he shal not for the same offence eftsoones receyve ponishment of the ordinary. Any thinge conteyned in this act to the contrary notwithstanding.

PROVIDED alwayes and be it enacted, that suche ornaments of the Churche, and of the ministers therof, shalbe reteined and be in use as was in this Churche of England, by authority of Parliament, in the second yere of the raygne of Kyng Edward the vi. until other order shalbe therin taken by thauthority of the Quenes Majestie, with the advise of her Commissioners appointed and auctorized under the great Seale of England, for causes ecclesiastical, or of the Metropolitan of this Realme. And also that if there shal happen any contempte or irreverence to be used in the ceremonies or rites of the Church, by the misusinge of the orders appointed in this boke: The Quenes Majestie may by the like advise of the sayd commissioners, or Metropolytan, ordeine and publish such further ceremonies or rites as may be most for the advauncement of Gods glory, the edifyng of his Church, and the due reverence of Christes holy mysteries and Sacramentes.

AND be it further enacted by the auctoritie aforesaid, that al lawes, statutes and ordinaunces, wherin or whereby any other Service administration or Sacramentes or Common prayer, is limited, established, or set forth to be used within this Realme, or any other the Quenes dominions or Countryes, shall from hensforth be utterly voyde and of none effect.

THE PREFACE.

THERE was never anye thyng by the witte of man so well devised, or so sure established,

whiche (in continuaunce of tyme) hath not been corrupted: as (among other thynges) it may plainly appeare by the Common prayers in the church, commonly called divine service: the firste originall and ground wherof, if a man woulde serche out by auncient fathers, he shall fynde that the same was not ordeyned but of a good purpose, and for a greate advauncement of godlines. For they so ordred the matter, that all the whole Byble (or the gretest part therof) should be red over ones [once] in the yere entending therby, that the clergie and specially suche as wer Ministers of the congregacion, should (by often reading and meditacion of Gods word), be styrred up to godlines themselves, and be more able also to exhorte other [others] by holesome doctrine, and to confute them that wer adversaries to the truth. And further that the people (by daily hearynge of holy scripture read in the Church) should continually profite more and more in the knowlege of God, and be the more enflamed with the love of his true religion. But these many yeres passed, thys godly and decent ordre of the auncient fathers, hath been so altered, broken, and neglected, by planting in uncertain Stories, Legendes, Responses, Verses, vain Repetitions, Commemoracions, and Sinodalles [Synodals], that commonly when any booke of the Bible was begon, before thre or foure Chapters wer red out, al the rest wer unredde. And in this sort the booke of Esay [Isaiah] was begon in Advent, and the booke of Genesis in Septuagesima : but they were onely begonne, and never red through. After lyke sorte wer other bokes of holy scripture used. And moreover, wheras Saint Paule woulde have such language spoken to the people in the Church, as they might onderstande, and have profite by hearing thesame, the service in this church of Englande (these many yeres) hath been redde in Latine to the people, whiche they understoode not, so that they have heard with their eares only, and their hartes, spirite, and mynd, have not been edified therby. And furthermore, notwithstanding that thaunient fathers have devyded the Psalmes into seven porcions, wherof every one was called a Nocturne, now of late tyme, a fewe of them have been daily sayd (and oft repeated) and the rest utterly omitted. Moreover, the nombre and hardnesse of the rules, called the Pye, and the manifold changeinges [changes] of the service, was the cause, that to turne the booke onely, was so harde and intricate a matter, that many tymes there was more businesse to find out what should be read, then to reade it when it was found out.

These inconveniences therefore considered, here is set furthe suche an ordre, whereby thesame shalbe redressed. And for a readinesse in this matter, here is drawen out a kalendre for that purpose, which is plain and easy to be understanden [understood], wherin (so muche as may be) the reading of holy scriptures is so set furth, that all thinges shalbe doen in ordre, without breaking one piece therof from another. For this cause be cut of Anthemes, Responses, Invitatories, and such lyke thinges, as dyd breake the continual course of the reading of the scripture. Yet because ther is no remedy, but that of necessitie there must be some rules, therefore certayn rules are here set furth, which as they be fewe in nombre, so they be plain and easy to be onderstanden. So that here you have an ordre for prayer (as touching the reading of holy scripture) much agreable to the mynd and purpose of thold fathers, and a great deale more profitable and commodious, then that which of late was used. It is more profitable, because here are left out many thinges, whereof some be untrue, some uncertayn, some vain and superstitious, and is ordeyned nothing to be readde but the very pure woord of God, the holye scriptures, or that which is evidently grounded upon the same, and that in such a language and ordre, as is most easy and playne for the understanding bothe of the readers and hearers. It is also more commodious, bothe for the shortnesse therof, and for the playnesse of the ordre, and for that the rules be fewe and easye. Furthermore, by thys ordre, the Curates shall nede none other bookes for their publike service, but this booke, and the Bible, by the meanes wherof, the people shal not be at so greate charge for bookes, as in tyme paste they

have been.

And where hertofore there hath been greate diversitie, in saying, and singyng in churches within thys realme, some folowing Salisburie use, some Herford use, some the use of Bangor, some of Yorke, and some of Lincolne: now from hence furth, all the whole realme, shall have but one use. And if any would judge this way more paynfull, because that all thynges must be readde upon the booke, wheras before by the reason of so often repeticion, they could say many thinges by heart; if those men will weigh their labour, with the profite and knowledge, which daily they shall obteyne by readyng upon the booke, they will not refuse the peyn, in consideracion of the great profite that shal ensue therof.

And forasmuche as nothyng can almost be so playnly set furth, but doubtes may ryse in the use and practising of the same: To appease all such diversitie (if any aryse), and for the resolucion of all doubtes concerning the maner howe to understand, do, and execute the thinges contened in this booke: the parties that so dout [doubt], or diversly take any thing, shal alway resort to the Bishoppe of the dyocesse, who by hys discrecion shall take ordre for the quyeting and appeasing of the same : so that the same ordre be not contrary to any thyng conteyned in this booke. And yf the the Byshoppe of the Dyocesse be in any doubte, then may he sende for the resolucion therof unto the Archebishoppe.

Though it be appoynced in the afore written Preface, that all thynges shalbe readde and song in the Church, in the Englishe tongue, to the ende that the congregacion may bee thereby edified; yet it is not meant, but when men say Mornyng and Evening prayer privately, they may say thesame in any language that they themselves do understande.

And all Priestes and Deacons, shalbe bounde to say daily, the Morning and Evenyng prayer, eyther privately or openly, except they be letted [=prevented] by preaching, studying of divinitie, or by some other urgent cause.

And the Curate that ministreth in every paryshe Church or Chapell, beyng at home, and not beyng otherwyse reasonably letted [=prevented], shall say thesame in the Parishe Church or Chapell where he ministreth, and shall toll a belle therto, a convenient tyme before he begyn, that such as be disposed may come to heare Goddes woorde, and to praye with him.

The wording of the Preface was changed in a number of minor ways at various times throughout the life of this book.

These last three paragraphs were separated from the Preface and printed in italics in later editions

OF CEREMONIES,

WHY SOME BE ABOLISHED, AND SOME RETAYNED.

OF suche Ceremonies as be used in the church, and have hadde their beginning by the institution of man : Some at the firste were of Godlye entent and purpose devysed, and yet at length, turned to vanitie and supersticion : some entered into the Church, by indiscrete devocion and suche a zeale as was withoute knowledge: and for because they were winked at in the beginning, they grue daily to more and more abuses, which not only for their unprofitableness, but also because they have muche blynded the people, and obscured the glorye of God, are woorthy to be cut away, and cleane rejected. Other there be, which although they have been devysed by manne, yet it is thought good, to reserve them still, aswel for a decent ordre in the church (for the which they wer first devised) as because they pertain to edificacion : wherunto all thinges doen in the Church (as the Apostle teacheth) ought to be referred. And although the keypyng or omitting of a Ceremonie

(in it selfe considered) is but a small thyng : yet the wilfull and contempteous transgression, and breakyng of a common ordre, and discipline : is no small offence before God.

Let all thynges be doen emong you (saith S. Paule) in a semelye and dewe ordre. The appoyntment of the which ordre, perteyneth not to private men; therefore no man ought to take in hande, nor presume to appoincte or alter any publique or common ordre in Christes Church, excepte he be lawfully called and aucthorised therunto.

And wheras as in this our tyme, the mindes of menne are so diverse, that some thinke it a great matter of conscience, to departe from a piece of the least of their Ceremonies (they be so addicted to their old customes) and again on the other side, some be so newe fangled, that they would innovate all thing, and so do despise the olde, that nothing can like them, but that is newe: it was thought expedient, not so muche to have respect how to please and satisfie either of these parties, as how to please God, and profite them bothe. And yet lest anye man shoulde be offended (whom good reason might satisfie) here be certain causes rendered why some of the accustomed Ceremonies be put away, and some retained and kept still.

Some are put away, because the great excesse and multitude of them, bath so encreased in these latter days, that the burthen of them was intollerable; whereof S. Augustine in his tyme complained, that they were growe to suche a nombre, that the state of christian people was in worse case (concerning that matter) then wer the Jewes. And he counsailed that such yoke and burthen shoulde be taken away, as tyme woulde serve quietly to doe it.

But what woulde saint Augustine have sayde, if he had seen the Ceremonies of late dayes used emong us? wherunto the multitude used in his time was not to bee compared. This our excessive multitude of Ceremonies was so greate, and many of them so darke, that they did more confounde and darken, then declare and set furthe Christes benefites unto us.

And besides this, Christes Ghospell is not a Ceremoniall lawe (as muche of Moses lawe was) but it is a religion to serve God, not in bondage of the figure, or shadowe, but in the fredome of spirite, beyng content onelye with those Ceremonies, which doe serve to a decent ordre, and godlye discipline, and suche as be apte to styrr up the dull minde of manne, to the remembraunce of his duetie to God, by some notable and speciall significacion, whereby he might be edified.

Furthermore, the moste weightie cause of the abolishment of certain Ceremonies was, that thei wer so farre abused, partly by the superstitious blindnesse of the rude and unlearned, and partly by the unsaciabie avarice of such as sought more their owne lucre, then the glorye of God: that the abuses could not well be taken awaye, the thing remaining still. But now as concerning those persones, whiche peradventure will bee offended, for that some of the old Ceremonies are retained stil: if thei consider, that without some Ceremonies it is not possible to kepe anye ordre, or quyet discipline in the Church, they shall easely perceive just cause to reforme their judgements. And if they thinke muche that anye of the olde dooe remain, and would rather have all devysed newe: Then such men graunting some Ceremonies convenient to be had, surelye where the olde maye be well used, there they cannot reasonably reprove thold onely for their age without bewraying [betraying] of their awn foly. For in such a case, they ought rather to have reverence unto them, for their antiquitie, if they will declare themselves to be more studious of unitie and concord, then of innovacions and new fanglenesse, whiche (asmuch as maye bee with the true setting furth of Chrystes Religion) is alwayes to be eschewed. Furthermore, such shall have no just cause with the Ceremonies reserved, to be offended: For as those bee taken away, whiche wer moste abused, and dyd burthen mennes consciences without any cause: so the other that remain are retained for a Dyscipline and ordre, whiche (upon just causes) maye bee altered and chaunged, and therefore

are not to be esteemed equall with Goddes lawe. And moreover thei be neither darke nor dombe Ceremonies, but are so set furthe, that everye manne may understand what they dooe meane, and to what use they dooe serve. So that it is not lyke, that they in tyme to come, shoulde bee abused, as the other have been. And in these oure doynge, we condempne no other nacions, nor prescribe any thing, but to our awne people onelye. For wee thinke it convenient that every countrey should use such Ceremonies, as they shall thinke best, to the setting furth of Goddes honour, or glorye, and to the reducyng of the people to a moste perfect and Godly livyng, without errour or Supersticion. And that they should put away other thynges, whiche from tyme to tyme, they perceyve to bee moste abused, as in mennes ordinaunces, it often chaunceth diversely in divers countreys.

Return to the 1559 Book of Common Prayer

The Order for Morning Prayer

The Book of Common Prayer - 1559

THE ORDRE WHERE MORNING AND EVENING PRAYER
SHALBE USED AND SAYDE.

¶ *The Morning and Evening praier shalbe used in the accustomed place of the churche, chapel, or Chauncell, except it shalbe otherwise determined by the ordinary of the place: and the chauncels shall remain, as they have done in tymes past. And here is to be noted, that the Minister at the time of the communion, and at all other tymes in hys ministracion, shall use suche ornamentes in the church, as wer in use by auctoritie of parliament in the second yere of the reygne of king Edward the .VI. according to the acte of parliament set in the beginning of thys booke.*

¶ AN ORDRE FOR MORNING
PRAYER DAYLY THROUGHOUT THE YERE.

At the beginning both of Morning Prayer, and lykewyse of Evening Prayer, the Minister shall reade with a lowde voyce, some one of these sentences of the Scriptures that folowe. And then he shall say that, which is written after the said sentences.

AT what tyme soever a synner doth repent him of his sin from the bottome of hys harte; I wil put al his wickednes out of my remembraunce sayeth the Lord. Ezek. xviii.

I do know mine awne wickednes, and my syne is alwaies against me.

Psalm li.

Turne thy face away from our sinnes (O lorde) and blotte out all our offences. Psalm li.

A sorowful spirite is a sacrifice to God: despise not (O Lorde) humble and contrite hartes. Psalm li.

Rende your hartes, and not your garmentes, and turne to the Lorde your God, because he is gentle and mercyful, he is pacient and of muche mercie, and such a one that is sory for your afflictions. Joel ii.

To the, O Lorde God belongeth mercies and forgevenes: for we have gone away from the, and have not harkened to thy voice, whereby we myght walcke in thy lawes, whiche thou hast appointed for us. Daniel ix.

First page of Morning Prayer, from an edition printed in 1559. Clicking on the image will bring up a larger, readable image.

Correct us, O Lorde, and yet in thy judgement, not in thy furie, least we shoulde be consumed and brought to nothyng. Jere. ii

Amende your lives, for the kyngdome of God is at hande. Math. iii.

I will go to my father, and say to him, father, I have sinned against heaven, and againste the, I am no more worthy to be called thy sonne. Luke xv.

Entre not in to judgement wyth thy servaunts, O Lorde, for no fleshe is rightous in thy sight. Psal.cxlii.

If we saye that we have no synne, we deceyve ourselves, and there is no truthe in us.

1 John i.

DERELY beloved Brethren, the Scripture moveth us in sondry places, to acknowledge and confesse our manifold sinnes and wickednes, and that we should not dissemble nor cloke them before the face of almighty God our heavenly father, but confesse them with an humble, lowly, penitent and obedient harte to the ende that we may obtaine forgevenes of the same by his infinite goodnesse and mercie. And although we ought at all tymes humbly to knowledge* our synnes before God, yet ought we moste chiefly so to doe, when we assemble and mete toguether, to rendre thanks for the greate benefites that we have received at his handes, to sette furth his moste worthie praise, to heare his moste holye worde, and to aske those thynges whiche be requisite and necessarie, aswel for the bodye as the soule. wherfore I praye and beseche you, as many as be here presente, to accompany me wyth a pure harte and humble voice, unto the throne of the heauenly grace, saying after me.

* "acknowledge" from late 1500's

A generall confession, to be saide of the whole congregacion after the minister, knelyng.*

ALMIGHTIEand most merciful father, we have erred and strayed from thy waies, lyke lost shepee we have folowed to much the devises and desires of our owne hartes. We have offended against thy holy lawes: We have left undone those thinges whiche we ought to have done, and we have done those thinges which we ought not to have done, and there is no health in us, but thou, O Lorde, have mercy upon us miserable offendours. Spare thou them O God, whiche confesse their faultes. Restore thou them that be penitent, accordyng to thy promises declared unto mankynde, in Christe Jesu our Lorde. And graunt, O most merciful father, for his sake, that we may hereafter lyve a godly, ryghtuous, and sobre life, to the glory of thy holy name. Amen.

"made" in 1604

*The absolution[, or remission of sins,]*to be pronounced by the Minister alone.*

ALMIGHTY God, the father of our Lord Jesus Christ, which de sireth not the deathe of a sinner, but rather that he maye turne from his wickednesse and lyve: and hath geven power and commaundement to hys Ministers, to declare and pronounce to his people beyng penitent, the absolution and remission of their synnes: he pardoneth and absolveth all them which truly repent, and unfeinedly beleve his holy gospel. Wherefore we beseche him to graunt us true repentaunce and hys holy spirite, that those thynges may please hym, whych we doe at thys present, and that the rest of our life hereafter may be pure and holy so that at the last we may come to his eternall ioye, through Jesus Christe our lorde.

The people shal aunswere.

Amen.

Then shall the Minister heginne the Lordes Prayer wyth a loude voice.

OURFather, whiche arte in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kyngdom come. Thy will be done in earth as it is in heaven. Geve us this day our dayly breade. And forgeve us our trespasses, as we forgeve them that trespassed against us. And lead us not into temptacion. But deliver us from evil. Amene.

Then likewise he shall saye.

O Lord, open thou our lippes. * added in 1604

Aunswere. And our mouthe shall shewe furth thy prayse.

Prieste. O God, make spede to save us.

Aunswere. Lord, make haste to helpe us.

Prieste. Glory be to the father, and to the sonne [: and to the holye Ghost]*.

As it was in the beginning, [is nowe and ever shalbe: worlde without ende. Amen.]*

Praise ye the Lorde.

* Replaced by "&c." in 1604.

Then shalbe sayde or song, this Psalme folowyng.

O COME let us syng unto the lord: let us hartely rejoyce in the strength of our salvacion.

Let us come before his presence wyth thankesgevinge: and shewe oureselfe* gladde in hym wyth Psalmes.

For the Lorde is a great god: and a greate Kynge, above all goddes:

In his hand are al the corners of the earth: and the strength of the hilles is his also.

The Sea is his, and he made it and his handes prepared the drie lande.

O come, let us worshippe and fal doune: and knele before the lorde our maker.

For he is the Lord our god: and we are the people of his pasture, and the shepe of his handes.

To day if ye wyl heare his voyce, harden not your hartes: as in the provocation, and as in the daie of temptation in the wilderness.

When your fathers tempted me : proved me, and sawe my workes.

Fortie yere long was I greved with this generacion, and saide: it is a people that doe erre in their hartes: for they have not knowen my wayes.

Unto whom I sware in my wrath that the shoulde not enter into myrest.

Glory be to the father, and to the sonne: &c.

As it was in the beginning, is now, &c.

Venite exultemus domino. 95

"ourselves" from late 1500's

Then shal folowe certeyn Psalmes in order, as they bene appointed in a table made for that pourpose, excepte there be proper Psalmes appointed for that day, and at thend of everye Psalme throughout the yere, and likewise in thende of Benedictus, Benedicite, Magnificat, and Nunc Dimittis, shal be repeated.

Glory be to the father, and to the sonne, &c.

1604:

"Glory be to the Father, &c. As it was in the, &c."

Then shalbe redde two lessons distinctly with a loude voyce, that the people may heare. The first of the olde Testament, the seconde of the newe, Lyke as they he appointed by the Kalender, except there be proper Lessons, assigned for that daye: the Minister that readeth the Lesson, standyng and turning him so as he may best be heard of all such as be present, And before every lesson, the Minister thai saye thus. The fyrst, second, thyrd, or fourth chapiter of Genesis or Exodus, Mathewe, Marke, or other like, as is appointed in the Kalender, And in thend of everye chapiter, he shal saye,

¶ Here endeth such a Chapiter of suche a Booke.

And (to the ende the people maye the better heare) in suche places where they do synge, there shall the lessons be songe in a plaine tune after the maner of distinct readinge: and likewise the Epystle and gospels. After the firste lesson shall folowe, Te deum laudamus in Englyshe dayly throughe the whole yere.

Te Deum.

We prayse the, O God, we knoweledge the to be the Lorde
 All the earth doth worship the, the Father everlastynge.
 To the al Aungels crye aloude, the heavens and all the powers therein.
 To thee Cherubin, and Seraphin, continually do crye.
 Holy, holy, holy, Lorde God of Sabaoth.
 Heaven and earth are ful of the majesty of thy glory.
 The glorious company of the Apostles prayse the.
 The goodly felowship of the Prophetes prayse the.
 The noble army of Martyrs, prayse the.
 The holye Churche through out al the worlde dothe knowledge [acknowledge] the.
 The father of an infinite Majesty.
 Thy honourable true, and onely sonne.
 Also the holy ghost the comforter.
 Thou art the kyng of glory, O Christe.
 Thou arte the everlastynge sonne of the father.
 When thou tokest upon the to deliver man, thou diddest not abhore the virgins wombe.
 When thou haddeste overcome the sharpnes of death thou diddest open the kyngdome of
 heaven to al belevers.
 Thou syttest on the ryght hand of God, in the glorye of the father.
 We beleve that thou shalt come to be our judge. We therefore pray the, helpe thy servants whom
 thou hast redemed wyth thy precious bloude.
 Make them to be numbred with thy saintes, in glorye everlasting.
 O Lord save thy people: and blesse thine heritage.
 Govern theme and lifte them up for ever.
 Day by day we magnifye the.
 And we worshyp thy name ever world without ende.
 Vouchsafe, O Lorde, to kepe us thys daye without synne.
 O Lorde, have mercy upon us, have mercie upon us.
 O Lorde, let thy mercy lyghten upon us : as our trust is in the.
 O Lorde, in the have I trusted : let me never be confounded.
 Musical colon added to each line in late 1500's.
Or this canticle, Benedicite omnia opera Domini domino. O ALLye worckes of the Lorde, blesse
 ye the Lorde : praise him, and magnify him for ever.
 O ye Aungels of the Lord, blesse ye the Lorde : praise ye him, and magnifye him for ever.
 O ye heavens, blesse ye the Lorde : prayse him, and magnifye him for ever.
 O ye waters that be above the firmamente, blesse ye the Lorde: prayse him, and magnifye him
 for ever.
 O all ye powers of the lord, blesse ye the Lorde : prayse hym, and magnifie him for ever.
 O ye Sonne, and Mone, blesse ye the Lorde : prayse hym, and magnifie him for ever.
 O ye starres of heaven, blesse ye the Lorde : praise him, and magnifie him for ever.
 O ye showers, and dewe, blesse ye the Lorde : prayse him, and magnifie him for ever.
 O ye windes of God, blesse ye the Lorde : prayse him, and magnifye him for ever.
 O ye fyre and heate, blesse ye the Lord : praise him, and magnifie him for ever.
 O ye Winter and Sommer, blesse ye the Lorde : praise him, and magnifye him for ever.
 O ye dewes and frostes, blesse ye the Lorde : praise him, and magnifie him for ever.

O ye froste and cold, blesse ye the Lorde : praise him, and magnifie him for ever.
O ye Ice and Snowe, blesse ye the Lorde : praise him, and magnifie him for ever.
O ye nightes and daies, blesse ye the Lord : praise him, and magnifie him for ever.
O ye light and darknes, blesse ye the Lorde : prayse him, and magnifie him for ever.
O ye lyghtenynges and cloudes, blesse ye the Lorde : prayse him, and magnifie him for ever.
O let the earth blesse the Lorde : yea, let it praise hyrn, and magnifie hyrn for ever.
O ye mountaynes and hills : blesse ye the Lorde, prayse hym, and magnifie hym for ever.
O al ye grene thynges upon the earthe, blesse ye the Lord praise him, and magnifie hym for ever.

O ye welles, blesse ye the Lorde : praise him, and magnifye hym for ever.
O ye Seas, and fluddes, blesse ye the Lorde : praise hym, and magnifie hym for ever.
O ye whales, and all that move in the waters, blesse ye the Lorde : prayse him, and magnifie him for ever.

O all ye foules of the aire, blesse ye the lord, praise him, and magnifie him for ever.
O all ye beastes, and cattell, blesse ye the Lorde : praise him, and magnifye him for ever.
O ye children of men blesse ye the Lord : praise him, and magnifye him for ever.
O let Israel blesse the Lorde : praise him, and magnify him for ever.
O ye prestes of the lord, blesse ye the Lord : prayse hym, and magnifye him for ever.
O ye servauntes of the Lord, blesse ye the Lord : prayse him, and magnifye him for ever.
O ye sprites and soules of the righteous, blesse ye the Lord: prayse him, and magnify him for ever.

O ye holy and humble men of herte blesse ye the Lord : praise him, and magnifye him for ever.
O Ananias, Azarias, and Misael, blesse ye the lord : prayse him, and magnifye him for ever.
Glory be to the father, and to the Sonne [: and to the holye Ghoste]*.
As it was in the begynninge, is nowe, [and ever, etc]*.

* Replaced by "&c." in 1604.

And after the second lesson shalbe used and sayde Benedictus, in Englyshe, as foloweth,

Benedictus.

BLESSED be the Lord God of Israell : for he hath visited and redemed his people;
And hath raised up a mighty salvacion for us : in the house of hys servaunt David;
As he spake bi the mouth of his holy prophetes : which have benne sence the worlde began;
That we should be saved from our enemyes : and from the handes of al that hate us;
To performe the mercy promised to our forfathers : and to remember his holy covenant;
To perfourme the othe whiche he sware to our forefather Abraham : that he would geve us ;
That we beyng delivred out of the handes of oure enemies : might serve him withoute feare
In holynesse and ryghtuousnesse before hym : all the dayes of our lyfe.
And thou Chylde, shalt be called the Prophete of the hyghest for thou shalt go before the face of
the Lorde to prepare hys wayes;
To geve knowledge of salvacion unto hys people: for the remission of theyr synnes,
Through the tender mercie of our God : whereby the day spring from on hyghe, hath visited us;
To geve light to them that sitte in darckenes, and in the shadowe of death : and to guyde our
feete into the waye of peace.

Glory be to the father, and to the sonne, [and to the holy Gost]*.

As it was in the beginning, is now, [and ever shalbe : worlde wythout ende. Amen.]*

* Replaced by "&c." in 1604.

Or this Psalme.

O be joyfull in the Lorde (al ye landes:) serve the Lorde wyth gladnes, and come before hys presence wyth a song.

Be ye sure that the Lord he is God : it is he that hath made us, and not we ourselves; we are hys people, and the shepe of his pasture.

O go your way into his gates wyth thankesgeving, and into his courtes wyth prayse : be thanckefull unto hym, and speake good of hys name.

For the Lorde is gracious, his mercy is everlastyng : and his truth endureth from generacion to generacyon.

Glory be to the Father, &c. As it was in the, &c. Amen.

Then shal be sayd the Crede, by the Minister and the people, standyng.

I BELEVE in God the father almightie maker of heaven and earth. And in Jesus Christ hys onely sonne our Lorde, which was conceived by the holy ghoste, borne of the Virgen Mary. Suffred under Ponce Pylate, was crucified dead and buried, he descended into Helle. The thirde daye he rose agayn from the deade. He ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the ryghte hande of God the Father almightie. From thence he shall come to judge the quicke and the deade. I beleve in the holy Ghoste. The holy Catholique Church. The communion of saintes. The forgevenesse of sinnes. The resurrection of the body. And the life everlasting. Amen.

Jubilate Deo.

And after that, these prayers folowyng, aswell at Evenyng praier as at Mornyng prayer: al devoutlye knelyng. The Minister firste pronouncinge with a loude voyce.

The Lorde be with you.

Answer. And with thy spirite.

Minister. Let us praie.

Lorde have mercy upon us.

Christ have mercy upon us.

Lorde have mercy upon us.

Then the Minister, Clarkes, and people; shall saye the Lordes praier in Englyshe, with a loud voice.

Oure father Which, &c.

Then the Minister; standing up shal say.

O lorde, shewe thy mercy upon us.

Aunswere. And graunte us thy salvacion.

Prieste. O Lorde save the Queene.

Aunswere. And mercifully here us when we call upon the.

Prieste. Endue thy ministers with rightuousnes.

Aunswere. And make thy chosen people joyful.

Prieste. O Lorde save thy people.

Aunswere. And blesse thyne enheritaunce.

Prieste. Geve peace in our tyme, O Lorde.

Aunswere. Because there is none other that fyghteth for us, but onely thou, O God.

Prieste. O God make clene our hartes with in us.

Aunswere. And take not thy holy spirite from us.

Then shal folowe three Collectes. The firste of the daye, whiche shall be the same that is appointed at the Communion, The seconde for peace, The thirde for Grace to live wel. And the two leaste Collectes shal never altre, but dayly be sayde at Mornynge praier, throughoute al the yere, foloweth.

¶ The seconde Collecte for Peace.

O GOD, whiche art authour of peace, and lover of concord, in knowledge of whom standeth our eternal lyfe, whose service is perfect fredom; defend us thy humble servaunts in al assaultes of our enemies that we surely trusting in thy defence, may not feare the power of any adversaries : through the might of Jesu Christ our lord, Amen.

The thirde Collecte for Grace.

O LORDE our heavenly father, almightie and everlastyng God, whiche hast safely broughte us to the begynnyng of thys day: defende us in the same wyth thy myghtye power, and graunte that this daie we fall into no synne, nether rune into any kinde of daunger: but that al our doinges may be ordred by thy governaunce, to doe alwayes that is rightuous in thy sighte: through Jesus Christe our Lorde. Amen.

Return to the 1559 Book of Common Prayer

The Order for Evening Prayer

The Book of Common Prayer - 1559

AN ORDER

FOR EVENING PRAIER

THROUGHOUT THE YERE.

The Priest shal saie.

OUR Father, which, &c.

Then likewise he shal saye.

O Lord open thou our lippes.

Aunswere. And our mouth shall shewe furth thy prayse.

Priest. O God make spede to save us.

Aunswere. Lord, make haste to helpe us.

Priest.

Glory be to the father, and to the sonne: and to the holy ghoste. As it was in the beginninge, is now, and ever shal be : worlde wythout ende. Amen.

Praise ye the Lorde.

Then Psalmes in ordre, as they be appointed in the Table for Psalmes, except there be proper Psalmes appointed for that day. Then a Lesson of the olde Testament, as is appointed likewise in the kalender, except there be propre lessons appointed for that day. After that, Magnificatin Englishe, as foloweth.

Magnificat. Luke 1

MY soule doeth magnifie the Lorde.

And my sprit hath rejoyced in god my saviour.

For he hath regarded the loweliries of his handmaiden.

For beholde from hencefurth al generacions shall call me blessed.

For he that is mightie hath magnified me : and holy is his name.

And his mercy is on them that feare him : throughout all generacions.

He hath shewed strength with his arme; he hath scatered the proude in the imagination of their hertes.

He hath put downe the mightye from theyr seate : and hath exalted the humble and meke.

He hath filled the hungry with good thinges : and the ryche he hath sent empty away.

He remembring his mercy, hath holpen his servaunte Israel as he promysed to our forefathers, Abraham and his sede for ever.

Glory be to the Father, and to the sonne, [and to the holy Ghoste]*.

As it was in the beginnunge, is now, [and ever shalbe, world without ende. Amen.]*

Musical colon added to each line in late 1500's.

Replaced by "&c." in 1604.

Or the xcvi. Psalme Cantate domino canticum nouum.

O SINGE unto the Lorde a newe songe : for he hath done marveilous thinges.

With his owne right hande, and with his holy arme : hath he gotten him selfe the victorye.

The Lord declared his salvacion : his righteousnes hath he openly shewed in the syght of the Heathen.

He hath remembred his mercy and truthe towarde the house of Israel: and all the endes of the worlde haue sene the salvacion of our God.

Shewe your selves joyfull unto the Lorde, all ye landes : synge, rejoyce and geve thanks.

Prayse the Lorde upon the harpe : synge to the harp with a Psalme of thankesgeving.

With trumpettes also and shawmes : O shewe your selves joyfull before the Lord the kynge.

Let the Sea make a noyse, and all that therein is : the rounde worlde and they that dwell therin.

Let the floudes clappe their handes, and let the hylles be joyful togyther before the Lord : for he is come to judge the earth.

With righteousnes shal he judge the worlde : and the people with equitie.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Sonne, [and to the holy Ghoste.]* As it was in the beginnunge, is now, [and ever shalbe, worlde without ende. Amen.]*

Replaced by "&c." in 1604.

Then a lesson of the new testament. And after that (Nunc dirnittis) *in Englyshe, asfolloweth.*

LORDE, nowe letteth thou thy servaunt departe in peace : according to thy worde.

For myne eyes have sene : thy salvacion.

Whiche thou haste prepared : before the face of all people;

To be a lyght to lyghten the Gentiles : and to be the glorie of thy people Israell.

Glorye be to the father, and to the sonne, [and to the holy ghoste.]*

As it was in the beginning, is now, [and ever shall be, worlde withoute ende. Amen.]*

Replaced by "&c." in 1604.

Or els thys Psalme, Dens misereatur nostri *in Englyshe.*

GOD be merciful unto us, and blesse us : and shew us the light of his countenance, and bee mercifull unto us.

That thy way maie be knowne upon earth: thy savinge healthe amonge all nacions.

Let the people praise thee O God : yea, let all the people praise thee.

O let the nacions rejoyce and be glad: for thou shalte judge the folke righteouslye, and governe the nacions upon earth.

Let the people praise thee, O God: let all the people praise thee.

Then shall the earth bringe forth her increse: and God, even our owne God, shall geve us his blessinge.

God shall blesse us : and all the endes of the worlde shall feare him.

Glory be to the Father, &c.

As it was in the beginning, &c.

Then shal folow the Crede, with other prayers, as is before appoynted at Morning prayer, after Benedictus. And with the Collectes: Fyrste of the day, the seconde of peace, the thyrde for ayde agaynste all peryls, as hereafter foloweth, whiche two last Collectes shabe daylye sayde at Evenyng Prayer wythout alteracion.

The seconde Collecte at Evenyng Prayer.

O GOD, from whome all holy desires, all good counsailes, and all just woorkes do procede: geve unto thy servauntes that peace, whiche the worlde cannot geve: that bothe our hertes may be set to obey thy commaundementes, and also that by thee, we beyng defended from the feare of our enemies, may passe our time in rest and quietnes. Through the merites of Jesus Chryste our saviour. Amen.

The thyrde Collecte for ayde, against all peryls.

LYGHTENoure darckenesse, wee beseche thee (O Lorde,) and by thy greате mercye defende us from all perils and daungers of this nyghte, for the lone of thy onely sonne oure Savioure Jesus Christe. Amen.

In the feastes of christmas, the Epiphany, S. Mathye, Easter, the Assencion, Pentecost, S. John Baptyst, S. James, S. Bartholomew, S. Mathew, S. Simon, and Jude, S. Andrew, and Trinitie Sunday: Shalbe songe or sayde immediatly after Benedictus, thys confession of our Christen faythe.

WHOSOEVERwyl be saved : before all thynges it is necessarye that he holde the catholyke faythe.

Whiche Faithe, excepte everye one dooe kepe holy, and undefyled : withoute doubt he shall perysh everlastingly.

And the Catholyke Faythe is this : that we worshyp one God in Trinitie, and trinitie in unitie.

Neyther confounding the persons : nor devidinge the substaunce.

For there is one persone of the Father, an other of the Sonne : and another of the holy ghost.

But the Godhed of the Father, of the Sonne, and of the holy Ghost, is al one : the glory equall, the majesty coeternall.

Suche as the Father is, such is the sonne : and suche is the holy ghost.

The father uncreate, the sonne uncreate : and the holy ghoste uncreate.

The Father incomprehensible, the sonne incomprehensible : and the holy Ghoste incomprehensible.

The father eternall, the sonne eternall : and the holy Ghoste eternall.

And yet they are not thre eternalles : but one eternall.

As also there be not thre incomprehensibles, nor thre uncreated : but One uncreated, and one incomprehensible.

So likewyse the Father is almighty, the sonne almighty : and the holy ghoste almighty.

And yet are not there thre Almightyes, but one almighty.

So the father is God, the sonne is God : and the holy Ghoste is God.

And yet are they not thre Gods : but one God.

So lykewyse the father is Lord, the sonne Lorde : and the holy ghoste Lorde.

And yet not thre Lordes : but one Lord.

For like as we be compelled by the Christian verity : to acknowledge every person by hym selfe to be God, and Lorde.

So are we forbidden by the Catholique Religion : to say there be thre Gods, or thre Lordes.

The father is made of none : neyther created, nor begotten.

The sonne is of the Father alone : not made, nor created, but begotten.

The holy Ghoste is of the Father, and of the Sonne : neither made, nor created, nor begotten, but proceding.

So there is one father, not thre fathers, one sonne, not thre sonnes : one holy Ghost, not thre holy Ghostes.

And in this trinitie, none is afore, or after other : none is greater, nor lesse than other.

But the whole thre persons : be coeternall toguether and coequall.

So that in all thinges as is aforesayde : the Unitye in Trinitie, and the Trinitie in unitie is to be worshypped.

He therefore that wil be saved : must thus thincke of the Trinitie.

Furthermore, it is necessarye to everlasting salvation : that he also beleve rightlye in the Incarnation of oure Lorde Jesu Christ.

For the right Faythe is, that we beleve and Confesse : that oure Lorde Jesus Christe the sonne of God, is God and Man;

God of the Substaunce of the father, begotten before the worldes : and man of the substaunce of his mother, borne in the worlde.

Perfect god, and perfect man of a reasonable Soule, and humaine flesh subsistynge.

Equal to the father as touchyng his godhead : and inferior to the father, touchyng his manhode.

Who although he be God and man : yet he is not two, but one Christ.

One; not by conversion of the Godhead into fleshe: but by taking of the manhode into God;

One altogether, not by confusion of Substaunce: but by unitie of person.

For as the reasonable soule and flesh is but one man : so God and man is but one Christ.

Who suffred for our salvation : descended into hell, rose againe the thirde day from the deade.

He ascended into heaven: he sitteth bn the ryghte hand of the father, God Almighty, from whence he shall come to judge the quicke and the dead.

At whose comming all men shal rise againe with their bodies and shall geve accompt for their owne worckes.

And they that have done good, shall go into life everlasting and they that have done evel, into everlastyng fyre.

This is the Catholike faith, whiche except a man beleve faithfully, he can not be saved.

Glory be to the father, and to the sonne: and to the holy Ghoste.

As it was in the beginninge, is now, and ever shalbe : worlde without ende. Amen.

Thus endeth the order of Morning and Evening Prayer through the whole yere.

Quicunque vult

Return to the 1559 Book of Common Prayer

The Litany

The Book of Common Prayer - 1559

HERE FOLLOWETH THE

LETANI

TO BE USED

UPON SONDAIES, WEDNESDAIES, AND FRIDAYES,

AND AT OTHER TYMES, WHEN IT SHALBE COMMAUNDED BY THE ORDINARYE.

O GOD the father of heaven : have mercy upon us miserable synners.

O God the Father of heaven etc.

O God the sonne redemer of the worlde : have mercye upon us miserable synners. *O God the sonne redemer of, etc.*

O God the holye Ghoste, proceding from the father and the Sonne : have mercye upon us miserable synners. *O God the holy ghoste, proceding from, etc.*

O holy, blessed, and glorious Trinitie, three persons and one god : have mercy upon us miserable synners. *O holy, blessed, and glorious trinitie thre persons, etc.*

Remember not, Lorde our offences, nor the offences of our forefathers, neyther take thou vengeaunce of oure synnes spare us good Lorde, spare thy people whome thou haste redemed with thy moste precious bloude, and be not angry with us for ever. *Spare us good Lorde.*

From all evil and mischief, from synne, from the craftes and assaultes of the Devil, from thy wrath, and from everlasting dampnation. *Good Lorde delyver us.*

From all blyndnes of herte, from pride, vayne glorye, and hypocrisy, from envy, hatred and malice, and all uncharitablenes. *Good Lorde delyver us.*

From fornicacion and all other deadly synne: and frome all the deceiptes of the worlde, the Fleshe and the Devill. *Good Lorde delyver us.*

From lightnings and tempestes, from plague, pestilence and famine, from battayle and murder, and from soudeine death. *Good Lorde delyver us.*

From all sedicion and prively conspiracye, from all false doctrine and heresy, from hardnes of harte, and conternpte of thy worde and commaundement. *Good Lorde delyver us.*

By the misterye of thy holye Incarnacion, by thy holy Nativitie and circumcision, by thy Baptysme, fastynge and temptacion. *Good Lorde delyver us.*

By thyne agonye and bloudy sweate, by thy crosse and passion, by thy precious deathe and buriall, by thy glorious resurrection, and ascencion, and by the commynge of the holy Ghoste. *Good Lorde delyver us.*

In al tyme of our tribulacion, in al tyme of our welth, in the houre of death, and in the daye of judgement. *Good Lorde delyver us.*

We synners do beseche the to heare us (O Lord God,) and that it may please the to rule and governe thy holy Church universally, in the right way. *We beseche the to heare us good Lorde.*

That it may please the, to kepe and strengthen in the true worshipping of the in righteousnes and holynes of lyfe, thy servaunt Elizabeth our most gracious Quene and governour.* *We beseche the to heare us good Lorde.* * "thy servaunt JAMES our most gracious king and governour." in 1604, and changed similarly for Charles I.

That it may please the, to rule her harte in thy faith, feare, and love, that she may evermore have affiaunce [faith] in the, and ever seke thy honoure and glory. *We beseche the to heare us good Lorde.*

That it may please the, to be her defender and keper, geving her the victory over al her enemyes. *We beseche the to heare us good Lorde.*

[That it may please thee to bless and preserve our gracious Queen Anne, Prince Henry, and the rest of the King and Queen's Royal issue. *We beseech thee to hear us good Lorde.*]*

* added in 1604, and changed appropriately later (see below).

That it may please the to illuminate all Byshoppes, Pastours, and ministers of the Church, with true knowledge, and understanding of thy words, and that both by their preaching and livinge, they may sette it furth and shewe it accordingly. *We beseche the to heare us good Lorde.*

That it maye please thee to endue the Lordes of the Counsaile, and all the nobilitie, with grace, wisdom, and understanding. *We beseche the to heare us good Lorde.*

That it may please thee to blesse and kepe the Magistrates, geving them grace to execute justice, and to maynteyne truthe.

That it may please the to blesse, and kepe al thy people.

We beseche the to heare us good Lorde.

That it may please thee to geve to all nacions, unitie, peace and concorde. *We beseche the to heare us good Lorde.*

That it maye please the to geve us an harte to love and dread [respect] the, and diligently to lyve after thy commaundementes. *We beseche the to heare us good Lorde.*

That it maye please the to gyve all thy people encrease of grace, to heare mekely thy worde, and to receyve it wyth pure affeccion, and to bring furthe the fruites of the spirit. *We beseche the to heare us good Lorde.*

That it may please the to bring into the way of truth all suche as have erred, and are deceyved. *We beseche the to heare us good Lorde.*

That it maye please thee to strengthen suche as dooe stande, and to comforte, and helpe the weake-harted, and to rayse theym up that falle, and finally to beate downe Sathan under our feete. *We beseche the to heare us good Lorde.*

That it may please the to succour, helpe and comforte all that be in daunger, necessitie, and tribulation. *We beseche the to heare us good Lorde.*

That it maye please thee to preserve all that travayle [travel], by lande or by water, al women labouringe of chylde, all sycke persons and yonge chyl dren, and to shew thy pitye upon all prisoners and captives. *We beseche the to heare us good Lorde.*

That it may please the to defende, and provide for the fatherles children and widowes, and all that be desolate and oppressed. *We beseche the to heare us good Lorde.*

That it may please the to have mercy upon all men. *We beseche the to heare us good Lorde.*

That it may please the to forgeve our enemyes, persecutours and slaunderers, and to turne theyr hertes. *We beseche the to heare us good Lorde.*

That it may please the to geve and preserve to our use the kindly fruites of the earth, so as in due tyrne we maye enjoye them. *We beseche the to heare us good Lorde.*

That it may please the to geve us true repentaunce, to forgeve us all our sinnes, negligences, and ignoraunces; and to endue us with the grace of thy holy spirite, to amende our lyves according to thy holy worde. *We beseche the to heare us good Lorde.*

Sonne of God we beseche thee to heare us.

Sonne of God: we beseche thee to heare us.

O Lambe of God, that takest away the synnes of the worlde.

Graunt us thy peace.

O Lambe of God that takest awaye the synnes of the worlde,

Have mercy upon us.

O Christ heare us.

O Christe heare us.

Lorde have mercy upon us.

Lorde have mercy upon us.

Christe have mercy upon us.

Christe have mercy upon us.

Lorde have mercy upon us.

Lorde have mercy upon us.

Our father whiche art in heaven. &c.

And leade us not into temptacion. *But delyver us from evyll.*

Amen.

The Versycle. O Lorde deale not with us after our synnes.

The Aunsware. Neither rewarde us after our iniquities.

Let us praye.

O GODmerciful father, that dispisest not the syghing of a contrite hart, nor the desyre of suche as be sorowfull, mercyfully assiste our praiers that we make before the, in all our troubles and adversities, whensoever they oppresse us. And graciouslye hear us, that those evilles, whiche the crafte and subtiltie of the devel, or man worketh against us, be broughte to noughte, and by the providence of thy goodnesse they may be dispersed, that we thy Servauntes, beyng hurt by no persecucions, may evermore geve thanckes to the, in thy holy Church, through Jesus Christ our Lorde.

Lord aryse, helpe us, and deliver us for thy names sake.

GODwe have hearde with our eares, and our fathers have declared unto us the noble worckes that thou diddeste in their dayes, and in the olde tyme before them. *O Lord aryse, helpe us, and delyver us, for thyne honoure.*

Glory be to the father, and to the sonne, and to the holye Goste.

As it was in the beginninge, is nowe, and ever shalbe worlde without ende. Amen.

From our enemues defende us, O Christ. *Graciously loke upon our afflictions.*

Pitifully beholde the sorowes of our harte. *Mercifully forgeve the synnes of thy people.*

Favourably with mercy heare our prayers. *O sonne of David have mercy upon us.*

Bothe now and ever, vouchesafe, to heare us, O Christe. *Graciously hear us, O Christ, Graciously heare us, O Lorde Christ.*

The Versycle. O Lorde let thy mercy be shewed upon us.

The Aunsware. As we do put our trust in the.

Let us praye.

WE humbly beseche the, O father, niercifullye to loke upon oure infirmities, and for the glory of thy names sake, turne from us all those evilles that we moste righteously have deserved: and graunte that in all oure troubles we maye put our whole truste and confydence in thy mercye, and evermore serve the in holynes and purenes of living, to thy honour and glory : throughe our onely mediatoure and advocate Jesus Christe our Lorde. Amen.

Prayer for the Queenes Majesty.

O LORD our heavenly father, high and mighty king of kynges, Lorde of lordes, the onely ruler of princes, which doest from thy throne beholde all the dwellers upon earth, most hartely we beseche the with thy favoure to beholde our mooste gracious soveraigne Lady Quene Elizabeth*, and so replenyshe her with the grace of thy holy spirit, that she may alway incline to thy wil, and walcke

in thy waye: Indue her plentifully wyth heavenly gifts: Graunt her in health and wealthe longe to live: strength her that she may vanquish and overcome al her enemies: And finally after this life she may attaine everlasting joye and felicitie, thorowe Jesus Christ our Lorde. Amen.

* Replaced by a prayer for the King in 1604 (see below)

A Prayer for the Queen and Prince, and other the King and Queen's children.

ALMIGHTY God, which hast promised to be a Father of thine Elect, and of their seed, We humbly beseech thee to bless our gracious Queen Anne, Prince Henry, and all the King and Queen's royal progeny*: endue them with thy holy Spirit, enrich them thy heavenly grace, prosper them with all happiness, and bring them to thine everlasting Kingdom, through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

ALMIGHTY and everlastinge God, whiche onely workest great mervailles, sende downe upon our Bishoppes and Curates, and al congregacions committed to their charge, the healthful spirit of thy grace, and that they may truly please thee, Powre upon them the continuall deawe of thy blessinge: Graunte this, O Lorde, for the honour of our advocate and mediatoure, Jesus Christ. Amen.

¶ *A Prayer of Chrisostome.*

ALMIGHTY God, which hast geven us grace at this tyme with one accorde, to make our common supplications unto thee, and doest promyse that when two or three be gathered together in thy name thou wilt graunt their requestes: fulfyl now, O Lorde, the desyres and petitions of thy servauntes, as may be most expedient for them, graunting us in this world knowledge of thy truthe, and in the world to come lyfe everlasting. Amen.

¶ *ii. Corin. xiii.*

THE grace of oure Lorde Jesus Christe, and the love of God, and the felowship of the holye ghoste, bee wyth us all evermore. Amen.

¶ *For rayne, yf the tyme requyre.*

O GOD heavenly father, whiche by thy Sonne Jesus Christe, haste promysed to all them that seke thy kingdome and the righteousnes therof, all thinges necessary to their bodelye sustenance: Sende us, we beseeche the, in this oure necessitie, such moderate raine and showers, that we may receyve the fruytes of the earthe to our comforte and to thy honoure, throughe Jesus Christ our Lorde. Amen.

¶ *For fayre weather.*

O LORDE God, which for the synne of man diddest ones drowne al the world, excepte eyght persons, and afterward of thy great mercy diddest promise never to destroy it so againe: we humbly beseeche the, that althoughe we for our iniquities have worthely deserved this Plague of raigne and waters; yet upon oure true repentaunce, thou wilt sende us suche wether, wherby we may receyve the frutes of the yearth in due season, and learne bothe by thy punishment to amende our lives, and for thy clemency to geve thee prayse and glorye, throughe Jesus Christ our Lorde. Amen.

¶ *In the tyme of dearth and famyne.*

O GOD heavenly Father, whose gyft it is that the rayne dothe fall, the earth is frutefull, beastes encrease, and fyses do multiply: Behold, we beseeche thee, the afflictions of thy people, and graunte that the scarcitee and dearthe (which we do now moste justly suffer for our iniquitye) maye through thy goodnes be mercifully tourned into cheapnesse and plenty, for the love of Jesu Christ our Lorde, to whome with thee and the holye Ghoste be Prayse for ever. Amen.

¶ *In the tyme of Warre.*

O ALMIGHTY God, king of al kinges, and governoure of al thinges, whose power no creature is hable to resiste, to whome it belongeth justly to punyshe synners, and to be mercyfull unto then that truely repente, Save, and deliver us (we humbly besече thee) from the handes of our enemyes, abate their pryde, aswage theyr malyce, and confounde theyr devyses, that we beyng armed with thy defence, maye be preserved evermore from all peryls to glorifye thee, whiche art the onely gever of all victory, throughe the merites of thy onely sonne Jesus Christ our Lorde. Amen.

¶ *In the tyme of any common plague or syckenesse.*

O ALMIGHTY God, whiche in thy wrathe, in the tyme of king David didst slea [slay] with the plague of pestilence, thre score and ten thousande, and yet remembre thy mercy, diddest save the rest: have pitie upon us miserable synners, that nowe are vysited with great sicknesse, and mortalitie, that like as thou diddest then commaunde thyne angel to cease from punishing; So it may now please thee to withdrawe from us this plague, and grevous syckenesse, throughe Jesus Christe our Lorde. Amen.

O GOD, whose nature and propertie is ever to have mercy,
and to forgeve, receyve our humble petitions: and
thoughe we be tyed and bounde with
the chayne of our synnes, yet let
the pitifulnes of thy great mercy
lose us, for the honoure of
Jesus Christes sake,
our mediatoure
and advocate.
Amen.

This prayer added in 1604 (see below for variations).

* sometimes "issue"

The following Thanksgivings were added in 1604:

A thanksgiving for Rain

O GOD our heavenly Father, who by thy gracious providence dost cause the former and the latter rain to descend upon the earth, that it may bring forth fruit for the use of man; We give thee humble thanks that it hath pleased thee, in our greatest necessity, to send us at the last a joyful rain upon thine inheritance, and to refresh it when it was dry, to the great comfort of us thy unworthy servants, and to the glory of thy holy Name; through thy mercies in Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

A thanksgiving for fair Weather.

O LORD God, who hast justly humbled us by thy late plague of immoderate rain and waters, and in thy mercy hast relieved and comforted our souls by this seasonable and blessed change of weather; We praise and glorify thy holy Name for this thy mercy, and will always declare thy loving-kindness from generation to generation; through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

A thanksgiving for Plenty.

O MOST merciful Father, which of thy gracious goodness hast heard the devout prayers of thy Church, and turned our dearth and scarcity into cheapness and plenty; We give thee humble thanks for this thy especial bounty; beseeching thee to continue this thy loving-kindness unto us, that our land may yield us her fruits of increase, to thy glory and our comfort; through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

A thanksgiving for peace and victory.

O ALMIGHTY God, which art a strong tower of defence unto thy servants against the face of their enemies; We yield thee praise and thanksgiving for our deliverance from those great and apparent dangers wherewith we were compassed. We acknowledge it thy goodness that we were not delivered over as a prey unto them; beseeching thee still to continue such thy mercies towards us, that all the world may know that thou art our Saviour and mighty Deliverer; through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

A thanksgiving for Deliverance from the Plague

O LORD God, which hast wounded us for our sins, and consumed us for our transgressions, by thy late heavy and dreadful visitation; and now, in the midst of judgment remembering mercy, hast redeemed our souls from the jaws of death; We offer unto thy fatherly goodness ourselves, our souls and bodies which thou hast delivered, to be a living sacrifice unto thee, always praising and magnifying thy mercies in the midst of the Congregation; through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

Or this.

WE humbly acknowledge before thee, O most merciful Father, that all the punishments which are threatened in thy law might justly have fallen upon us, by reason of our manifold transgressions and hardness of heart: Yet seeing it hath pleased thee of thy tender mercy, upon our weak and unworthy humiliation, to assuage the noisome Pestilence wherewith we lately have been sore afflicted, and to restore the voice of joy and health into our dwellings; We offer unto thy Divine Majesty the sacrifice of praise and thanksgiving, lauding and magnifying thy preservation and providence over us; through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

Variations in the State Prayers

Date Prayer for the King's / Queen's Majesty Prayer for the Royal Family

1559 Sovereign Lady Queen Elizabeth [*prayer added 1604*]

1603 Sovereign Lord King James Queen Anne, Prince Henry ...

1613 Queen Anne, Prince Charles, Fredericke the Prince Elector Palatine and the Lady Elizabeth his wife ...

1619 Prince Charles, Frederick the Prince Elector Palatine, the Lady Elizabeth his wife ...

1621 Prince Charles, Frederick the Prince Elector Palatine, the Lady Elizabeth his wife with all their royall [*or princely*] issue ...

1625 Sovereign Lord King Charles (I) Queene Mary, Fredericke the Prince Elector Palatine. the Lady Elizabeth his wife ...

1630 Queen Mary, our Noble Prince Charles, Fredericke the Prince Elector Palatine, the Lady Elizabeth his wife with their princely issue...

1633 Queen Mary, our Noble Prince Charles, the Lady Mary & the Lady Elizabeth ...

1634 Queen Mary, Prince Charles and the rest of the royal progeny

The Book of Common Prayer was not published from 1643 through 1659.

1660 Sovereign Lord King Charles (II) Queen Mary, Prince James Duke of York and the rest of the royal progeny

A number of variatons on the exact wording of the State Prayers exist.

Return to the 1559 Book of Common Prayer

The Order of the Administration of the Lord's Supper, or Holy Communion

The Book of Common Prayer - 1559

THE ORDRE

FOR THE

ADMINISTRACION OF THE LORDES SUPPER,

OR HOLY COMMUNION.

So many as entend to be partakers of the holy Communion, shall signifie their names to the Curate over night; or els in the mornynge, afore the beginning of morning prayer or immediately after.

And if any of those be an open and notorious evil liver, so that ye congregacion by him is offended, or have done any wrong to hys neighbours by word or dede ye curate havynge knowledge therof, shal cal hym, and advertyse hym, in any wise not to presume to the Lordes table, until he have openly declared him self to have truely repented, and amended his former naughty lyfe, that the Congregacion may therby be satisfyed, which afore were offended, and that he have recompensed the parties, who he hath done wrong unto, or at the least declare him selfe to be in full purpose so to doe, as sane as he conveniently may.

Thesame order shall the Curate use with those, betwixt whome he perceyveth malice and hatred to raigne not suffering them to be partakers of the Lordes table untill he know them to be reconciled. And if one of the parties so at variance, he content to forgeve from the bottome of hys hart, all that the other hath trespassed agaynste him, and to make amends for that he hymn self hath offended: and the other partye wyll not be perswaded to a godly unitye, but remain stil in his frowardnes and malice The Minister in that case, ought to admit the penitent person to the holy Communion, and not hym that is obstinate

The table, havynge at the Communion tyme a fayre whyte linnen cloth upon it, shall stand in the body of the churche or in the chauncell where mornynge prayer and evenynge prayour be appointed to be sayd. And the priest, standynge at the Northe syde of the table, shal say the Lordes prayour wyth this collecte followynge.

ALMIGHTY God, unto whom al hartes be open, al desires knowe, and from whom no secretes are hyd: clense the thoughtes of our hartes by the inspiracion of thy holy spirite, that we may perfectly love the, and worthily magnify thy holy name, through Christe our Lorde. Amen.

Then shal the Priest rehearse distinctly at the .x. Commaundementes, and the people knelyng, shal after every Commaundemente aske Goddes mercye for theyr transgressyon of the same, after thys sorte.

Minister. God spake these wordes, and saide, I am the Lord thy God, Thou shalt have none other Goddes but me.

People. Lorde have mercye upon us, and encline our hartes to kepe this lawe.

Minister. Thou shalt not make to thy self any graven ymage, nor the likenes of any thyng that is in heaven above, or in the earth beneth, or in the water under the earth. Thou shalt not bow doune to them, nor worshyppe the, for I the Lord thy God am a gelous God, and visite the synne of the fathers uppon the children, unto the thyrde and iiij. generacyon of them that hate me, and shew rnercie unto thousandes in theim that love me, and keepe my commaundementes.

People. Lorde have mercye upon us, and encline our hartes to kepe this lawe.

Minister. Thou shalt not take the name of the Lorde thy God in vaine, for the Lorde wil not holde hym giltlesse that taketh his name in vaine.

People. Lorde have mercie upon us, and encline our, &c.

Minister. Remembre that thou kepe holy the Sabboth daie: .vi. dayes shalt thou laboure, and doe all that thou haste to do, but the .vii. day is the Sabboth of the lorde thy god. In it thou shalt do no maner of worke, thou and thy sonne and thy daughter, thy man servaunt, and thy mayd servaunt, thy Catel, and the straunger that is within thy gates: For in .vi. daies the Lord made heaven and

earth, the Sea and all that in them is, and reasted the seventh daye. Wherefore the Lorde blessed the seventh daye and halowed it.

People. Lorde have mercy upon us, and encline our. &c.

Minister. Honour thy father and thy mother, that thy daies may be long in the lande which the Lord thy God geveth the.

People. Lorde have mercy upon us, and encline. &c.

The Minister. Thou shalt not do murther.

People. Lorde have mercy upon us, and encline. &c.

Minister. Thou shalt not committe adultery.

People. Lorde have mercy upon us, and encline. &c.

Minister. Thou shalt not steale.

People. Lorde have mercy upon us, &c.

Minister. Thou shalt not beare false wytnesse agaynste thyneighbour.

People. Lorde have mercy upon us, and encline our hartes to kepe this lawe.

Minister. Thou shalt not covet thy neighbours house, Thou shalt not covet thy neighbours wife, nor his servaunt, nor his maide, nor his oxe, nor his asse, nor any thing that is his.

People. Lord have mercy upon us, and write al these thy lawes in our hartes we beseeche the.

¶ Then shall folowe the Collect of the day with one of these two Collectes folowyng for the Quene, the Priest standyng up and saying.

Let us praye Priest.

ALMIGHTY God, whose kyngdom is everlasting, and power infinite, have mercy upon the whole congregacion, and so rule the heart of thy chose servant Elizabeth our Quene and governoure that she (knowing whose minister she is) may above all thinges, seke thy honoure and glorye: and that we her subjectes, (duly considering whose auctority she hath) may faithfully serve, honour, and humblye obey her in the and for the, according to thy blessed worde, and ordinance, through Jesus Christ our Lord, who with the and the holye ghost, lyveth and reyneth ever one God, worlde without ende. Amen.

ALMIGHTY and everlastinge God, we be taughte by thy holy word, that the hartes of Princes are in thy rule and governaunce, and that thou doest dispose, and turne them as it semeth best to thy Godly wysedome: we humbly beseeche thee, so to dispose and governe the harte of Elizabeth, thy servaunte, our Quene and governour, that in all her thoughtes, wordes, and workes she may ever seke thy honoure and glorye, and studye to preserve thy people committed to her charge, in welth, peace and godlynes. Graunt this O merciful father, for thy deare sonnes sake Jesus Christ our Lorde. Amen.

Immediately after the Collectes, the Priest shall reade the Epystle beginning thus.

The Epystle written in the. Chapter of. *And the Epystle ended, he shal say the Gospel, beginninge thus.*

The Gospell wrytten in the. Chapter of. *And the Epistle and Gospel being ended, shalbe said the Crede.*

I BELEVE in one God, the father almighty maker of heaven and earthe, and of all thynges visible and invisible: And in one Lorde Jesu Christe, the onely begotten sonne of GOD, begotten of his father before al worldes, god of God, lyghte of lyghte, verye God of verye God, gotten, not made, beyng of one substance wyth the father, by whome all thinges were made, who for us men, and for oursalvation came doune from heaven, and was incarnate by the holy Ghoste, of the Virgine Mary, and was made man, and was crucified also for us, under poncius Pilate. He suffered and was

buried, and the thyrde dayhe rose againe accordinge to the Scriptures, and ascended into heaven, and sitteth at the right hande of the father. And he shal come againe with glory, to judge both the quicke and the deade, whose Kyngdome shall have none ende. And I beleve in the holye Ghoste, The Lorde and geuer of life, who procedeth from the father and the sonne, who with the father and the sonne together is worshipped and glorified who spake by the Prophetes. And I beleve one catholicke and Apostolicke Church. I acknowledge one Baptisme, for the remission of synnes. And I loke for the resurreccion of the dead : and the lyfe of the worlde to come. Amen.

After the Crede yf there be no sermon, shall folowe one of the Homelies alredy set furth, or hereafter to he set furth by commune auctoritie.

After suche Sermon, homely, or exhortacion, the Curate shall declare unto the people, whether there be anye holy dayes or fastynge dayes the weke folowyng, and earnestly exhorte theim to remembre the poore, saying one, or moe of these sentences following, as he thinketh most convenient by his discretion.

This prayer was changed appropriately for subsequent monarchs, King James & King Charles

LET your light so shyne before men, that they maye see your good workes, and glorifye youre father whyche is in heaven. Math. v.

Laye not up youreselves treasure upon the earthe, where the ruste and mothe doeth corrupte, and where theeves breake through and steale: But lay up for youreselves treasures in heaven, where neyther rust, nor motthe doeth corrupt, and where theeves do not breake thorowe and steale. Math. vi.

Whatsoever you woulde that menne shoulde do unto you, even so due unto them, for this is the lawe and the Prophetes. Math. vii.

Not every one that sayeth unto me Lord, Lord, shall entre into the Kingdome of heaven; but he that doeth ye wyl of my father whiche is in heaven. Math.vii.

Zache [Zaccheus] stode forth, and sayde unto the Lord, beholde Lord, the halfe of my goodes I gyve to the poore, and yf I have done any wronge to any man, I restore foure folde. Luk. xix.

Who goeth a warefare at any tyme of his owne coste? Who planteth a vyneyarde, and eateth not of the fructe thereof? Or who feedeth a flocke, and eateth not of the mylke of the flocke? i Cor. ix.

If we have sown unto you spiritual thinges, is it a great matter, yf we shal reape your worldly thinges? i. Cor. ix.

Do ye not knowe, that they whiche minister aboute holy thinges, lyve of the sacrifice? whyche wayte of the aultare, are partakers with the aultare. Even so hath the Lorde also ordeyned : that they whiche preache the Gospell, shoulde lyve of the gospel. i. Cor. ix.

He which soweth lytle shal reape lytle; and he that soweth plenteously, shal reape plenteously. Let every man doe accordynge as he is dysposed in his harte, not grudgynglye or of necessitie: for God loveth a cherefull gyver. ii. Cor. ix.

Let hym that is taughte in the woorde, minister unto him that teacheth, in all good thinges. be not deceived, God is not mocked; for whatsoever a man soweth, that shall he reape. Gala.[6]

Whyle we have tyme, let us do good unto al men, and specially unto them, whiche are of the householde of faythe. Gala vi.

Godlynes is great ryches, yf a man be contente with that he hath: for we brought nothyng into the worlde, neyther may we cary any thing out. i. Tim. vi.

Charge them whyche are ryche in thys worlde, that they be ready to give, and glade to distribute, laying up in store for them selves a good foundacion, against the time to come, that they may attayne eternal lyfe. i Tim. vi.

God is not unrighteous, that he wil forget your workes and laboure that procedeth of love,

whiche love ye have shewed for his names sake, whiche have ministered unto saintes, and yet do minister. Hebr. vi.

To do good, and to distribute, forget not, for with such sacrifices God is pleased. Heb. xiii

Whoso hath thys worldes good, and seeth his brother have nede and shutteth up his compassyon from hym, how dwelleth the love of God in hym? i. John iii.

Geve almose [alms] of thy goodes, and turne never thy face from any poore man, and then the face of the Lorde shall not be turned away from the. Tob. iiiii

Be mercifull after thy power. If thou hast muche gyve plenteously, if thou hast litle, doe thy diligence gladly to geve of that litle, for so gatherest thou thy selfe a good rewarde in the day of necessitye. Tob. iiiii

He that hath pitye upon the poore, lendeth unto the Lorde: and looke what he layeth out: it shalbe paid him agayne. Pro xix.

Blessed be the man that provydeyth for the sycke, and nedy, the Lorde shall deliver him, in the time of trouble.

Then shal the Churchwardens, or some other by them appoynted, gather the devocion of the people, and put the same into the poore mens boxe, and upon the offeryng daies appoynted, every man and woman shal pay to the Curate the due and accustomed offerings, after whiche done, the Priest shal saie.

Let us pray for the whole estate of Christes Church militant here in earth.

Psal. lxi.

ALMIGHTYE and everliving God, whych by thy holye Apostle hast taughte us to make prayers and supplicacyons, and to geve thanckes for all men: We humbly beseche thee moste mercifully (to accepte our almose) and to receyve these our prayers whyche of we offer unto thy divine majestie, beseechyng the to inspire continually, the universal Church wyth the spiryte of truthe, unitye, and concorde: And graunt that all they that do confesse thy holy name, may agree in the truthe of thy holy woorde, and lyve in unytie and godlye love. We beseche thee also to save and defend alle Christyane Kynges, Prynces, and Governours, and specially thy servaunt, Elyzabeth our Quene that under her we may be godly and quietly governed: and graunt unto her whole Counsaill, and to all that be put in auctoritye under her, that they may truely and indifferently [impartially] minister justice, to the punishement of wyckednes and vice, and to the maintenaunce of goddes true religion and vertue. Give grace (O heavenly Father) to al Bishopes, Pastours and Curates, that they may bothe by theyr life and doctrine set furth thy true and lively worde and rightely and duely administer thy holy Sacramentes: and to all thy people gyve thy heavenlye grace, and especially to thys congregacion heare present, that with meke harte and due reverence, they may heare and receive thy holy worde, truely serving the in holines and ryghtuousnes all the dayes of theyr lyfe. And we moost humbly beseche the of thy goodnes (O Lord) to comfort and succoure all theym whyche in thys transitory lyfe bee in trouble, Sorowe, nede, sicknes, or any other adversity. Graunt this, O father, for Jesus Christes sake our onely Mediatour and advocate. Amen.

If ther be none almes geven unto the poore, then shall the words of accepting our almes bee lefte out unsayd.

Then shal folowe this exhortacion, at certayne tymes when the Curate shal see the people negligent to come to the holy Communion.

WE be come together at thys tyme, derely beloved brethren to fede at the Lordes supper, unto the whyche in Goddes behalf I bydde you all that be heare present, and beseche you for the lorde Jesus Christes sake, that ye wyll not refuse to come thereto, beyng so lovingly called, and bidden of God him selfe. Ye know howe grevous and unkynde a thing it is, when a manne hath prepared a

riche feaste: decked his table with al kynde of provisyon, so that there lacketh nothings but the gestes to sitte downe: and yet they whych be called wythout anye cause, mooste unthankfully refuse to come. Whyche of you in suche a case woulde not be moved? Who woulde not thyncke a greate injurie and wrong done unto hym? Wherefore moste derely beloved in Christe take ye good heade, lest ye, wythdrawyng your selves from this holy supper, and provoke Goddes indignation against you, it is an easy matter for a man to say, I will not communicate, because I am otherwise letted [hindered] with worldly busynes, but suche excuses be not so easily accepted and allowed before god. If any man say, I am a grevous sinner, and therefore am afrayed to come. Wherefore then do ye not repent and amende? When god calleth you, be you not ashamed to say ye wil not come? when you should returne to god, wil you excuse your self and say that you be not redy? Considre earnestly with your selves howe litle such feined excuses shall availe before God. They that refused the feaste in the Gospell, because they had bought a farme, or would trie their yokes of oxen, or because they were married, were not so excused, but conpted [counted] unworthy of the heavenly feast. I for my part am here present and according to myne office, I bid you in the name of god, I cal you in Christes behalfe, I exhort you, as you love your owne Salvation, that ye wil be partakers of this holy Communion. And as the sonne of God, did vouchesafe to yelde up his soule by death upon the crosse for your healthe, even so it is youre duety to receyve the Communion together in the remembraunce of his death as he hymselfe cornmaunded. Nowe, yf ye wyll in no wise thus do, consider with your selves, how great injury ye doe unto God, and howe sore punishment hangeth over your heades for thesame. And whereas ye offende God so sore in refusing this holy banquet, I admonishe, exhorte, and beseche you, that unto this unkyndenes ye wyll not adde any more. Whiche thing ye shall doe yf ye stand by as gasers and lokers of them that do Communicate, and be no partakers of the same your selves. For what thing can this be accompted els, then a further contempt and unkindenes unto God? Truly it is a greate unthankfulness to saye naye when ye be called, but the faulte is muche greater, when men stande by, and yet wyll neyther eate, nor drincke this holye Communion with other. I praie you what can this be ells but even to have the misteries of Christ in derision: it is sayde unto al: Take ye and eate, take and drincke ye al of this, do this in remembraunce of me. With what face then, or with what countenaunce shal ye here these wordes? what wyl this be els, but a neglecting, a despisyng, and mockyng of the Testament of Christ? wherfore rather the you shold so do, departe you hence, and geve place to them that be Godly dysposed. But when you departe, I beseche you pondre with yourselves, from whome ye departe: ye departe from the Lordes Table: ye depart from your brethren, and from the banket [banquet] of most heavenly foode. These thynges (yf ye earnestly consydre) ye shall by Goddes grace, returne to a better mynde, for the obteining wherof, we shall make our humble petitions while we shal receive the holy Communion.

And some tyme shalbe said this also, at the discretion of the Curat.

DERELY beloved, for asmuche as our dutye is to rendre to almighty God our heavenly father most hartly thanckes for that he hathe geven his sonne our Sauour Jesus Christ not onely to die for us, but also to be oure Spirituall fode, and sustenaunce, as it is declared unto us, aswel by Goddes worde, as by the holy sacramentes of his blessed body and bloud, the which being so comfortable a thing to them whiche receive it worthelye and so daungerous to them, that wil presume to receyve it, unworthely. My duty is to exhorte you to considre the dignitie of the holy mistery, and the great peril of the unworthy receyving therof, and so to searche and examine youre owne consciences, as you shold come holy and cleane to a moste godly and heavenly feast, so that in no wise you come but in the mariage garment, required of God in holy scripture, and so come and be receyved as

worthye partakers of suche a heavenly Table, the waye and meanes therto is.

First to examine your lives and conversation by the rule of Goddes commaundementes and wherinsoeuer ye shall perceyve your selves to have offended eyther by wil, worde, or deede, there bewaile your owne synfull lives, confesse your selves to almighty God, with ful purpose of amendement of life. And yf ye shal perceive your offences to be such, as be not only against God, but also against your neighbours. Then ye shal reconcyle youre selves unto them, ready to make restitution and satisfaction according to the uttermost of your powers for all injuries and wronges done by you to any other, and likewise being ready to forgeve other that have offended you as you would have forgivenes of your offences at Goddes hande. For otherwyse the receiving of the holy Communion doth nothing els, but encrease your dampnation.

And because it is requisite that no manne shoulde come to the holye Communion, but with a ful trust in goddes mercy, and with a quiet conscience: therfore yf there be any of you, which by the meanes aforesaid cannot quiet his owne conscience, but requireth further comforte or counsaile, then let him come to me, or some other discrete and learned minister of gods word, and open his grieffe, that he may receive suche ghostly counsaile, advise, and comfort, as his conscience may be releved, and that by the ministry of Gods word, he may receyve comfort, and the benefyte of absolution, to the quieting of his conscience, and advoiding of all scruple and doubtfulnes. ¶ *Then shall the Priest say this exhortation.*

DERELY beloved in the Lorde: Ye that mynde to come to the holye Communion of the bodye and bloude of oure savioure Christe, must consyder what sainte Paule writeth unto the Corinthiens, howe he exhorteth all persones diligentlye to trye and examyne them selves, before they presume to eate of that breade, and drincke of that cuppe. For as the benefyte is greate, yf wyth a trulye penitente herte and lyvely faith we receive that holy sacrament (for then we spiritually eate the fleshe of Christ, and drincke his bloude, then we dwell in Christe and Christe in us, we be one wyth Christ, and Christe with us) so is the daunger great, if we receyve the same unworthely. For then we be guilty of the body and bloude of Christ our saviour. We eate and drincke our owne dampnation, not considering the lordes bodye. we kinde Gods wrath against us, we provoke him to plague us with divers diseases, and sundrye kyndes of death. Therfore if any of you be a blasphemer of god, an hinderer or slaunderer of his worde, an adulterer, or be in malyce or envye, or in anye other grevous crime, bewaile your Sinnes, and come not to this holy table, lest after the taking of that holy sacrament, the devil enter into you, as he entred into Judas, and fill you full of al iniquities, and bring you to destruction both of bodye and soule. Judge therefore your selves (brethren) that ye be not judged of the Lord. Repent you truly for your sinnes past, have a lively and stedfast faith in Christ our saviour. Amende your lives, and be in perfect charitie wyth all men, so shal ye be mete partakers of those holy misteries. And above al thinges ye must geve most humble and herty thanks to God the father, the sone, and the holye ghost, for the redemption of the world by the deathe and passion of our saviour Christ, bothe God and man, who did humble him selfe, even to the deathe, upon the crosse, for us miserable sinners which lay in darckenes, and shadowe of death, that he mighte make us the children of God, and exalte us to everlasting life. And to thende that we should alwaie remembre the exceadinge greate love of our master and onelie saviour Jesu Christ, thus dying for us, and the innumerable benefites (which by his precious bloudshedding) he hath obtained to us, he hath instituted and ordeined holy misteries, as pledges of his love, and continuall remembraunce of his death, to our great and endles comfort. To him therfore with the father and the holye Ghost, let us geve (as we are moste bounden) continuall thanks, submitting our selves wholly to his holie will and pleasure, and studyng to serve him in true holines and

righteousnes, al the daies of our life. Amen.

Then shall the Priest saye to them that come to receyve the holy Communion.

You that do truly and earnestly repente you of youre sinnes, and be in love, and charite with your neighbors and entende to lede a newe lyfe, folowing the commaundementes of God, and walkynge from hence furthe in his holy waies: Draw nere and take this holy Sacrament to your comforte make your humble confession to almighty God, before this congregation here gathered together in his holye name, mekely knelynge upon your knees.

¶ Then shall this generall confession be made, in the name of all those, that are mynded to receyve this holy Communion, either by one of them, or els by one of the ministers, or by the priest him selfe, all kneeling humbly upon their knees.

ALMIGHTY God, father of oure Lorde Jesus Christe, maker of all thynges, Judge of all menne, we acknowledge and bewaile oure manifolde synnes and wyckednesse, whiche we from tyme to tyme moste grevously have committed, by thoughte woorde and deede, against thy divine Majestie, provokynge mooste justlye thy wrathe and indignation againste us: we do earnestly repente, and bee hartely sorye for these oure misdoinges, the remembraunce of them is grevous unto us: the burthen of them is intollerable: have mercy upon us, have mercye upon us, mooste mercyfull father, for thy sonne oure Lorde Jesus Christes sake, forgeve us all that is paste, and graunte that we may ever hereafter serve and please the, in newenes of lyfe, to the honour and glorie of thy name throughe Jesus Christ our Lorde. Amen.

¶ Then shall the priest or the Bishop (beyng present) stande up, and turning himself to the people shall say thus.

ALMIGHTY God, oure heavenly father, who of his great mercy hathe promised forgevenes of sinnes, to al them, whiche with hartye repentaunce and true faithe turne to hym: have mercye upon you, pardon and deliver you from all your sinnes, confirme and strengthen you in all goodnes, and bring you to everlastyng lyfe; through Jesus Christ our Lorde. Amen.

Then shall the Priest also saye.

Here what comfortable wordes our saviour Christ saithe to all them that truly turne to him.

¶ COME unto me all that travaile and be heavy laden, and I shal refreshe you. So God loved the world that he gave his onely begotten sonne, to thende that al that beleve in him, should not perishe but have life everlastyng.

Heare also what S. Paule saithe.

¶ This is a true saieng, and worthy of all men to be receyved, that Jesus Christ came into the worlde to save synners.

Heare also what S. John saieth.

¶ If any manne sinne, we have an advocate with the father, Jesus Christ the righteous, and he is the propiciation for our sinnes. *¶ After the whiche the priest shall procede saying.*

Lift up your hartes.

Aunswere. We lyfte them up unto the Lorde.

Priest. Let us geve thanckes unto our Lorde God.

Aunswere. It is mete and right so to do.

¶ Priest. It is very mete, right, and our bounden duety that we should at al times, and in all places, geve thanckes to the, O Lord holy father, almighty everlasting God.

Here shall folow the proper prefaces, according to the tyme, yf there be any specially appointed, or els immediatly shal folow:

Therefore with aungelles &c.

¶ PROPER PREFACES.

Upon Christmas day and seven dayes after.

BECAUSE thou dydest geve Jesus Christ, thyne onely Sonne, to be borne as this daye for us, who by the operation of the holy ghoste was made very man of the substaunce of the virgin Mary his mother, and that without spot of synne, to make us clene from al sinne. Therefore with aungels &c.

Upon Easter daye, and vii dayes after.

BUT chiefly are we bounde to praise the for the glorious resurrection of thy sonne Jesus Christ our lord, for he is the very paschal lambe, whiche was offred for us, and hath taken awaye the sinne of the world, who by his death hath destroyed death, and by his rising to life againe, hath restored to us everlasting life. Therefore with aungels

Upon the Ascencion day, and vii dayes after.

THROUGH thy most deare beloved sonne, Jesus Christ our Lorde, who after his moste glorious resurrection, manifestly appered to al his Apostles, and in their sight ascended up into heaven, to prepare a place for us, that where he is, thether might we also ascende, and reigne with him in glory. Therefore with aungels &c.

Upon Wytsonday, and vi daies after.

THROUGH Jesu Christ our Lord, according to whose mooste true promyse, the holye ghoste came downe this daye from heaven, with a soddine greate sounde, as it had bene a mighty wynde, in the lykenes of fiery tonges lyghtinge upon the Apostles, to teache them, and to leade them to all truth, geving them bothe the gyfte of divers languages, and also boldnes with fervent zeale, constantly to preache the gospel unto all nacions, whereby we are broughte out of darcknes and errour into the cleare light and true knowledge of the, and of thy sonne Jesus Christ. Therefore with Aungels &c.

Upon the feaste of Trinitie onely.

IT is very mete right, and our bounden dutie, that we should at all times, and in all places, geve thanks to the, O Lorde, almightie and everlasting God, which art one god, one lord, not one only person, but thre persons in one substaunce, for that whiche we beleve of the glorye of the father, the same we beleve of the sonne, and of the holy ghost, without any difference or inequalitie. Therefore &c.

¶ *After which preface, shall folow immediatly.*

THEREFORE with Aungelles and Archangelles, and wyth all the company of heaven, we laude and magnify thy glorious name, evermore praising thee, and saying: Holy, holy, holy, lord god of hostes, heven and earth are ful of thy glory, glory be to the, O Lord most hyghe.

¶ *Then shall the priest knelynge downe at Gods borde, say in the name of all them that shall receyve the communion, this prayer folowing.*

WE do not presume to come to this thy table (O merciful Lorde) trustinge in oure owne rightuousnesse, but in thy manifolde and greate mercies, we be not worthy so muche as to gather up the crommes under thy Table, but thou arte the same Lord, whose property is alwaies to have mercy. Graunt us therefore gracious Lorde, so to eate the fleshe of thy deare sonne Jesus Christ, and to drinke his bloude, that oure synful bodies may be made cleane by his body, and our soules washed through his most precious bloud, and that we may evermore dwell in him, and he in us.

Then the priest standing up, shal say as foloweth:

ALMIGHTY God our heavenly father whiche of thy tender rnercye, diddest give thine onely Sonne Jesus Christ, to suffer death upon the Crosse for our redemption, who made ther (by his one

oblation of himself once offered) a ful, perfect and sufficient sacrifice, oblation, and satisfaction for the synnes of the whole worlde, and didde institute, and in his holy gospel commaunde us to continue a perpetual memory of that his precious deathe, untill his comminge againe: Heare us O merciful father, we besech the, and graunt that we receivng these thy creatures of breade and wine, accordinge to thy sonne our saviour Jesu Christes holy institution, in remembraunce of his death and passion, may be partakers of his moste blessed body and bloude, who in the same night that he was betraied, toke bread, and when he had geven thanks, he brake it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take, eate, this is my bodie, which is geven for you. Doe this in remembraunce of me. Likewise after supper he toke the cuppe, and when he had geven thanks, he gave it to them, saying: Drinke ye all of this, for this is my bloude of the new Testament, whiche is shedde for you and for many, for remission of sinnes: doe this as oft as ye shall drinke it in remembraunce of me.

¶ Then shall the minister fyrste receyve the Communion in bothe kyndes him selfe, and next deliver it to other Ministers (yf any be there present, that they may helpe the chief minister) and after to the people in their handes kneeling. And when he delivereth the breade, he shall saye.

THE bodie of our lord Jesu Christ, which was geven for the, preserve thy body and soule into everlastinge life: and take and eate this in remembraunce that Christ died for thee, feede on him in thine heart by faith, with thanksgevyng.

And the minister that delivereth the cuppe shall saye.

THE bloude of our lorde Jesu Christ, which was shedd for the, preserve thy body and soule into everlasting life: and drinke this in remembraunce that Christes bloude was shedde for thee, and be thankful.

Then shall the priest say the Lordes prayer, the people repetyng after him every petition.

Page showing the words of administration, from an edition printed in 1559. Clicking on the image will bring up a larger, readable image.

¶ After shalbe sayde as foloweth.

O LORDE and heavenly father, we thy humble servaunts, entierly desire thy fatherly goodnes mercifully to accept this our Sacrifice of praise and thanksgeving moste humblye besechyng thee to graunte, that by the merites and death of thy sonne Jesus Christ, and throughe faith in his bloude, we (and all thy whole church,) may obtaine remission of our sinnes, and al other benefites of his passion. And here we offer and presente unto the, O Lord, our selves, our soules, and bodies, to be a reasonable, holy, and lively sacrifice unto the, humblye beseching the, that al we which be partakers of this holye communion, may be fulfilled with thy grace, and heavenly benediction. And although we be unworthy through our manifold sinnes, to offer unto the any sacrifice, yet we beseeche the to accept this our bounden duty and service, not weighing our merites, but pardoning our offences, through Jesus Christ our Lord, by whom and with whom, in the unitie of the holy ghoste, all honour and glorye be unto the, O father almighty, world without ende. Amen.

Or this,

ALMIGHTY and everlastinge God, we moste hartely thancke the, for that thou doest vouchsafe to fede us, whiche have duly received these holy misteries, with the spiritual fode of the moste precious body and bloude of thy sonne, our saviour Jesus Christ, and doest assure us therby of thy favour and goodnes towarde us, and that we be very membres incorporate in thy mystical body, whiche is the blessed company of al faithful people, and be also heyres through hope of thy everlasting kingdom, by the merites of the most precious death and passion of thy deare sone. We now most humbly beseeche the, O hevenly father, so to assist us with thy grace, that we may continue in that holy felowship, and do all suche good workes as thou hast prepared for us to

walke in, throughe Jesus Christe our Lord; to whom with the and the holy ghost be all honour and glory, world without ende. Amen.

Then shalbe sayde or songe.

GLORYE be to God on hyghe. And in earthe peace, good wyll towards men. We prayse thee, we blesse thee, we worshyppe thee, we glorifye thee, wee geve thanckes to thee, for thy greate glorye. O Lorde God, heavenly Kynge, God the father Almightye. O Lorde the onely begotten Sonne Jesu Christ. O Lord God, Lambe of God, Sonne of the father, that takest awaye the sinnes of the worlde, have mercye upon us: Thou that takest awaye the Sinnes of the worlde, have mercy upon us. Thou that takest away the synnes of the worlde, receive our praier. Thou that syttest at the right hande of God the Father, have mercy upon us. For thou onely art holy: Thou only art the Lorde, thou only O Christe with the holy Ghost, art most highe in the Glory of God the father. Amen.

Then the Priest or the Byshop, if he be present, shal let them depart with this blessing.

THE peace of God, which passeth all understanding, kepe youre hartes, and mindes in the knowlege and love of God, and of his Sonne Jesu Christe, oure Lorde. And the blessing of God almyghty, the Father, the Sonne, and the holy Ghost, be among you, and remayne with you alwaies. Amen.

¶ *Collectes to be sayd after thofertory when there is no Communion; every suche daye one. And thesame maye be sayde also as often as occasion shall serve, after the Collectes, either of Morning and Evening Praier, Communion, or Letany, by the discretion of the minister.*

ASSISTus mercifully, O Lorde, in these our Supplications and Praiers, and dispose the way of thy servauntes towarde the attaynement of everlasting salvation, that emong al the chaunges, and chaunces of this mortal lyfe, thei may ever be defeded by thy moste gracious, and redy helpe. Through Christ our Lorde. Amen.

O ALMIGHTYLorde and everlivyng God, vouchesafe we beseche the, to direct, sanctifie, and governe bothe oure hartes, and bodies, in the wayes of thy lawes, and in the worckes of thy commaundementes, that through thy most mighty protection, both here and ever, we maye bee preserved in bodye and Soule: throughe oure lorde and Savioure Jesus Christe. Amen.

GRAUNT we beseche the almighty God, that the wordes which we have herd this daye with our outward eares, may through thi grace be so graffed [grafted] inwardly in our hartes, that they may bring furth in us the fruite of good living, to the honour and praise of thy name: throughe Jesus Christ our Lorde. Amen.

PREVENTE[Direct] us O Lorde in all our doynges, with thy most gracious favoure, and further us with thy continuall helpe, that in al our workes begonne, continued, and ended in the: we may glorify thy holy name, and finally by thy mercy, obtaine everlasting lyfe, Through Jesus Christ our Lorde. Amen.

ALMIGHTYGod, the founteine of all wisdom, which knowest oure necessities before we aske, and our ignoraunce in asking, we beseche the to have compassion upon our infirmities, and those thinges which for our unworthiness we dare not, and for oure blindenes we cannot aske, vouchesafe to geve us for the worthines of thy sonne Jesus Christe our Lorde. Amen.

ALMIGHTYGod, whiche haste promysed to here the petitions of them that aske in thy sonnes name, we beseche the mercifully to encline thine Eares to us that have made nowe nowe our praiers and supplications unto the, and graunt that those thinges which we have faithfully asked, according to thy wil, may effectually be obtained to the relief of our necessitie, and to the setting furth of thy glory through Jesus Christ our Lorde. Amen.

¶ Upon thle holy dales (jf there be no Communion,) shalbe said at that is appointed at the Communion, untill the ende of the homely, concluding with the generall praier, far the whole estate of Christes Church militant here in earth, and one, or moe of these Collectes before rehersed, as occasian shall serve.¶ And there shalbe no celebration of the lordes supper except there be a good number to Communicate wyth the Priest, accordinge to his dyscretion.¶ And yf there be not above xx persons in the Parish of discretion to receyve the Communion, yet there shalbe no communion except foure or thre at the least communicate with the priest And in Cathedral and collegiate churches, where be many Priestes and Deacons, they shall all receyve the communion with the minister every Sondag at the leaste, except they have a reasonable cause to the contrary.¶ And to take awaye the superstition, whiche any person hath, or myghte have in the breade and wyne, it shall suffice that the breade be suche as is usual to be eaten at the table, with other meates, but the beste and purest wheate breade, that conveniently may be gotten. And yf anye of the breade or wyne remaine, the Curate shall have it to hys owne use.¶ The bread and wyne for the Communion shalbe provided by the Curate, and the church wardeines, at the charges of the Paryshe, and the paryshe shalbe discharged of suche summes of money, or other duties, which hitherto they have payed far the same by order of their houses every Sondag.¶ And note that every Parishioner shall communicate, at the leaste thre tymes in the yere, of whiche Easter to be one: and shall also receyve the sacramentes, and other rytes, accordinge to the order in this boke appoincted. And yerely at Easter, every Parishioner shall recon with his Person [Parson], Vicar or Curate, or his, or their deputie or deputies, and paye to them or hym, all ecclesiastical duties, accustomedly due then and at that tyme to be payed.

Return to the 1559 Book of Common Prayer

The Ministration of Baptism

The Book of Common Prayer - 1559

¶ THE MINISTRACION OF BAPTISME TO BE USED IN THE CHURCHE.

It appeareth by auncient writers, that the Sacrament of Baptisme in the old old tyme, was not commonly Ministred, but at two times in the yeare, at Easter and Whytson tide, at which tymes it was openly ministred in the presence of al the congregacion: which custome (now being growen out of use,) although it can not for many consideracions bee well restored agayne, yet it is thought good to folow the same as nere as conveniently may be. Wherefore the people are to be admonished, that it is most convenient that Baptisme should not be ministred but upon Sondag, and other holy dayes, when the most nombre of people may come together, aswel for that the congregacion there present maye testifie the receyving of them that be newly Baptized into the nombre of Christes Church, as also because in the Baptisme of Infants everye man present may be put in remembraunce of his awne profession made to God in hys Baptisme. For which cause also, it is expedient that Baptisme be ministred in the English tongue. Nevertheles (if necessitie so require) children may at al tymes be Baptized at home.

¶ When there are children to be baptized upon the Sondag, or holy day, the parentes shal geve knowledge over nighte, or in the morning, afore the beginning of Mornyng prayour, to the curate. And then the Godfathers, Godmothers, and people with the children, must be ready at the Fonte, eyther immediatly after the last Lesson at Morning Prayour, or els immediatly after the last Lesson at Evening Praiour, as the Curate by his discretion shall appoincte. And then standinge there, the Priest shall ask whether the children be Baptized or no. If they aunswer, No. Then the priest say thus.

DERELYbeloved, forasmuche as al men be conceived and borne in synne, and that our saviour Christ saith, none can entre into the kingdom of God (except he be regenerate, and borne a new of water and the holy gost) I beseche you to cal upon God the father, throughe our lord Jesus Christ, that of his bounteous mercy, he wil graunt to these children, that thing which by nature thei can not have, that they may be baptized with water and the holy Ghost, and received into Christes holy church; and be made lively membres of the same.

Then the Priest shall say.

Let us praye.

ALMIGHTIEand everlasting God, whiche of thy great mercy diddest save Noe and his familie in the Arcke, from perishing by water, and also diddest sauflly lead the children of Israel, thy people, through the redde Sea, figuring therby thy holy Baptisme: and by the Baptisme of thy welbeloved sonne Jesus Christe, diddest sanctifye the floude Jordane, and al other waters, to the mistical washinge away of synne: We beseche the (for thine infinite mercies) that thou wilt mercifully loke upon these children, sanctify them and washe them with thy* holy gost, that they beyng delivered from thy wrath, may be received into the Arcke of Christes church, and beyng stedfast in faithe, joyfull throughe hope, and roted in charitie, may so passe the waves of this troublesome world, that finally they may come to the lande of everlasting life, there to reigne with the, worlde without ende, through Jesus Christ our Lorde. Amen.

* "the" in 1604.

ALMIGHTY and immortal God, the aide of al that nede, the helper of al that fly to the for succour, the life of them that beleve, and the resurrection of the deade, we cal upon the for these infantes, that they, comming to thy holy Baptisme, may receyve remission of their sinnes by spiritual regeneracion, receive them (O Lorde) as thou haste promised by thy welbeloved sonne, saynge: Aske and you shall have; seke, and you shall fynde: knocke and it shalbe opened unto you: So geve now unto us that aske. Let us that seeke, fynde open thy gate unto us that knocke, that these infantes enjoy the everlasting benediction of thy heavenly wassing, and may come to the eternal kingdome whiche thou haste promised by Christ our Lorde. Amen.

¶ *Then shall the Priest saye*

Heare the words of the Gospel, written by Sainct Marke in the tenth Chapter.

AT a certayne tyme they brought children to Christ that he should touche them, and his Disciples rebuked those that brought them. But when Jesus sawe it, he was displeased, and sayde unto them. Suifre lytle children to come unto me, and forbydde them not; For to suche belongeth the Kyngdome of God. Verely, I saye unto you; whosoever doeth not receive the kingdome of God, as a lytle chylde: he shall not entre therin. And when he had taken the up in his armes: he put his handes upon them, and blessed them.

¶ *After the Gospel is redde, the minister shal make this briefe exhortacion upon the wordes of the Gospell.*

FRENDES, ye heare in this Gospell the woordes of our saviour Christe, that he commaunded the chyl dren to bee broughte unto him: howe he blamed those that woulde have kepte theym from hym, how he exhorted all men to folowe their innocencye. Ye perceive how by his outward gesture and dede he declared his good wil towarde them. For he embraced them in his armes, he laied his hands upon them, and blessed them, doubt not you therfore, but earnestly beleve that he wil likewise favourably receive these present infants, that he wil embrace the with the armes of his mercy, that he wil geve unto them the blessing of eternal life: and make them partakers of his everlasting kingdome. Wherefore we being thus perswaded of the good wyl of our heavenly father, towardes these enfantes declared by his son Jesus Christ, and nothing doubting, but that he

favourably alloweth this charitable worke of ours, in bringing these children to his holye Baptisme: let us faithfully and devoutly geve thakes unto him, and saye

ALMIGHTY and everlasting God, heavenly Father, we geve thee humble thanks, that thou haste vouchesaufe to call us to the knowledge of thy grace and fayth in the, encrease this knowledge, and confirme this faith in us evermore: Geve thy holy spirit to these enfantes, that they may be borne againe, and be made heyres of everlasting salvacion, throughe our Lorde Jesus Christ. who liveth and reigneth with the, and the holy spirite, nowe and for ever. Amen.

Then the Priest shal speake unto the Godfathers and Godmothers, on this wyse:

WELBELOVED frendes, ye have broughte these children here to be baptised, ye have praied that our lord Jesus christ, would vouchesaufe to receive them, to lay his handes upon them, to blesse them, to release them of their sinnes, to geve them the kingdom of heaven, and everlasting lyfe. Ye have heard also that our Lord Jesus Christ hath promised in his Gospel, to graunt all these thinges that ye have praied for: which promise he for his part wil most surely kepe and performe. Wherefore after this promise made by Christ, these infants muste also faythfully for their part promise by you that be their sureties, that they wil forsake the divil and al his woorkes, and constantly beleve Gods holy word, and obediently kepe his commaundements.

Then shal the Priest demaunde of the Godfathers and Godmothers thes questions.

DOEST thou forsake the devil and all his workes, the vaine pompe and glorye of the world, with al covetous desires of the same, and the carnal desires of the flesh, so that thou wilt not folow, nor be led by them? *Aunsweare.* I forsake them al.

The Minister. Doest thou beleve in god the father almighty, maker of heave and earth? And in Jesus christ his only begotten sonne our Lord, and that he was conceived by the holy Ghost, borne of the virgin Mary: that he suifred under Poncius Pilate, was crucifyed, dead and buried, that he went doune into hel, and also did rise againe the thirde day: that he ascended into heaven, and sitteth at the right had of god the father almighty; and from thence shall come againe at the ende of the worlde, to judge the quicke and the dead? And doest thou beleve in the holy Ghoste the holy Catholicque Church, the communion of saintes, the remission of synnes, the resurreccion of the fleshe, and everlasting lyfe after death?

Aunsweare. All this I stedfastly beleve.

Ministre. Wylt thou be baptised in this fayth?

Aunsweare. That is my desyre.

Marke x.

¶ *Then shal the Priest say.*

O MERCIFUL God, graunte that the olde Adam in these children maye be so buried, that the newe man may be raysed up in them. Amen.

Graunte that all carnal affeccions maye dye in them, and that all thinges belonginge to the spirite may live and growe in them. Amen.

Graunte that they may have power and strength to have victory, and to triumphe against the Divil, the worlde, and the flesh. Amen.

Graunt that whosoever is here dedicated to thee, by our office and ministerie, may also be endued with heavenly vertues, and everlastingly rewarded through thy mercy, O blessed Lord God, who doest live and govern al thinges worlde without ende. Amen.

ALMIGHTY everliving God, whose most derely beloved son Jesus Christe, for the forgevenes of our sinnes, did shed out his moste precious syde bothe water and bloude, and gave commaundement to his disciples that they should go teache al nacions, and baptise them in the name of

the father, the sonne, and of the holy Ghost : Regard, we beseche the, the supplications of thy congregacion, and graunt that al thy servantes whiche shalbe baptised in this water, may receve the fulnes of thy grace, and ever remaine in the nombre of thy faithful and elect chyldren, through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

Then the Priest shal take the Childe in his handes, and aske the name; and naming the Childe, shal dippe it in the water, so it be discretely and warely done, saying,

N. I Baptise the in the name of the Father, and of the Sonne, and of the holy Ghost. Amen.

¶ *And yf the Ghilde be weake, it shall suffice to powre water upon it, saying the foresaid wordes.*

N. I Baptize the in the name of the Father, and of the sonne, and of the holy Ghost. Amen.

Then the Priest shall make a Crosse upon the Childes forehead, saying:

WE receive this Childe into the congregacion of Christes flocke, and do sygne him with the signe of the crosse, in token that hereafter he shal not be ashamed to confesse the faith of Christ crucified, and manfully to fight under his banner against sinne, the worlde, and the devyll, and to continue Christes faithful souldiour and servaunt unto his lives ende. Amen.

Then shal the Priest say,

SEYINGnow, derely beloved brethren that these children be regenerate and graffed [grafted] into the bodye of Christes congregacion, let us geve thanks unto God for these benefites, and with one accorde make our praiours unto almighty God, that thei may lead the reste of their lyfe according to this beginning.

Then shal be sayd.

Our Father which art &c.

Then shal the Priest say,

We yelde the harty thanks most merciful father, that it hathe pleased thee to regenerate this enfant with thy holy spirite, to receyve him for thine owne childe by adoption, and to incorporate him into thy holy congregacion. And humbly we beseche thee to graunt that he being dead unto sinne and lyving unto righteousnes, and being buried with Christ in his death, maye crucify the old man, and utterly abolyshe the whole bodye of synne, that as he is made partaker of the deathe of thy sonne, so he maye be partaker of hys resurreccion, so that finally with the residue of thy holy congregacion, he may be inheritour of thine everlasting kingdome. Through Christ our Lord. Amen.

¶ *At the laste ende, the Priest calling the Godfathers and Godmothers together, shal say this shorte exhortation folowing.*

FORASMUCHEas these children have promysed by you to forsake the Devil and his woorkes, to beleve in God, and to serve hym, you must remember that it is your parts and duties to see that these enfantes be taughte, so sone as they shalbe able to learne, what a solempne vowe, promyse, and profession they have made by you. And that they may know these thinges the better; ye shal cal upon them to heare Sermons, And chiefly you shal provide that they may learne the Crede, the Lordes praier, and the Ten Commaundementes in the English tongue; and al other thinges which a Christian man ought to know and beleve to his soules health. And that these children may be vertuously brought up, to leade a Godly and a christian life, remembring alwaies that Baptisme doeth represent unto us our profession, which is to folow the example of our saviour Christ, and to be made like unto hym, that as he died and rose again for us: so should we (whiche are Baptised) dye from sinne, and ryse again unto rightuousnes, continually mortifiyng al our evyll and corrupt affections, and dailye procedyng in all vertue and godlynes of living.

¶ *The Minister shal commaunde that the chyldren be brought to the Byshop to be confirmed of him,*

so sone as they can saye in theyr vulgare tongue the articles of the faythe, the Lordes praier, and the x. Commaundementes, and be further instructed in the Catechisme set furth for that purpose, accordyngly as it is there expressed.

OF THEM THAT BE BAPTISED IN PRIVATE HOUSES,
IN TYME OF NECESSITIE.

[BY THE LAWFUL MINISTER OF THE PARISH, OR ANY OTHER LAWFUL MINISTER, THAT CAN BE PROCURED.]*

* Added in 1604.

¶ *The Pastours and Curates shal oft admonish the people, that they deferre not the Baptisme of enfantes any longer then the Sonday, or other holy day, next after the childe be borne unlesse upon a great and reasonable cause declared to the Curate, and by him approved.*

1559:

And also they shal warne theim that without great cause, and necessity, they baptize not children at home in their houses. And when great nede shall compelle theim so to doe, that then they minister on this fassion. Fyrste let theim that be present cal upon God for hys grace, and say the Lordes prayour, yf the time wil sufre. And then one of them shall name the childe, and dippe him in the water, or powre water upon him, saying these wordes.

1604:

And also they shall warne them, that without great cause and necessity, they procure not their children to be baptized at home in their houses. And when great need shall compel them so to do, that then Baptisme shall be administered in this fashion. First, let the lawfull Minister, and them that be present, call upon God for his grace and say the Lord's Prayer, if the time will suffer. And then the childe being named by some one that is present, the said lawfull Minister shall dip it in water, or poure water upon it, saying these words.

N.I Baptise the in the name of the Father, and of the Sonne, and of the holy Ghoste. Amen.

And let them not doubt, but that the childe so Baptised, is lawfully and sufficiently Baptised, and ought not to be Baptised agayne in the Church. But yet neverthles, if the child whyche is after this sorte Baptised, do afterwarde live, it is expediente that he be broughte into the Churche, to the entent the Priest may examyne and trie, whether the child be lawfully Baptised or no. And yf those that bryng any childe to the Churche do answere that he is already Baptised: then shal the Priest examine them further.

N.I Baptise thee in the Name of the Father, and of the Sonne, and of the holy Ghost. Amen.

And let them not doubt, but that the childe so Baptised, is lawfully and sufficiently Baptised, and ought not to be Baptised agayne in the Church. But yet neverthles, if the child whyche is after this sorte Baptised, do afterwarde live, it is expediente that he be broughte into the Churche, to the entent that if the Priest or Minister of the same Parish did himself baptize that childe, the Congregation may be certified of the true forme of Baptisme, by him privately before used: Or if the child were baptized by any other lawfull Minister, that then the Minister of the Parish where the childe was borne or Christened, shall examine and trie whether this childe be lawfully baptized, or no. In which case, if those that bring any childe to the Church, do answer that the same child is already baptized, then shall the Minister examine them further, saying,

¶ By whome the childe was Baptised?

¶ Who was present when the childe was Baptised?

¶ Whether they called upon God for grace and succour in that necessitie?

¶ Wyth what thing, or what matter they did Baptise the Chylde?

¶ Wyth what wordes the childe was Baptised?

¶ Whether they thinke the childe to be lawfully and perfectly Baptised?

¶ By whom the childe was baptized?

¶ Who was present when the childe was baptized?

¶ And because some things essentiall to this Sacrament may happen to be omitted through fear or haste in such times of extremitie; therefore I demand further of you,

¶ With what matter was the childe baptized?

¶ With what words was the childe baptized?

¶ Whether think you the childe to bee lawfully and perfectly baptized?

¶ *And yf the Minister shall prove* by the aunswers of suche, as brought* the childe, that all thinges were done as they oughte to be: Then shal not he Christen the childe againe, but shall receyve him, as one of the flocke of the true Christian people, saynge thus.*

I CERTIFY you, that in this case ye have done wel*, and according unto due ordre concerning the Baptising of this childe, whiche beyng borne in Originall sinne and in the wrathe of God, is nowe by the laver [=water] of regeneration in Baptisme, received into the number of the children of God, and heires of everlasting life, for our Lorde Jesus Christ doeth not deny his grace and mercy unto such infantes, but most lovingly doth cal the unto him: as the holy gospel doth witnes to our comfort on this wise.

* "finde" and "bring" in 1604.

* "all is well done" in 1604.

AT a certaine time they brought children unto Christ that he should touche them, and his dysciples rebuked those that brought them. But when Jesus saw it, he was displeased, and said unto them: Suffre litle children to come unto me, and forbid them not, for to such belongeth the kingdome of God. Verely I say unto you, whosoever doth not receive the kingdom of God as a litle child, he shal not entre therin. And when he had taken them up in his armes, he put his handes upon them, and blessed them.

¶ *After the Gospel is redde, the minister shal make this exhortacion upon the wordes of the Gospel.*

FRENDES, ye heare in this Gospell the wordes of oure saviour Christe, that he commaunded the chyldren to bee brought unto hym: howe he blamed those that woulde have kepte theym from him, howe he exhorted all men to folowe their innocencye: Ye perceive how by his outward gesture in dede he declared his good wil toward them. For he embraced them in his armes, he laied his hands upon them, and blessed them, doubt not you therefore, but earnestly beleve, that he hath likewise fauourably received this present infant, that he hath embraced hym wyth the armes of hys mercy, that he hath geuen unto him the blessing of eternal life, and made him partaker of his everlasting kingdom. Wherefore we beyng thus perswaded of the good wil of our heeuenly father declared by his sonne Jesus Christ towards this infant, Let us faithfully and devoutly geve thanks unto him, and say the praier, which the lord him self taught, and in declaracion of our faith, let us recite the articles contained in our Crede.

¶ *Here the Minister with the Godfathers, and Godmothers shall say.*

OUR Father which &c.

¶ *Then the Priest shal demand the name of the child, which beyng by the Godfathers, and Godmothers pronounced, the Minister shall say,*

¶ DOEST thou in the name of this child forsake the devil, and al his workes, the vaine pompe, and glory of the world, with al the covetous desires of the same, the carnal desires of the fleshe, and not to folowe and be ledde by them?

Aunswere. I forsake them al.

¶ *The Minister.* Doest thou in the name of this childe professe this faith, to beleve in God the father almighty, maker of heaven and earth And in Jesus Christ his only begotten son our Lord, and

that he was conceived by the holy ghost, borne of the virgin Mary: that he suffered under ponce Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried, that he wet doune into hel, and also did rise again the iii daye: that he ascended into heaven, and sytteth at the ryght hande of God the father almighty: and from thence he shal come again at the ende of the world, to judge the quicke and the dead? And do you in his name beleve in the holy gost the holy Catholique church, the communion of saintes, the remission of sinnes, resurreccion of the fleshe, and everlasting life after death?

Aunswere. All this I steadfastly beleve.

Let us pray.

ALMIGHTY and everlasting God, heavenly father, we geve thee humble thanckes, for that thou hast vouchsafed to call us to the knowledge of thy grace and faythe in thee: increase this knowledge, and confyrme this faythe in us evermore: Geve thy holye spirite to this infante, that he beyng borne agayne and beyng made heyre of everlastynge salvacion, through our Lord Jesus Christ, may continue thy servant, and atteine thy promise, through the same our Lorde Jesus Christ thy sonne, who liveth and reigneth with the in the unitie of the same holy spirit everlasting. Amen.

Then shal the Minister make this exhortacion, to the Godfathers and Godmothers.

FORASMUCHE as this childe hath promised by you to forsake the devil and al his workes, to beleve in God, and to serve him: you must remembre that it is your part and dutie, to see that this enfante be taught (so sone as he shalbe able to learne) what a solempne vowe promise, and profession he hath made by you. And that he may know these thinges the better, ye shal call upon him to hear sermons. And chiefly ye shal provide that he may learne the Crede, the Lordes praier and the x Commaundementes in the English tongue, and al other thinges which a Christian man ought to know, and beleve to his soules health, and that this chyld may be vertuously brought up, to leade a godly, and a christian lyfe. Remembring alway that Baptisme doeth represent unto us our profession, which is to folow the example of our Saviour Christ, and be made like unto him, that as he died and rose againe for us, so shoulde we which are Baptized, dye from sinne, and rise againe unto righteousnes, continually mortifying all our evil and corrupt affections, and daily proceding in al vertue, and godlines of living, etc:

¶ *As in Publique Baptisme.*

¶ *But if they which bring the enfantes to the Church, do make an uncerteine aunswere* to the Priestes questions, and say that they cannot tel what they thought, didde, or said, in yt great feare, and trouble of minde: (as ofte times it chaunseth) then let the Priest Baptise him in forme above written, concerning publique Baptisme, saving that at the dipping of the chylde in the Fonte, he shal use this forme af wordes.*

If thou be not Baptized al ready, N. I baptise the in the name of the father, and of the Sonne, and of the holy Ghoste. Amen. Marke x.

* "such uncerteine answers" in 1604.

Return to the 1559 Book of Common Prayer

Confirmation, with the Catechism

The Book of Common Prayer - 1559

¶ CONFIRMACION,

WHEREIN IS CONTAINED A CATECHISME FOR CHILDREN.

1559 Title

The Order of Confirmation, or laying
on of hands upon children baptised, and able
to render an account of their Faith, according
to the Catechisme following.

1604 Title

TO thende that confirmacion may be ministred to the more edifying of suche, as shal receive it (according unto S. Paules doctrine, who teacheth that al things should he doen in ye Church, to the edification of the same) it is thought good that none hereafter shalbe confyrmed but suche as can saie in their mother tongue the articles of the faith, the Lordes praier, and the x Commaundementes: And can also answeere to suche questions of this short Catechisme, as the Bishop (or suche as he shal appoinct) shal by hys discretion appose[=examine]theim in. And this order is most convenient to be observed for divers consideracions.

First, because that when children come to the yeres of discrecion, and have learned what their godfathers and godmothers promised for them in Baptisme, they may then themselves wyth their owne mouthe, and wyth their awne consent, openly before the Churche, ratifie and confyrme the same, and also promise that by the grace of God, they shall evermore endeavour themselves faithfully to observe and kepe suche thynges, as they by theyr owne mouth and confession have assented unto.

Secondly, forasmuche as Confirmacion is ministred to theym that be Baptised, that by imposition of handes and prayer, they may receive strengthe and defence agaynst all temptacions to synne, and the assaults of the worlde and the Devill: it is most mete to be ministred when children come to that age, that partely by the frailtye of their awne fleshe, partely by the assaults of the worlde and the Devil, thei begyn to be in daunger to fal into sondry kyndes of synne.

Thirdly, for that it is agreable wyth the usage of the Churche, in times paste, wherby it was ordeined that Confirmacion shoulde he ministred to them that were of perfecte[=proper, appropriate]age, that they, beyng instructed in Christes religion, should openly professe their awne faithe, and promise to be obedient unto the wyl of God.

And that no man shal thyncke that any detryment shall come to children by diferring [deferring]of their Confirmacion; he shal knowe for truth, that it is certeine by Goddes worde, that children beyng baptised, have all thynges necessarie for their salvacion, and be undoubtedly saved.

A CATECHISME,

THAT IS TO SAY,

AN INSTRUCTION TO BE LEARNED OF EVERY CHILDE BEFORE HE BE BROUGHT TO BE
CONFIRMED OF THE BISHOPPE.

Question. WHAT is your name?

Aunsweere. N.or M. *Question.* Who gave you this name?

Aunsweere. My Godfathers and Godmothers in my Baptisme, wherein I was made a membre of Christe, the childe of God, and an inheritour of the kingdome of heaven.

Question. What did your godfathers and godmothers then for you?

Aunsweere. They did promise, and vowe iii thinges in my name. First, that I should forsake the devil, and all his [workes and pompes, the]* vanities of the wicked worlde, and al the sinful lustes of the fleshe. Secondly, that I should beleve al the articles of the Christian faith. And thirdely, that I should kepe Goddes holy wil and Commaundemetes, and walke in the same al the daies of my lyfe.

* “workes, the pompes and” in 1604.

Question. Doest thou not thynke that thou art bounde to beleve and to do, as they have promised for the?

Answer. Yes verely, and by Goddes helpe so I wil. And I hartely thanke our heavenly Father, that he hath called me to this state of salvation, through Jesus Christe our saviour. And I pray God to geve me his grace, that I may continue in the same unto my lyves ende.

Question. Reherse the Articles of thy belefe.

Aunswere. I beleve in God the Father almighty, maker of heaven and of earth. And in Jesus Christe his onely Sonne our Lorde. Whiche was conceived of the holy Ghost. Borne of the Virgine Mary. Suffered under Ponce Pylate, was crucifyed, deade and buried, he descended into hell. The thyrd day he rose agayne from the dead. He ascended into heven, and sitteth at the right hand of God the Father almighty. From thence he shal come to judge the quicke and the dead. I beleve in the Holy ghost. The holy catholike Churche. The Communion of saynctes. The forgiveness of synnes. The resurrection of the body. And the lyfe everlastinge. Amen.

Question. What doest thou chiefly learne in these artycles of thy beliefe?

Aunswere. Firste, I learne to beleve in God the father, who hath made me and al the worlde.

Secondlye, in God the sonne, who hath redemed me and all mankinde.

Thirdly, in God the holy Ghost, who sanctifieth me and all the elect people of God.

Question. You said, that your godfathers and godmothers, dyd promise for you, that you shoulde kepe Gods commaundementes. Tell me how many there be?

Aunswere. Tenne.

Question. Whiche be they?

Aunswere. The same which God spake in the .xx. cha of Exodus, saying: I am the Lord thy God whyche have brought the out of the land of Egypt, oute of the house of bondage. Thou shalt have none other goddes but me.

II. Thou shalt not make to thy selfe any graven Image nor the lykenes of any thyng that is in heaven above, or in the earthe beneth, nor in the water under the earthe: thou shalt not bow doune to them nor worship them. For I the Lorde thy God, am a gelous God, and visyte the sinnes of the fathers upon the chyl dren, unto the iiii and fourth generacion of them that hate me, and shewe mercye unto thousandes of them that love me, and kepe my commaundementes.

III. Thou shalt not take the name of the Lord thy God in vaine, for the Lorde will not holde hym guiltles that taketh his name in vaine.

IIII. Remember thou kepe holy the Sabboth day. Syxe daies shalt thou laboure, and do all that thou hast to do: but the vii day is the Sabboth of the Lord thy God. In it thou shalt do no maner of worcke, thou, and thy sonne, and thy daughter, thy man servaunt, and thy maydservaunt, thy cattel, and the straunger that is wythin thy gates: for in sixe daies the Lord made heaven and earth, the sea, and al that in them is, and rested the vii day, wherfore the Lorde blessed the vii day, and halowed it.

V. Honour thy father and thy mother, that thy daies may be long in the lande, whiche the Lorde thy God geveth the.

VI. Thou shalt do no murther.

VII. Thou shalt not committe adultery.

VIII. Thou shalt not steale.

IX. Thou shalt not beare false wytnes agaynste thy neighbour.

X. Thou shalt not covet thy neyghbours house, thou shalt not covet thy neyghboures wyfe, nor hys servaunt, nor hys mayde, nor hys oxe nor hys asse, nor any thyng that is hys.

Question. What doest thou chiefly learne by these commandementes?

Aunsware. I learne two thynges. My duty towardes God, and my duty towardes my neighbour.

Question. What is my duety towardes God?

Aunsware. My duty towardes God is, to beleve in him, to feare him [=to hold him in awe], and to love hym with all my harte, with al my mynde, with al my soule, and with all my strengthe. To worship hym. To geve hym thanckes. To putte my whole truste in hyrn. To call upon hym. To honour hys holy name and hys woorde, and to serve hym truely all the dayes of my lyfe.

Question. What is thy duty toward thy neighbour?

Aunsware. My duty towardes my neyghbour is to love hym as my selfe: And to do to all men as I would they should do unto me. To love, honour, and succour my father and mother. To honour and obey the Kyng, and his minysters. To submitte my selfe to al my governours, teachers, spiritual Pastours and Maisters. To order my selfe lowly and reverently to all my betters. To hurte no body by worde, nor dede. To be true and juste in all my dealyng. To beare no malice nor hatred in my harte. To kepe my handes from pickyng and stealyng, and my tongue from evil speakyng, liyng and slaundryng. To kepe my body in temperaunce, sobernes, and chastitie. Not to covet nor desire other mennes goodes. But learne and labour truely to get myne awne livyng, and to do my duty in that state of life, unto whiche it shal please God to cal me.

Question. My good child know this, that thou art not able to do these thinges of thy self, nor to walke in the commaundementes of God, and to serve hym, wythout hys specyall grace, whyche thou must learne at al tymes to cal for by diligent prayer. Let me heare therefore, if thou canst saye the Lordes praier.

Aunsware. Our Father whiche art in heaven; Hallowed be thy name. Thy kyngdom come. Thy wil be done in earth, as it is in heaven. Geve us this day our daily bread. And forgeve us our trespasses, as we forgeve them that trespassed against us. And leade us not into temptacion. But deliver us from evil. Amen.

Question. What desirest thou of God in this praier?

Aunsware. I desire my Lord God our heavenly Father, who is the geve of al goodness, to send his grace unto me, and to all people, that we may worship hym, serve hym, and obeye hym as we ought to doe. And I pray unto God, that he will sende us all thynges that be nedefull, bothe for our soules and bodies. And that he will be merciful unto us, and forgeve us our sinnes: and that it wil please him to save and defende us in al daungers ghostly [=spiritually] and bodily : and that he will kepe us from all synne and wikednes, and from our ghostly enemy, and from everlastyng death. And this I trust he wil do of his mercye and goodnes, throughe our lord Jesu Christ. And therefore I say. Amen. So be it.

Page from the 1604 Book of Common Prayer showing the Catechism with additional questions.

Question. HOW many Sacraments hath Christ ordained in his Church?

Answer. Two onely as generally necessary to salvation; that is to say, Baptisme and the Supper of the Lord.

Question. What meanest thou by this word *Sacrament*?

Answer. I meane an outward and visible signe of an inward and spirituall grace given unto us; ordained by Christ himselve, as a means whereby we receive the same, and a pledge to assure us thereof.

Question. How many parts be there in a Sacrament?

Answer. Two; the outward visible signe, and the inward spirituall grace.

Question. What is the outward visible signe or forme in Baptisme?

Answer. Water: wherein the person baptized is dipped or sprinkled with it, *In the name the Name of the Father, and of Sonne, and of the holy Ghost.*

Question. What is the inward and spirituall grace?

Answer. A death unto sinne, and a new birth unto righteousnesse: for being by nature borne in sinne, and the children of wrath, we are hereby made the children of grace.

Question. What is required of persons to be baptized?

Answer. Repentance, whereby they forsake sinne; and faith, whereby they stedfastly beleieve the promises of God, made to them in that Sacrament.

Question. Why then are Infants baptized, when by reason of their tender age they cannot performe them?

Answer. Yes: they doe performe them by their Sureties; who promise and vow them both, in their names: which when they come to age, themselves are bound to performe.

Question. Why was the Sacrament of the Lords Supper ordained?

Answer. For the continuall remembrance of the Sacrifice of the death of Christ, and the benefits which we receive thereby.

Question. What is the outward part or signe of the Lords Supper?

Answer. Bread and wine, which the Lord hath commanded to bee received.

Question. What is the inward part or thing signified?

Answer. The Body and Blood of Christ, which are verely and indeed taken and received of the faithfull in the Lords Supper.

Question. What are the benefits whereof we are partakers thereby?

Answer. The strengthening and refreshing of our soules by the Body and Blood of Christ, as our bodies are by the Bread and wine.

Question. What is required of those which come to the Lords Supper?

Answer. To examine themselves, whether they repent them truely of their former sinnes, stedfastly purposing to leade a new life; have a lively faith in Gods mercy through Christ, with a thankfull remembrance of his death; and be in charitie with all men.

The following questions & answers were added in 1604

¶ *So sone as the children can saye in theyr mother tongue, the articles of the faith, the Lordes prayer, the .x. commaundementes, and also can aunswere to such questyone of thys shorte Catechisme, as the Bishoppe (or suche as he shall appoint) shal by hys discretyon appose [=examine] them in, then shal they be brought to the Byshop by one that shalbe his godfather or godmother, that every childe may have a witnes of his Confirmacyon.*

¶ *And the Bishoppe shal confirme them on this wise.*

CONFIRMATION. 1559 Title

Confirmation, or laying
on of hands.

1604 Title

OUR helpe is in the name of the Lorde.

Aunswere. Whiche hath made bothe* heaven and earth.

Minister. Blessed is the name of the Lorde.

Aunswere. Hencefurthe worlde without ende.

Minister. Lorde heare our prayer.†

Aunswere. And let our crie come to the.

¶ Let us pray.

ALMIGHTYE and everlivyng God, whyche hast vouchesd saufe to regenerate these thy servauntes by water and the holy Ghost; and hast geven unto them forgevenes of al theyr synnes: strengthen them we beseche the (O Lorde) with the holy Ghoste the comforter, and daiely encrease in them thy manifolde giftes of grace, the spirite of wisdom and understanding: the spirite of counsaile and ghostly strength, the spirite of knowledge and true godlinesse, and fulfyll them (O Lord) with the spirite of thy holy feare. Amen.

¶ *Then the Bishop shal laye hys hande upon every childe severally, saying,*

DEFENDE, O Lorde, this childe with thy heavenly grace that he may continue thine for ever, and daiely encrease in thy holy spirite more and more, untill he come unto thy everlastyng kingdome. Amen.

¶ *Then shal the Bishop saye,*

Let us praie.

ALMIGHTIE everlivyng God, whiche makest us bothe to will, and to do those thynges that be good, and acceptable unto thy Majestie, we make our humble supplications unto the for these children, upon whome (after the example of thy holy Apostles) we have laied our handes, to certifie theim (by thys signe) of thy favour, and gracious goodnes toward them, let thy fatherly hande we beseche the ever be over them, let thy holy spirite ever be with them, and so leade them in the knowledge and obedience of thy worde that in the ende they may obtaine the everlasting lyfe: through our Lorde Jesus Christe, who with the and the holy Ghost liveth and reigneth one God, worlde without ende. Amen.

¶ *Then the Bishop shal blesse the children, thus saying.*

THE blessing of God almighty, the Father, the Sonne, and the Holy ghoste, be upon you, and remayne with you for ever. Amen.

¶ *The Curate of every paryshe, or some other at his appointment, shal diligently upon Sondayes and holy dayes, haulfe an houre before Evenyng prayer, openly in the Churche instruct and examyne so many children of his parish sent unto him, as the time wil serve and as he shal thinke convenient, in some part of this Catechisme.*

¶ *And al fathers, and mothers, maisters, and dames, shal cause theyr children, servauntes, and prentises (whyche have not learned theyr Catechisme) to come to the Churche at the tyme appoynted, and obediently to heare, and he ordred by the Curate, untyll suche time as they have learned all that is here appoynted for theim to learne. And whensoever the Byshop shall geve knowledge for chyldren to be brought afore him to any convenyent place, for their confirmation: then sheal the Curate of every Paryshe eyther bryng or sende in wrytyng the names of all those children of hys Paryshe, whiche can say the Articles of their fayth, the Lordes prayer, and the x Commaundementes, and also how many of them can answeere to thother questions contened in this Catechisme.*

¶ *And there shall none be admitted to the holy communion; until suche tyme as he can saye the Catechisme and be confirmed.*

* 'bothe' removed in 1604.

† 'prayers' in 1604

Return to the 1559 Book of Common Prayer

The Form of Solemnization of Matrimony

The Book of Common Prayer - 1559

THE FOURME OF

SOLEMPNIZACION OF MATRIMONYE.

FIRST, the banes[banns] must be asked thre severall Sondaies or holy daies, in the tyme of service, the people beyng present, after the accustomed maner. And yf the persons that would be maryed dwell in diverse Paryshes, the banes must be asked in both Parishes and the Curate of the one Paryshe shall not solempnize matrimonye betwyxt them, wythout a certyficate of the banes beyng thryse asked, from the Curate of the other Parysh. At the date appoincted for solempnizacyon of Matrimonye, the persones to be maryed shal come into the body of the Church, wyth theyr frendes and neighbours. And there the Pryest shall thus saye.

DEARELY beloved frendes, we are gathered together here in the sight of God, and in the face of his congregacion, to joyne together this man and this woman in holy matrimony, which is an honorable state, instytuted of God in Paradise, in the time of manes innocencie, signiflyng unto us the mistical union that is betwixt Christ and his Church: which holy state Christe adourned and beautified with his presence and firste myracle that he wrought in Cana of Galile, and is commended of saint Paul to be honourable emong all men, and therefore is not to be enterprised, nor taken in hande unadvisedly, lightly or wantonly, to satisfye mennes carnall lustes and appetytes, lyke brute beastes that have no understanding ;but reverently, discretely, advisedly, soberly, and in the feare of God, duely consideryng the causes for the which matrimony was ordeined. One was the procreation of children, to be brought up in the feare and nurtoure of the Lorde, and praise of God. Secondly, it was ordeined for a remedy agaynste sinne and to avoide fornication, that suche persones as have not the gifte of continencie might mary, and kepe themselves undefiled membres of Christes body. Thirdly, for the mutual societie, helpe, and comfort, that the one ought to have of the other, bothe in prosperity and adversitey, into the whiche holy state these two persones present, come nowe to be joyned. Therefore if any man can shewe any just cause, why thei may not lawfully be joyned together let hym now speake, or els hereafter for ever holde his peace. *And also speakyng to the persons that shalbe maryed, he shall saye.*

I REQUIRE and charge you (as you wil aunswere at the dreadful day of judgement, when the secretes of all hartes shalbe disclosed) that if either of you doe knowe any impedymment, why ye may not be lawfully joyned together in Matrimony, that ye confesse it. For be ye well assured, that so many as be coupled together, otherwyse than Goddes worde doeth allowe, are not joyned together by God, neither is their Matrimonye lawfull.

At whyche day of Maryage, if any man do allege and declare any impediment, why they may not be coupled together in matrimony by Gods law, or the lawes of thys realme, and wyll be bound, and sufficient sureties with him to the parties, or els put in a cautyon to the ful value of suche charges, as the persons to be maryed do susteine to prove hys allegation: then the solempnization must be deferred unto suche tyme as the truthe be tried. If no impedymment be alledged, then shall the curate saye unto the man,

N.WILT thou have thys woman to thy wedded wyfe, to lyve together after Goddes ordynaunce in the holye estate of Matrimony? Wylt thou love her, comforte her, honour, and kepe her, in sickenes, and in healthe? And forsakyng al other, kepe the onely to her, so long as you both shall hve?

The man shall aunswere,

I will.

Then shall the Priest saye to the woman,

N.WILT thou have this man to thy wedded housband, to lyve together after Goddes ordynaunce in the holy estate of matrimony? wilt thou obey hym and serve him, love, honour, and kepe him, in sycknes and in health? And forsakyng al other, kepe the onely to him so long as ye bothe shal live

The woman shall aunswere,

I will.

Then shall the Minister saie,

Who geveth this woman to be married unto this man?

¶ *And the Minister receivynge the woman at her father or frendes handes, shall cause the man to take the woman by the right hand, and so either to geve their trouth to other, the man first saying.*

I N.take the. N.to my wedded wyfe, to have and to hold from thys day forward, for better, for worse, for richer, for porer, in sickenes, and in healthe, to love and to cheryshe, tyll death us departe; according to Gods holy ordinaunce, and therto I plight the my trouth.

Then shall they louse their handes, and the woman takynge againe the man by the right hande, shall saie.

I N.take the. N.to my wedded husbande, to have and to holde, from this day forward, for better, for worse, for richer, for poorer, in sickenes, ad in health, to love, cherish, and to obey, till death us departe, accordynge to godes holy ordinaunce: and therto I geve the my trouth.

Then shall they again louse theyr handes, and the man shal geve unto the woman a ring, laying the same upon the booke, with the accustomed dutie to the Priest and Clerke. And the Priest taking the ryng, shal delyver it unto the man, to put it upon the fourth finger of the womans left hand. And the man taught by the Priest, shal say.

WITH this ring I the wed: with my body I the worship: and with all my worldly goodes, I the endow. In the name of the Father, and of the Sonne, and of the holy Ghost. Amen.

Then the man leavyng the ryng upon the fourth finger of the womans left hande, the Minister shall saye.

O ETERNALL God, creatoure and preserver of all mankynd, giver of all spirytuell grace, the authour of everlastyng life: send thy blessing upon these thy servauntes, thys man and this woman, whom we blesse in thy name, that as Isaac and Rebecca lyved faithfully together: So these persons may surely performe and kepe the vow and covenaut betwixte them made, wherof this ring geven, and received, is a token and pledge, and may ever remain in perfect love and peace together, and live according unto thy lawes, thorough Jesus Christ our Lorde. Amen.

¶ *Then thai the Priest joyne their right handes together and say.*

Those whome God hath joyned together, let no man put a sonder.

Then shall the Minister speak unto the people.

FOR asmuche as .N. and .N. have consented together in holy wedlocke, and have witnessed the same before God, and thys company, and therto have given and pledged, their trouth eyther to other, and have declared the same by gevyng and receivynge of a ryng, and by joynynge of handes I pronounce that thei be man and wife together. In the name of the father, of the sonne and of the holy Ghost. Amen.

And the Minister shal adde this blessing.

GOD the Father, God the Sonne, God the holy Ghost, blesse, preserve, and kepe you, the Lorde mercifully wyth his favour loke upon you, and so fil you with al spiritual benediction, and grace, that you may so lyve together in thys life, that in the world to come, you may have life everlastyng. Amen.

¶ *Then the Ministers or Clerckes goyng to the Lordes table, shall saie, or syng this Psalme folowyng Beati omnes.*

BLESSED are all they that feare the Lorde, and walke in his waies.

For thou shalt eate the labour of thy handes, O wel is the, and happy shalt thou be.
 Thy wife shalbe as the fruitfull vine upon the walles of thy house.
 Thy children like the olive braunches rounde about thy table.
 Lo thus shall the man be blessed: that feareth the lorde.
 The Lorde from out of Sion shal blesse the: that thou shalt see Hierusalem in prosperitie, al thy
 life long:
 Yea, that thou shalt see thy childrens children, and peace upon Israel.
 Glory be to the. &c.
 As it was. &c.
 Psal. cxxviii.
Or elles this Psaime folowyng Deus misereatur.
 GOD be mercifull unto us and blesse us: and shewe us the lyght of his countenance, and be
 merciful unto us.
 That thy waie maie be knowne upon the earth: thy savyng healthe among al nacions.
 Let the people prayse the (O God) yea, let all the people praise the.
 O let the nacions rejoyce and be glad, for thou shalt judge the folke ryghteously, and governe
 the nacions upon the earth.
 Let the people praise the (O God) lette all the people praise the.
 Then shall the earthe bryng furthe her encrease, and God, even our God, shal geve us his
 blessing.
 God shall blesse us, and al the endes of the worlde shall feare him.
 Glory be to the Father. &c.
 As it was in the be. &c.
*The Psaime ended, and the man and the woman knelyng afore the Lordes table: The Priest standyng
 at the Table, and turnyng hys face towarde them, shal saie,*
 Lorde have mercie upon us.
Aunswere. Christe have mercie upon us.
Minister. Lorde have mercie upon us.
 OUR FATHER WHICHE ART. &c.
 And leade us not into temptation.
Aunswere. But deliver us from evil. Amen.
Minister. O Lorde, save thy servaunt, and thy handmaide.
Aunswere. Whyche put their trust in the.
Minister. O Lorde sende them helpe from thy holy place.
Aunswere. And evermore defende them.
Minister. Be unto them a towre of strength.
Aunswere. From the face of their enemye.
Minister. O Lorde heare our praier.
Aunswere. And let our crie come unto the.
 ¶ *The Minister.* O GOD of Abraham, God of Isaac, God of Jacob, blesse these thy servauntes,
 and sowe the sede of eternal life in their mindes, that whatsoever in thy holy worde they shal
 profitably learne, they may in dede fulfil the same. Loke, O Lorde mercifully upon them from
 heaven, and blesse them. And as thou diddest send thy blessing upon Abraham and Sara to their
 greate comforte: so vouchesaufe to sende thy blessing upon these thy servauntes, that they obeying

thy will, and alway beyng in saufetie under thy protection, may abide in thy love unto their lives ende, throughe Jesu Christe our Lorde. Amen.

¶ *This prayer next folowyng shal be omitted where the woman is past chide birth.* O MERCIFULL Lorde, and heavenly Father, by whose gracious gifte mankynde is encreased, we beseeche the assiste with thy blessing these two persones, that they may bothe be fruitefull in procreation of children, also live together so long in godly love and honestie, that they may see their childers children, unto the thirde and fourthe generacion unto thy praise and honour: through Jesus Christe our Lorde. Amen.

O GOD whiche by thy mightie power hast made all thinges of naught, which also after other thinges set in ordre, diddest appoint that out of man (created after thyne owne ymage and similitude) woman should take her beginning, and knitting them together, diddest teache that it shoulde never be lawfull to put a sonder those, whome thou by matrimonie haddest made one: O God which haste consecrated the state of matrimonie to suche an excellent misterie, that in it is signified and represented the spiritual mariage and unitie betwixte Chniste and his Church: Loke mercifully upon these thy servauntes, that both this man may love his wife, accordyng to thy worde (as Christe did love his spouse the Church, who gave himselfe for it, lovyng and cherishing it, even as his owne fleshe). And also that this woman may be lovyng and amiable to her housband as Rachel, wise as Rebecca, faithfull and obedient as Sara, and in all quietnes, sobrietie, and peace, be a folower of holy and Godly matrones, O Lorde blesse them bothe, and graunt them to enherite thy everlastyng kyngdome: throughe Jesus Christe our Lorde. Amen.

¶ *Then shall the Priest saye,*

ALMIGHTIE God, which, at the beginnyng did create our firste parentes Adam and Eve, and did sanctifie and joyne them together in mariage, powre upon you the riches of his grace, sanctifie, and blesse you, that ye may please hym both in body and soule, and live together in holy love, unto your lives ende. Amen.

Then shal begyn the Communion, and after the Gospel shalbe saied a Sermon, wherin ordinarily (so oft as there is any mariage) thoffice of a man and wife shalbe declared, accordyng to holy Scripture, or if there be no sermon, the Minister shal reade this that foloweth.

AL ye which be married, on whiche entend to take the holy estate of Matrimonie upon you: heare what holy scripture doth say, as touching the dutie of housbandes toward their wives, and wives toward their housbandes.

Saincte Paul (in his Epistle to the Ephesians, the v Chapter) doeth geve this commaundement to all married men.

Ye housbandes love your wives, even as Christ loved the Church, and hath geven hymselfe for it, to sanctifie it, purgyng it in the fountaine of water, throughe the worde, that he might make it unto hym selfe a glorious congregacion, not havynge spot or wrinkle, or any suche thyng, but that it shoulde be holy and blameles. So men are bounde to love their owne wyves, as their owne bodies. He that loveth his owne wife loveth hym selfe. For never did any man hate his owne fleshe, but nourisheth and cherisheth it, even as the Lorde doeth the congregacion, for we are membres of his body: of his flesh and of hys bones.

For this cause shall a man leave father and mother, and shalbe joined unto his wife, and thei two shalbe one flesh. This mistery is great, but I speake of Christe and of the congregacion. Neverthesse, let every one of you so love his owne wyfe, even as hym selfe.

Psal. lxxvii.

Likewise the same saint Paule (wrytyng to the Collossians) speaketh thus to all men that be

married. Ye men, love your wyves, and be not bitter unto them. Collos iii.

Heare also what saincte Peter Thaposthe of Christe, whiche was him selfe a married man (saith unto al men) that are married. Ye housbandes, dwel with your wyves according to knowledge. Gevyng honour unto the wyfe as unto the weaker vessell, and as heires together of the grace of lyfe, so that your praiers be not hyndred.

Hetherto ye have hearde the dutie of the housbande toward the wyfe.

Now likewise ye wyves heare and learne your dutie toward your housbandes, even as it is plainly sette furth in holy scripture. i. Pet. iii.

Saincte Paule (in the forenamed Epistle to the Ephesians) teacheth you thus: Ye women, submit youre selves unto youre owne housbandes as unto the Lorde: for the housbande is the wyves headde, even as Christe is the headde of the Church. And he is also the savioure of the whole bodye. Therefore as the Church or congregacion, is subjecte unto Christe. So likewise lette the wyves also be in subjection unto their owne housbandes in al thinges. And againe he sayeth : Let the wife reverence her housbande. And (in his Epistle to the Collossians) Sayncte Paule geveth you thys shorte lesson, Ye wyves submitte youre selves unto youre own housbandes, as it is convenient in the Lorde.

Ephe. v.

Col. iii.

Saincte Peter also doeth instructe you verie godly, thus sayynge, Let wyves be subject to their owne housbandes, so that if anye obey not the woorde, they may be wonne withoute the woorde, by the conversacion [=behavior] of the wyves, whyle they beholde your chaste conversacion coupled with feare, whose apparell let it not be outward, with broided [braided] haire and trymmyng about with golde, eyther in puttinge on of gorgeous apparell, but let the hidde manne whiche is in the harte, be without all corruption, so that the spirite be milde and quiete, whiche is a precious thyng in the sighte of God. For after thys maner (in the olde tyme) did the holy women whiche trusted in God apparell them selves, beyng subject to their owne housbandes, as Sara obeyed Abraham callyng hym Lorde; whose daughters ye are made, doynge well, and beyng not dismayde with any feare.

The newe married persones (the same day of their mariage) must receyve the holy Communion. i. Pet. iii.

Return to the 1559 Book of Common Prayer

The Order for the Visitation of the Sick

The Book of Common Prayer - 1559

¶ THE ORDER FOR THE
VISITACION OF THE SICKE.

The Priest entryng into the sicke persones house, shall saye.

Peace be in* this house, and to all that dwel in it.

When he commeth into the sicke mannes presence, he shall saye knelynge doune.

REMEMBRE not Lorde oure iniquities, nor the iniquities of our forefathers. Spare us good Lorde, spare thy people, whome thou hast redemed with thy most precious bloude and bee not angry with us for ever.

Lorde have mercy upon us.

Christe have mercy upon us.

Lorde have mercy upon us.

¶ Our father whiche art in heaven. &c

And leade us not into temptacion.

Aunswere. But deliver us from evel. Amen.

¶ *Minister.* O Lorde save thy servaunt.

¶ *Aunswere.* Whiche putteth his trust in the.

¶ *Minister.* Sende him helpe from thy holy place.

¶ *Aunswere.* And evermore myghtely defende him.

¶ *Minister.* Let the enemy have none advauntage of him.

¶ *Aunswere.* Nor the wicked approche to hurte him.

¶ *Minister.* Be unto him O Lorde a strong Towre.

¶ *Aunswere.* From the face of his enemy.

¶ *Minister.* Lorde heare our praiers.

¶ *Aunswere.* And let our crie come unto the.

¶ *Minister,*

O Lorde lorde doune from Heaven, beholde, visite, and releve this thy servaunt. Lorde uppon him with the eyes of thy mercye, geve him comforte and sure confidence in the, defende him from the daunger of the enemy, and kepe him in perpetual peace, and saufety: Through Jesus Christe our Lorde. Amen.

HEARE us almighty, and most mercifull God, and saviour, extend thy accustomed goodnes, to this thy servaunt whiche is greved with sycknesse, visit him O Lorde, as thou diddest visit Peters wifes mother, and the capiteines servaunt. So visit and restore unto this sicke person his former health (if it bee thy wil) or els geve him grace so to take thy visitation, that after this painful life ended, he may dwell with the in life everlastyng. Amen.

¶ *Then shal the Minister exhorte the sicke person after this forme or other lyke.*

* "to" in early 1600's.

DERELY beloved know this, that almighty god is the lorde of life and death, and over al thinges to them pertainyng, as youthe, strength, helthe, age weaknesse, and sicknes, wherfore, whatsoever your sycknesse is, knowe you certainlye, that it is Goddes visitacion. And for what cause soever this sicknes is sent unto you: whether it bee to trie youre patience for the example of other, and that your faith may be founde in the dai of the lord laudable, glorious, and honorable, to the encrease of Glory, and endles felicitie: Or els it be sent unto you, to correct, and amende in you whatsoever dothe offende the eyes of our heavenly father: knowe you certainly, that yf you truly repent you of your sinnes, and beare your sickenes patiently, trustyng in Gods mercy for his dere sonne Jesus Christes sake, and rendre unto him humble thanks for his fatherly visitacion, submittynge your selfe wholly to his will, it shall turne to your profite, and helpe you forward in the right waye that leadeth unto everlastyng life*. Take therfore in good worthe, the chastement of the lord, for whom the lord loveth he chastiseth. yea, as S. Paul saith, he scourgeth every sonne which he receiveth: If you endure chastisement, he offereth himself unto you as unto his own children. What sonne is he that the father chastiseth not? If ye be not under correction (whereof all true children are partakers) then are ye bastards, and not children. Therefore seying, that when our carnal fathers do correct us, we reverently obey them, shal we not now muche rather be obedient to our spirituall father, and so live? And they for a few daies do chastise us after their owne pleasure, but he doth chastise us for our profit to thentent he maye make us partakers of his holines. These wordes good brother, are Gods wordes, and written in holy Scripture for our comforte and instruction, that we sholde

patiently and with thankesgeving, beare our heavenly fathers Correction, whensoever by any maner of adversitie it shal please his gracious goodnes to visite us. And there shoulde be no greater comforte to christien persons, than to be made like unto christ, by sufferieng patiently adversities, troubles, and Sickenesses. For he him selfe went not up to joye, but firste he suffered paine : hee entred not into his glorye, before he was crucified: So truly our way to eternall joye, is to suffer here with Christe, and our doore to entre into eternall life: is gladly to die with Christ, that we may ryse againe from death and dwell with him in everlastynge life. Nowe therefore, taking your sicknesse, whiche is thus profitable for you patiently: I exhorte you in the name of God, to rernembre the profession whiche you made unto God, in your Baptisme. And forasmuche as after this lyfe there is accompte [account] to be geven unto the rightuous judge, of whome all must be judged without respect of persons: I require you to examine your selfe and your state, bothe towarde God and man, so that accusynge and condempning your self for your owne faultes, you may fynde mercy at our heavenly fathers hande, for Christes sake, and not be accused and condempned in that fearful judgement. Therefore I shal shortly rehearse the Articles of our faith, that ye may know whether you do beleve as a Christien man shoulde, or no. ¶ *Here the minister shall rekerse the articles of the faith saieng thus*

DOEST thou beleve in God the father almighty.

And so furth, as it is in Baptisme.

1559:

*If the person visited be very sicke then the Curate may ende his exhortacion in thys place.

¶ *Then shal the minister examine whether he be in charitie, with all the worlde: exhortyng hym to forgive from the botome of his hart, al persons that have offended hym, and if he have offended other, to aske them forgevenesse; And wher he hathe done injury or wrong to any man, that he make amendes to the uttermost of his power. And if he have not afore disposed his goodes, let him the make his wil. (But men must be oft admonished that they set an order for their temporall goodes and landes,when they be in health.) And also declare his debtes, what he oweth, and what is owyng unto him, for discharging of his conscience, and quietnes ofhis executours. The minister may not forget, nor omitte to move the sicke person (and that most earnestly) to liberalitie lowarde the poore.*

From late 1500's:

This may be done before the minister begin his praiers as he shal se cause.

¶ *Then shal the minister examine whether he be in charitie, with all the world, exhorting him to forgive from the bottome of his heart all persons that have offended him, and if he have offended other, to aske them forgevenesse: and where hee hath done injury or wrong to any man, that he make amends to the uttermost of his power. And if he have not afore disposed his goods, let him the make his will, and also declare his debts, what he oweth, and what is owing unto him, for discharging of his conscience, and quietnesse of his Executors. But men must be oft admonished that they set an order for their temporall goods and lands, when they be in health.*¶ *These words before rehearsed, may bee said before the Minister begin his praier, as he shall see cause.*¶ *The minister may not forget, nor omit to moove the sicke person (and that most earnestly) to liberality loward the poore.*

¶ *Here shall the sicke persone make a speciall confession, if he feeles hys conscience troubled with any weighty matter. After whiche confession the priest shall absolve him after this sorte.*

OUR Lorde Jesus Christ who hath left power to hys Church to absolve all sinners, whiche truly repente, and beleve in him: of hys greates mercie forgeve thyne offences, and by his auctoritie committed to me, I absolve the from al thy synnes. In the name of the father and of the sonne &c. Amen. ¶ *And then the priest shal say the Collect folowyng.*

¶ Let us praie.

O MOST merciful God, whiche according to the multitude of thy mercies, dost so put awai the sinnes of those whiche truly repent, that thou remebrest them no more, open thy eie of mercy upon this thy servaunt, who most earnestly desireth pardon, and forgevenes. Renuie in him most lovyng father, whatsoever hath been decaied, by the fraud, and malice of the devel, or by his owne carnall will, and frailnes, preserve, and continue this sicke membre in the unitie of thy churche, consider his contricion, accept hys teares, asswage his paine, as shalbe sene to thee most expedient for him. And forasmuche as he putteth his full trust only in thy mercy, impute not unto him his former sinnes, but take him to thy favour, through the merites of thy moste derely beloved sonne Jesus Chriest. Amen.

¶ *Then the Minister shal saie this Psalm.*

IN the, O Lorde have I put my trust, let me never bee put to confusion, but ridde me, and deliver me into thy ryghtuousnesse, encline thine eare unto me and save me.

Be thou my strong holde wherunto I may alway resorte: thou hast promysed to helpe me, for thou art my house of defence, and my Castel.

Deliver me a my God out of the hande of the ungodly: out of the hande of the unrightuous and cruell man.

For thou O lorde God art the thyng that I long for : thou art my hope even from my youth.

Through the have I ben holden up ever sence I was borne: thou art he that toke me out of my mothers wombe, my prayse shall alway be of the.

I am become as it were a monster unto many: but my sure truste is in the.

O let my mouth be filled with thy praise: (that I may sing of thy glory) and honor all the daie longe.

Cast me not away in the tyme of age: forsake me not when my strength faileth me.

For myne enemies speake againste me, and they that laye wayte for my soule, take their counsaill together, saiynge: God hath forsaken hym, persecute hym, and take hym, for there is none to deliver hym.

Go not farre from me, O God: my God, haste the to helpe me.

Let them be confounded and perishe, that are against my soule: let them be covered with shame and dishonoure that seke to do me evill.

As for me, I will pacietly abide alwaie : and wil praise the, more and more.

My mouthe shall dayely speake of thy righteousnes, and salvacion: for I knowe no ende therof.

I will go furth in the strength of the Lorde God: and will make mencion of thy righteousnesse onely.

Thou (O God) haste taughte me from my youthe up untill now: therefore I will tell of thy wonderous workes.

Forsake me not (O God) in myne olde age, when I am gray headed: until I haue shewed thy strength unto this generacion, and thy power to all them that are yet for to come.

Thy righteousnesse (O God) is very hygh, and great thinges are they that thou haste done: O God, who is lyke unto the?

O what great troubles and adversities hast thou shewed me? and yet diddest thou turne and refreshe me, yea, and broughtest me from the depe of the earth agayne.

Thou hast broughte me to great honour: and comforted me on every side.

Therefore will I prayse the and thy faythefulnes (O God) plaiynge upon an instrument of Musicke: unto the will I synge uppon the Harpe, O thou holy one of Israell.

My lippes will be faine, when I sing unto the: and so will my soule whome thou hast delivered.
My tongue also shal talke of thy righteousnesse al the day long : for thei are confounded and brought unto shame, that seke to do me evill.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Sonne, and to the holy Ghoste.

As it was in the begynnyng, is now and ever shalbe worlde without ende. Amen.

Addyng thys.

O SAVIOUR of the worlde, save us, whyche by thy crosse and precious bloude hast redemed us, helpe us we beseeche the, O God.

¶ *Then shal the Minister saye.*

THE almightie Lord; whiche is a moste strong tower to all them that put their trust in him, to whom all thinges in heaven, in earthe, and under the earthe doe bowe and obey, be now; and evermore thy defence, and make the knowe and fele, that there is no other name under heaven geven to man, in whome, and throughe whome thou mayest receyve healthe and salvacion, but onely .the name of oure Lorde Jesus Christe. Amen. *In te, domine, spe. Psal. lxxi.*

¶ THE

COMMUNION OF THE SICKE.

Forasmuche as al mortal men be subjecte to many soubdein perilles, diseases, and sicknesses, and ever uncertaine what time they shal departs out of this lyf. Therefore to thentent they may be alwaies in a readines to die, whensoever it that please Almightye God to cal them: The Curates shal diligently from tyme to tyme, but specially in the plague time, exhort their Parishioners to the oft receivynge in the Church, of the holy Communion of the body and bloude of our saviour Christ. Whiche (if thei do) thei shal have no cause in their soubdeine visitation to be unquieted for lacks of the same. But if the sicke persons be not able to come to the Church, and yet is desirous to receive the Communion in his house, then yee must give knowledge over night, or elles early in the Morning to the Curate, signifying also how many be appointed to communicate with him. And havynge a convenient place in the sicke mans house, where the Curate may reverently minister, and a good number to receive the Communion with the sicke persons, with all thynges necessary for the same, he that there minister the holy Communion.

The Collect.

ALMIGHTIE everlivyng God, maker of mankynde, whiche doest correcte those whom thou doest love, and chastisest every one whome thou doest receive, we beseeche the to have mercie upon this thy servaunt visited with thy hande, and to graunt that he may take his sicknesse patiently, and recover his bodily helth (yf it be thy gracious wil), and whensoever his soule shal depart from the body, it may bee without spot presented unto the: Throughe Jesus Christe our Lorde. Amen.

The Epistle.

MY sonne, despise not the correction of the Lorde, neither faint when thou art rebuked of hym. For whome the Lorde loveth, him he correcteth : yea, and he scourgeth every sonne whom he receiveth.

Hebr. xii.

The Gospel.

VERELY, verely I say unto you, he that heareth my worde, and beleveth on hym that sent me, hath everlastyng life, and shall not come unto dampnacion, but he passeth from death unto lyfe.

¶ *At the time of the distribucion of the holy Sacrament, the Priest shal flrst receive the Communion hymselfe, and after minister unto them that be appointed to communicate with the sicke.*

¶ *But if any man, either by reason of extremitie of sickenes, or for lacke of warnyng in due time to the Curate, or for lacke of company to receive with hym, or by any other just impediment, do not receive the*

Sacrament of Christes body and bloud, then the Curate shall instruct hym, that if he do truely repent hym of his synnes, and stedfastly beleve that Jesus Christe hath sufred death upon the crosse for him, and shed his bloud for his redempcion, earnestly remembryng the benefites he hath therby, and geving him hartie thanks therfore, he doth eate and dryncke the body and blode of our saviour Christe, profitably to his soules health, although he doe not receive the Sacrament with his mouthe.

¶ When the sicke person is visited, and receiveth the holy Communion al at one time, then the Priest, for more expedicion, shal cut of the fourme of the visitacion at the Psaime, In the, O Lorde have I put my trust, and go streight to the Communion.

¶ In the time of plague, Swette, or such other like contagious tymes of sicknesses or diseases, when none of the Paroshe or neighbours can be gotten to communicate with the sicke in their houses, for feare of the infection, upon speciall request of the diseased, the minister may alonly communicate with hym.

John v.

Return to the 1559 Book of Common Prayer

The Order for the Burial of the Dead

The Book of Common Prayer - 1559

THE ORDER FOR THE BURIAL OF THE DEAD.

¶ The prieste metyng the corpse at the Church style, shal saye, Or els the priestes and clerkes shall syng, and so go eyther unto the churche, or towards the grave. * "into" in 1604.*

I AM the resurrection and the life (saith the Lord) he that beleveth in me: yea, though he were dead, yet shall he live. And whosoever liveth, and believeth in me, shall not dye for ever.

Jhon xi.

I KNOW that my redemer lyveth, and that I shal rise out of the earth in the last daye, and shal be covered agayne with my skinne, and shall se God in my flesh: yea, and I my selfe shall beholde hym, not with other, but with thesame eyes.

Job xix.

WE brought nothinge into this worlde, neither may we cary any thyng out of this worlde.

i. Tim. vi.

The Lord geveth, and the Lorde taketh awaye. Even as it hath pleased the Lorde so commeth thynges to passe: Blessed be the name of the Lorde.

¶ When they come to the grave, whyles the corps is made redy to be layd into the earth, ye priest shal say, or the priestes, and clerkes shal sing. Jobi.

MAN that is borne of a woman hathe but a shorte tyme to lyve, and is full of miserye: he commeth up, and is cut doune lyke a floure, he flyeth as it were a shadow, and never continueth in one staye. In the middest of life we be in death, of whom mai we seke for succour but of the, O Lorde, whiche for our sinnes justly arte displeased: yet O Lorde God most holy, O Lorde moste mightye, O holy, and moste mercifull Saviour, deliver us not into the bitter paynes of eternall death. Thou knowest Lord the secretes of our hertes, shut not up thy mercifull eyes to our prayers. But spare us Lorde moste holy, O God moste mighty, O holy and mercifull Saviour, thou most worthy judge eternall, suffer us not at our last houre for any paines of death to fall from the.

¶ Then whyle the earth shal be cast upon the body by some standing by, the priest shall saye.

FOR asmuche as it hath pleased almightie God of his great mercy to take unto hym selfe the Soule of oure deare brother, here departed, we therefore committe hys bodye to the ground, earthe,

to earthe ashes, to ashes, dust, to dust, in sure, and certein hope of resurrection to eternall lyfe, throughe oure Lorde Jesus Christe, who shall change oure vyle body that it may be lyke to his glorious body, according to the mighty workynge whereby he is able to subdue al thynges to hym selfe.

Then shalbe sayde, or songe.

I HEARDEa voyce from heaven sayng unto me, wryte from hencefurth, blessed are the dead whiche dye in the Lorde. Even so sayeth the spirite that they reste from their labours.

Job xi.

Then shall folowe this lesson, taken out of the. xv. Chap. to the Corin. the first Epistle.

CHRISTis rysen from the dead, and become the fyrst frutes of them that slept. For by a man came deth, and by a man came the resurreccion of the dead. For as by Adam al die, even so by Christ shal al be made alive, but every manne in his owne order. The fyrste is Christe, then they that are Christes at his comming. Then commeth the ende when he hathe delivered up the kyngedome to God the father, when he hath put doune all rule, and all auctoritie and power. For he must reygne till he have put hys enemies under hys fete. The laste enemye that shalbe destroyed is deathe. For he hath putte all thynges under his feete. But when he sayeth, all thynges are putte under hym, it is manifeste that hee is excepted, whyche dyd putte all thynges under hym. When al thinges are subdued unto him, then shall the sonne also hym self be subjecte unto him that put all thynges under hym, that God maye be al in all, elles what do they whyche are baptised over the deade, if the dead rise not at all? Why are they then baptised over them: yea, and why stande we alway then in jeopardye? By our rejoysinge which I have in Christ jesu our Lorde, I dye daily. That I have foughte wyth beastes Ephesus after the maner of men, what avauntageth it me, if the deadryse not agayne? Lette us eate and drincke, for to morow we shall dye. Be not ye deceyved; evil wordes corrupt good maners. Awake truly out of slepe, and sinne not. For somme have not the knowledge of God. I speake this to your shame. But some manne wyl say how aryse the dead? with what body shal they come? thou foole, that whiche thou sowest is not quickened except it dye. And what sowest thou? thou sowest not that body that shalbe; but bare corne [=seed], as of wheate, or some other: but God geveth it a bodye at hys plesure, to everye sede his owne bodye. All fleshe is not one maner of flesh: but there is one maner of flesh of menne, an other maner of flesh of beasts, an other of fishes, an other of byrdes. There are also celestial bodyes, and there are bodies terrestriall. But the glory of the celestiall is one, and the glory of the terrestriall is another. There is one maner glory of the Sonne, and another glory of the Mone [Moon], and another glory of the starres. For one starre differeth from another in glory: so is the resurrection of the deade. It is sowen in corrupcion, it riseth againe in incorrupcion. It is sowen in dishonoure, it riseth againe in honoure. It is sowen in weaknes, it ryseth againe in power. It is sowen a natural body, it ryseth againe a spirituall bodye. There is a natural body, and there is a spirituall body: as it is also wryten, the fyrst man Adam was made a lyvyng soule, and the laste Adam was made a quickeninge spirite. How be it that is not fyrst whyche is spirituall: but that whiche is naturall and then that whiche is spirytual. The first man is of the earth, earthye: The seconde manne is the Lord from Heaven (heavenlye). As is the earthy, suche are they that be earthy. And as is the heavenly, such are they that are heavenly. And as we have borne the ymage of the earthye, so shall we beare the ymage of the heavenly. Thys saye I brethren, that fleshe and bloude cannot enherite the kyngdome of God, neyther doth corruption enherite incorruption. Beholde, I shewe you a mystery. we shall not all slepe: but we shall al be chaunged, and that in a momente, in the twynkelyng of an eye by the last trumpe [trumpet]. For the trumpe shall blowe, and the deade shall rise incorruptible,

and we shall be chaunged. For this corruptible must put on incorruption, and this mortall must put on immortalitye. When this corruptible hath put on incorruption, and this mortall hath put on immortalitye: then shall be broughte to passe the sayinge that is wrytten, Deathe is swallowed up in victory: Deathe, where is thy sting? Hell where is thy victory? The styng of deathe is sinne, and the strengthe of sinne is the lawe. But thanks be unto God, whyche hathe geuen us victory, through our Lord Jesus Christ. Therfore my deare brethren, be ye stedfast and unmovable, alwaies rich in the worke of the lorde, forasmuch as ye knowe, howe that your laboure is not in vayne in the Lorde.

¶ *The Lesson ended, the Priest shall saye.*

Lorde have mercye upon us.

Christe have mercye upon us.

Lorde have mercye upon us.

Our Father whiche arte in heaven. &c.

And leade us not into temptation.

Aunswere. But deliver us from evil. Amen.

¶ *The Priest.*

ALMIGHTIE God, with whome do live the spirites of them that depart hence in the lorde and in whome the soules of them that be elected, after they be delivered from the burthen of the flesh, be in joye and felicitie. We geve the hearty thanks for that it hath pleased the to deliver this N. oure brother, out of the miseries of thys synneful worlde beseeching the that it may please the of thy gracious goodnes, shortelye to accomplishe the numbere of thyne electe, and to haste thy kyngedome, that we with thys oure brother, and all other departed in the true fayth of thy holy name, may have our perfect consummacion and blisse, both in bodye and soule in thy eternall and everlastyng glorie. Amen.

¶ *The Collect.*

O MERCIFULL God, the father of our Lord Jesus Christe, who is the Resurrection and the lyfe, in whom whosoever beleveth shall live, thoughe he dye, and whosoever liveth, and beleveth in hym, shall not dye eternally, who also taughte us (by hys holy apostle Paule), not to be sory as men without hope, for them that slepe in hym: We mekely beseeche the (O Father) to rayse us from the deathe of sinne unto the lyfe of righteousnes, that when we shall depart thys lyfe, we may rest in hym, as our hope is thys oure brother doeth, and that at the generall resurrection in the laste daye, we maye be founde acceptable in thy syghte, and receive that blessing which thy welbeloved sonne shall then pronounce to all that love and fear the, sayynge: Come ye blessed children of my father, receyve the Kyngedome prepared for you frome the begynnyng of the worlde. Graunte thys, we beseeche the, O mercifull father, through Jesus Christe our mediatoure and redemer. Amen.

Return to the 1559 Book of Common Prayer

The Thanksgiving of Women after Child-birth

The Book of Common Prayer - 1559

¶ THE THANKESGEVINGE OF WOMEN

AFTER CHILDE BYRTHE,

COMMUNELYE CALLED THE CHURCHYNGE OF WOMEN.

The woman shall come into the churche, and there shall knele downe in some convenient place, nyghe unto the place where the table standeth, and the priest standing by her, shal saie these wordes, or suche lyke, as the case that require.

FORASMUCHE as it hath pleased almyghtye God of hys goodnes to geve you safe delyveraunce, and hath preserved you in the great daunger of childbyrth: ye shal therfore geve heartye thanks unto God and praye.

¶ *Then shall the priest saye this Psalme.*

I HAVE lyfte up myne eyes unto the hylles, from whence commeth my helpe.

My helpe commeth even from the Lord: whych hath made heaven and earth.

He wyll not suifre thy foote to be moved: and he that kepeth the, wil not slepe.

Beholde, he that kepeth Israell: shall neyther slomber nor slepe.

The Lorde hym selfe is thy keper: the Lorde is thy defence upon thy ryght hande.

So that the sonne shall not burne the by daye, neither the moone by night.

The Lorde shal preserve the from al evil: yea, it is even he that shal kepe thy soule.

The Lorde shal preserve thy goinge out, and thy commynge in: from thys tyme forth for evermore.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Sonne &c.

As it was in the begynynge, is now &c.

Lorde have mercye upon us.

Christe have mercye upon us.

Lorde have mercye upon us.

OUR FATHER WHICHE ARTE &c.

And leade us not into temptacion.

Aunswere. But deliver us from evil. Amen.

Priest. *O Lorde save this woman thy servaunt.

Aunswere. Whiche putteth her trust in the.

Priest. *Be thou to her a strong Towre.

Aunswere. From the face of her enemy.

Priest. *Lorde heare our praier.

Aunswere. And let our crie come unto the.

Priest. * * "Minister" in 1604.

Let us praie.

O ALMIGHTY God, which hast delivered this woman thy servaunte from the great paine and peril of childe birthe: Graunt we beseeche the most mercifull Father, that she through thy help may bothe faithfully live, and walke in her vocation, accordyng to thy wil, in this lyfe present, and also may be partaker of everlastyng glory in the lyfe to come, throughe Jesus Christ our Lorde. Amen.

The woman that commeth to gine her thanckes, muste offer accustomed offerynges, aud if there be a Communion, it is convenient that she receive the holy Communion.

A COMMINATION AGAINST SINNERS,

WITH CERTAINE PRAYERS, TO BE USED DIVERS TIMES IN THE YERE.

After Mornyng prayer, the people beyng called together by the ringyng of a Bel, and assembled in the Churche, thenglish Letany shalbe saide after thaccustomed maner, whyche ended the priest shal go into the pulpit and saie thus.

BRETHREN, in the Prymatyve churche there was a godly discipline, that at the begynyng of Lent, suche personnes as were notoryus Synners, were putte to open penaunce and punyshed in thys world, that their soules might be saved in the daie of the lord. And that others admonyshed by theyr example myght be more afrayde to offende. In the stede wherof (untill the sayde Discypline maye be restored agayne, whyche thyng is muche to be wyshed) it is thought good that at this time (in your presence) shoulde be redde the general sentences of goddes cursyng agaynst impenitent Synners, gathered out of the .xxvii. Chapiter of Deuteronomye, and other places of Scripture. And that ye shoulde aunswere to every sentence. Amen. To thyntent that you being admonished of the great indignation of God against Synners: may the rather be called to earnest and true repentaunce, and maye walke more warely in these daungerous daies, flieing from suche vices, for the whyche ye affirme wyth your owne mouthes, the Curse of God to be due.

CURSED is the man that maketh any carved, or molten Image, an abomination to the Lorde, the worke of the handes of the craftes man, and putteth it in a secrete place to worship it.

¶ And the people shal aunswere and saie

Amen.

Minister. Cursed is he that cursethe his father, or mother.

Aunswere. Amen.

Minister. Cursed is hee that removeth away the marcke of hys neyghbours lande.

Aunswere. Amen.

Minister. Cursed is he that maketh the blynde to go oute of hys way.

Aunswere. Amen.

Minister. Cursed is he that, letteth [=hinders] in judgmet, the right of the straunger, of them that be fatherles, and of widdowes.

Aunswere. Amen.

Minister. Cursed is he that smiteth his neighbour secretlye.

Aunswere. Amen.

Minister. Cursed is he that lieth with his neyghbours wife.

Aunswere. Amen.

Minister. Cursed is he that taketh rewarde to slea the Soule of innocent bloude.

Aunswere. Amen.

Minister. Curseth is he that putteth hys trust in manne, and taketh manne for hys defence, and in hys harte goeth from the Lorde.

Aunswere. Amen.

Minister. Cursed are the unmerciful, the fornicatours, and adulterers, and the couetous persones, the worshippers of ymages, slaunderers, dronkardes, and extorcioners.

Aunswere. Amen.

The Minister.

Nowe seyng that all they be accursed (as the Prophete David beareth wytnesse) [Psa. cxviii. =Ps. 119:21] whyche do erre, and go astraye from the cornmaundernentes of God, let us remembring the dreadful judgements hanginge over our heddes, and beyng always at hande returne unto oure Lorde God, with all contricion and mekenes of hearte, bewailynge and lamenting our synful lyfe,

knowledging [=acknowledging] and confessing our offences, and sekyng to bryng furth worthie
 fruites of penaunce. For nowe is the Axe put unto the roote of the trees, so that every tree which
 bringeth not furth good fruit, is hewen downe and cast into the fire. [Math. iii.] It is a fearfull thing
 to falle into the handes of the lyvinge God: [Heb. x.] he shal poure doune raine upon the synners,
 Snares, fyre, and brimstone, storme and tempeste, thys shalbe their portion to drincke. [Psal. x. = Ps.
 11:6] For lo, the Lorde is comen out of his place, to visite the wickednesse of suche as dwel upon
 the earth. [Esai. (Isaiah) xxvi.] But who may abyde the daye of his comming? Who shalbe able to
 endure, when he apereth? [Mal. iii.] His fanne is in his hande, and he wyll pource hys floore, and
 gather his wheate into the barne, but he wyl burne the chaffe with unquenchable fyre. [Math. iii.]
 The daye of the Lord commeth as a thefe upon the night, and when men shall saye peace, and all
 thinges are saufe, then shal soubdenly destruction come upon them, as sorowe commeth uppon
 a woman travailyng with childe, and they shall not escape. [i. Thes. v.] Then shall appeare the
 wrathe of God in the day of vengeance, which obstinate sinners, throughe the stubburnnes of theyr
 hearte, have heaped unto them selfe, [Rom. ii.] whyche despysed the goodnes, pacyence, and
 longe sufferance of God, when he called them continually to repentaunce. Then shall they call
 upon me, sayeth the Lorde, but I wyll not heare: they shall seke me early, but they shall not fynde
 me: and that because they hated knowledge, and receyved not the feare of the Lorde, but abhorred
 my counsaile, and dispised my correccion, [Prover. i.] then shall it be to late to knocke, when the
 dore shalbe shutte, and to late to crye for mercye, when it is the tyrne of Justice. O terryble voyce of
 most just judgement, whiche shalbe pronounced upon them, when it shalbe sayde unto them: Go,
 ye cursed, into the fyre everlastyng, whyche is prepared for the devill and hys Aungeles. [Mat.
 xxv.] Therefore brethren take we hede by tyme, [betime, =in good time] whyle the daie of salvacion
 lasteth, [ii. Cor. vi.] for the nyght commeth when none can worke: [Jhon ix.] but let us whyle we
 have the lyght, beleve in the lyghte, and walke as the children of the lyght, that we be not caste into
 the utter darckenes, where is wepyng and gnasshyng of teeth. [Mat. xxv.] Lette us not abuse
 the goodnes of God, whyche calleth us mercyfully to amendement, and of hys endelesse pytye
 promysed us forgevenesse of that whyche is paste [past]: If (wyth a whole mynde and true hearte)
 we returne unto hym. For though our synnes be red as scarlet, they shalbe as whyte as snowe,
 and thoughe they be lyke purple, yet shall they be as whyte as wolfe. [Esay. (Isaiah) i.] Turne you
 cleane (sayeth the Lorde) from all your wickednes, and your synne shal not be your destruction.
 [Ezechiel xxviii. =Ezek. 18] Cast awaye from you all your ungodlynnes that ye have done: make
 you newe heartes, and a newe spiryte: wherfore wyll ye dye, O ye house of Israell? Seiyng that I
 have no pleasure in the deathe of hym that dyeth (sayeth the Lorde God.) Turne you then, and you
 shall lyve. Although we have synned, yet have we an advocate with the Father, Jesus Christe the
 ryghteous, and he it is that obteyneth grace for our synnes, [i. Jhon ii.] for he was wounded for our
 offences, and smytten for our wyckednesse. [Esai. liii.] Let us therefore returne unto hym, who is
 the mercifull receyver of all true penitent sinners, assuring oure selfe that he is ready to receyve
 us, and most willyng to pardone us, yf we come to him, with faythfull repentaunce. Yf we will
 submit our selves unto him, and from hencefurthe walke in his wayes. Yf we will take hys easy
 yoke, and lighte burthen upon us, [Math. xi.] to folowe hym in lowlines, pacyence, and charitie,
 and be ordered by the governaunce of hys holy spirite, seking alwayes his glorie, and servyng hym
 duely in our vocation with thankes gevyng. This yf we do, Christ wil deliver us from the curse
 of the law, and from the extreme malediction, which light upon theym, that shalbe set on the left
 hand, and he wyll set us on hys ryght hande, and geve us the blessed benediction of hys father,
 commaundyng us to take possession of his glorious kyngdome, [Math. xxv.] unto the whiche he

vouchesaufe to brynge us al, for hys infinite mercye.

¶ *Then shall they all knele upon theyr knees: And the Priestes and Clerckes knelynge (were they are accustomed to saye the Letany) shall say thy: Psalme. Miserere mei Deus.*

The scripture references seen here within the text were placed in the margin in the original.

HAVE mercy upon me, O God after thy great goodnes, according to the multitud of thy mercyes, do away myne offences,

Washe me throughly from my wyckednes and clense me from my synne.

For I acknowledge my faultes, and my synne is ever before me.

Against the onely have I synned, and done this evyll in thy sight, that thou mightest be justyfyed in thy sayeng, and cleare when thou art judged.

Beholde, I was shapen in wickednesse, and in synne hath my mother conceived me.

But lo, thou requirest trueth in inwarde parties [parts], and shalt make me to understande wisdomedome secretlye.

Thou shalte purge me with hysoppe, and I shall be cleane, thou shalt washe me, and I shall be whyter then Snowe.

Thou shalt make me here of joy and gladnesse : that the bones whiche thou hast broken may rejoyce.

Turne thy face from my sinnes: and put oute all my misdedites.

Make me a cleane hearte (O God:) and renue a right spirite within me.

Cast me not away from thy presence : and take not thy holy spirite from me.

O geve me the comforte of thy helpe agayne: and stablysh me with thy free spirite.

Then shall I teache thy wayes unto the wicked : and sinners shalbe converted unto the.

Deliver me from bloude giltines (O God) thou that art the God of my healthe: and my tonge shall synge of thy ryghteousnes.

Thou shalte open my lyppes (O Lord) my mouth shal shewe thy prayse.

For thou desirest no sacrifice, els woulde I geve it the: but thou delightest not in burnt offerynge.

The sacrifice of God is a troubled spirite: a broken and a contrite hearte O God, shalte thou not despise.

O be favourable and gracious unto Sion : builde thou the walles of Jerusalem.

Then shalt thou be pleased with the sacrifice of rightuousnesse, with the burnt offerynges and oblations : then shall they offer yong bullockes upon thine aultare.

Glory bee to the Father, and to the Sonne, and to the holy Ghoste.

As it was in the beginning, is nowe, and ever shal be world without ende. Amen.

Lorde have mercy upon us.

Christ have mercy upon us.

Lorde have mercy upon us.

Our father which arte in heaven. &c.

And leade us not into temptacion.

Aunswere. But deliver us from evil. Amen.

Minister. O Lorde save thy servauntes.

Aunswere. Whiche put their trust in the.

Minis/er. Sende unto them helpe from above.

Aunswere. And evermore mightely defende them.

Minister. Help us, O God our saviour.

Aunswere. And for the glorye of thy names sake deliver us, bee mercyfull unto us synners, for thy names sake.

The Minister. Lorde heare my praiers.

Aunswere. And let our crie come unto thee.

Let us praye.

O LORD, we beseeche the, mercifully heare our prayers, and spare al those which confesse their sinnes to the, that they (whose consciences by sin are accused) by thy merciful pardon may be absolved, throughe Christ our Lorde. Amen.

O MOSTEmighty God, and mercyfull father which haste compassion of al men, and hatest nothing that thou haste made: whiche wouldest not the deathe of a synner, but that he should rather turne from synne, and be saved: mercifully forgeve us oure trespasses, and comforte us, whiche be grieved and weryed [wearied] with the burden of oure synne. Thy propertye is to have mercy, to the onlye it apperteineth to forgeve synnes: spare us therefore good Lorde, spare thy people whom thou haste redemed. Enter not into judgement wyth thy servauntes, whiche be vyle earthe, and miserable synners, but so turne thyne yre [ire] from us whyche mekely knowledge [=acknowledge] oure vylenes, and trulye repente us of our faultes: so make haste to helpe us in this worlde, that we maye ever live wyth thee in the worlde to come, throughe Jesus Christe oure Lorde. Amen.

Then shall the people saye this that foloweth after the Minister.

TURNEthou us, O good Lorde, and so shall we be turned: be favourable O Lorde bee favourable too thy people, whyche turne to the, in wepyng, fastyng, and prayinge, for thou art a mercifull God, full of compassion, longe sufferynge, and of a great pitie. Thou sparest when we deserve punishment, and in thy wrathe thynkest upon mercye, spare thy people good Lorde, spare theym, and let not thy heritage be brought to confusion: heare us O Lorde for thy mercy is greate, and after the multitude of thy mercies, loke upon us.

Psal.li.

Return to the 1559 Book of Common Prayer

A Commination against Sinners

A Commination against Sinners, with Certain Prayers to Be Used Divers Times in the Year

After Morning Prayer, the people being called together by the ringing of a bell, and assembled in the church, the English Litany shall be said, after the accustomed manner, which ended, the priest shall go into the pulpit and say thus.

RETHREN, in the primitive Church there was a godly discipline, that, at the beginning of Lent, such persons as were notorious sinners were put to open penance and punished in this world, that their souls might be saved in the day of the Lord; and that others admonished by their example might be more afraid to offend. In the stead whereof, until the said discipline may be restored again (which thing is much to be wished) it is thought good, that at this time (in your presence) should be read the general sentences of God's cursing against impenitent sinners, gathered out of the twenty-seventh chapter of Deuteronomy, and other places of Scripture; and that ye should answer to every sentence, Amen. To the intent that you, being admonished of the great indignation

of God against sinners, may the rather be called to earnest and true repentance, and may walk more warely in these dangerous days, fleeing from such vices, for the which ye affirm with your own mouths, the curse of God to be due.

Cursed is the man that maketh any carved or molten image, an abomination to the Lord, the work of the hands of the craftsman, and putteth it in a secret place to worship it.

And the people shall answer and say.

Amen.

Minister. Cursed is he that curseth his father and mother.

Answer. Amen.

Minister. Cursed is he that removeth away the mark of his neighbour's land.

Answer. Amen.

Minister. Cursed is he that maketh the blind to go out of his way.

Answer. Amen.

Minister. Cursed is he that letteth in judgment the right of the stranger, of them that be fatherless, and of widows.

Answer. Amen.

Minister. Cursed is he that smiteth his neighbour secretly.

Answer. Amen.

Minister. Cursed is he that lieth with his neighbour's wife.

Answer. Amen.

Minister. Cursed is he that taketh reward to slay the soul of innocent blood.

Answer. Amen.

Minister. Cursed is he that putteth his trust in man, and taketh man for his defense, and in his heart goeth from the Lord.

Answer. Amen.

Minister. Cursed are the unmerciful, the fornicators, and adulterers, and the covetous persons, the worshipers of images, slanderers, drunkards, and extortioners.

Answer. Amen.

The Minister.

OW seeing that all they be accursed (as the Prophet David beareth witness) which do err and go astray from the commandments of God, let us (remembering the dreadful judgment hanging over our heads, and being always at hand) return unto our Lord God, with all contrition and meekness of heart, bewailing and lamenting our sinful life, knowledging and confessing our offenses, and seeking to bring forth worthy fruits of penance. For now is the axe put unto the root of the trees, so that every tree which bringeth not forth good fruit, is hewn down and cast into the fire. It is a fearful thing to fall into the hands of the living God; he shall pour down rain upon the sinners, snares, fire, and brimstone, storm and tempest; this shall be their portion to drink. For lo, the Lord is come out of his place, to visit the wickedness of such as dwell upon the earth. But who may abide the day of his coming? Who shall be able to endure when he appeareth? His fan is in his hand, and he will purge his floor, and gather his wheat into the barn, but he will burn the chaff with unquenchable fire. The day of the Lord cometh as a thief upon the night, and when men shall say peace, and all things are safe, then shall suddenly destruction come upon them, as sorrow cometh upon a woman travailing with child, and they shall not escape. Then shall appear the wrath of God in the day of vengeance, which obstinate sinners, through the stubbornness of their heart, have heaped unto themselves, which despised the goodness, patience, and long sufferance of

God, when he called them continually to repentance. Then shall they call upon me, saith the Lord, but I will not hear. They shall seek me early, but they shall not find me. And that because they hated knowledge and received not the fear of the Lord, but abhorred my counsel, and despised my correction, then shall it be too late to knock, when the door shall be shut, and too late to cry for mercy, when It is the time of justice. O terrible voice of most just judgment, which shall be pronounced upon them, when it shall be said unto them: Go ye cursed into the fire everlasting, which is prepared for the devil and his angels. Therefore brethren, take we heed betime, while the day of salvation lasteth, for the night cometh when none can work. But let us while we have the light believe in the light, and walk as the children of the light, that we be not cast into the utter darkness where is weeping and gnashing of teeth. Let us not abuse the goodness of God, which calleth us mercifully to amendment, and of his endless pity promiseth us forgiveness of that which is past, if (with a whole mind and true heart) we return unto him. For though our sins be red as scarlet, they shall be as white as snow, and though they be like purple, yet shall they be as white as wool. Turn you clean (saith the Lord) from all your wickedness, and your sin shall not be your destruction. Cast away from you all your ungodliness that ye have done, make you new hearts and a new spirit: wherefore will you die, O ye house of Israel? Seeing that I have no pleasure in the death of him that dieth (saith the Lord God). Turn you then and you shall live. Although we have sinned, yet have we an advocate with the Father, Jesus Christ the righteous, and he it is that obtaineth grace for our sins, for he was wounded for our offenses, and smitten for our wickedness. Let us therefore re turn unto him, who is the merciful receiver of all true penitent sinners, assuring ourself that he is ready to receive us, and most willing to pardon us, if we come to him with faithful repentance, if we will submit ourselves unto him, and from henceforth walk in his ways; if we will take his easy yoke and light burden upon us, to follow in lowliness, patience, and charity, and be ordered by the governance of his Holy Spirit, seeking always his

glory, and serving him duly in our vocation, with thanksgiving. This if we do, Christ will deliver us from the curse of the law, and from the extreme malediction, which shall light upon them that shall be set on the left hand. And he will set us on his right hand and give us the blessed benediction of his Father, commanding us to take possession of his glorious kingdom, unto the which he vouchsafe to bring us all, for his infinite mercy. Amen.

Then shall they all kneel upon their knees; and the priests and clerks kneeling (where they are accustomed to say the Litany) shall say this Psalm.

Ps. 118

(actually Ps. 119:21)

Matt. 3

Heb. 10

Ps. 10

(actually Ps. 11:6)

Esa. 26

Mal. 3

Matt. 3

1 Thess. 5

Rom. 2

Prov. 1

Matt. 25

2 Cor. 6

John 9
Matt. 25
Esa. 1
Ezek. 18
1 John 2
Esa. 53
Matt. 11
Matt. 25

AVE mercy upon me (O God) after thy great goodness: according to the multitude of thy mercies, do away mine offenses.

Wash me throughly from my wickedness: and cleanse me from my sin.

For I knowledge my faults: and my sin is ever before me.

Against thee only have I sinned, and done this evil in thy sight: that thou mightest be justified in thy saying, and clear when thou art judged.

Behold, I was shapen in wickedness: and in sin hath my mother conceived me.

But lo, thou requirest truth in inward parts: and shalt make me to understand wisdom secretly.

Thou shalt purge me with hyssop, and I shall be clean: thou shalt wash me, and I shall be whiter than snow.

Thou shalt make me hear of joy and gladness: that the bones which thou hast broken may rejoice.

Turn thy face from my sins: and put out all my misdeeds.

Make me a clean heart (O God): and renew a right spirit within me.

Cast me not away from thy presence: and take not thy Holy Spirit from me.

O give me the comfort of thy help again: and stablish me with thy free spirit.

Then shall I teach thy ways unto the wicked: and sinners shall be converted unto thee.

Deliver me from bloodguiltiness (O God) thou that art the God of my health: and my tongue shall sing of thy righteousness.

Thou shalt open my lips (O Lord): my mouth shall show thy praise.

For thou desirest no sacrifice, else would I give it thee: but thou delightest not in burnt offering.

The sacrifice of God is a troubled spirit: a broken and a contrite heart (O God) shalt thou not despise.

O be favorable and gracious unto Sion: build thou the walls of Hierusalem.

Then shalt thou be pleased with the sacrifice of righteousness, with the burnt offerings and oblations: then shall they offer young bullocks upon thine altar.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, etc.

As it was in the beginning, and is now, etc. Amen. *Miserere mei deus.* Ps. 51

Lord have mercy upon us.

Christ have mercy upon us.

Lord have mercy upon us.

UR Father which art in heaven, etc.

And lead us not into temptation.

Answer. But deliver us from evil. Amen.

Minister. O Lord save thy servants.

Answer. Which put their trust in thee.

Minister. Send unto them help from above.

Answer. And evermore mightily defend them.

Minister. Help us, O God our savior.

Answer. And for the glory of thy name's sake deliver us, be merciful unto us sinners, for thy name's sake.

Minister. Lord hear my prayers.

Answer. And let my cry come unto thee.

Let us pray.

LORD, we beseech thee mercifully hear our prayers, and spare all those which confess their sins to thee: that they (whose consciences by sin are accused) by thy merciful pardon may be absolved, through Christ our Lord. Amen.

MOST mighty God and merciful Father, which hast compassion of all men, and hatest nothing that thou hast made, which wouldest not the death of a sinner, but that he should rather turn from sin, and be saved: Mercifully forgive us our trespasses, receive and comfort us, which be grieved and wearied with the burden of our sin. Thy property is to have mercy, to thee only it appertaineth to forgive sins: Spare us therefore, good Lord, spare thy people whom thou hast redeemed. Enter not into judgment with thy servants, which be vile earth, and miserable sinners; but so turn thy ire from us, which meekly knowledge our vileness, and truly repent us of our faults, so make haste to help us in this world, that we may ever live with thee, in the world to come; through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

Then shall the people say this that followeth, after the minister.

URN thou us, O good Lord, and so shall we be turned. Be I favorable (O Lord) be favorable to thy people, which turn to thee in weeping, fasting, and praying; for thou art a merciful God, full of compassion, long-suffering, and of a great pity. Thou sparest when we deserve punishment, and in thy wrath thinkest upon mercy. Spare thy people, good Lord, spare them and let not thy heritage be brought to confusion. Hear us (O Lord) for thy mercy is great, and after the multitude of thy mercies, look upon us.

Return to 1559 Book of Common Prayer

Certain Godly Prayers

The Book of Common Prayer - 1559

GODLY PRAYERS.

¶ CERTAINE GODLY PRAYERS TO BE USED FOR SUNDRY PURPOSES.

A generall confession of sinnes, to be said every morning.

O ALMIGHTIE God, our heavenly Father, I confesse and knowledge, that I am a miserable and a wretched sinner, and have manifold waies most grievously transgressed thy most godly commaundements, through wicked thoughts, ungodly lusts, sinfull words and deeds, and in my whole life. In sinne am I borne and conceived, and there is no goodnesse in mee; inasmuch as if thou shouldest enter into thy narrow judgement with me, judging me according unto the same, I were never able to suffer or abide it, but must needs perish and be dampned [damned] for ever: So little help, comfort, or succoure is there either in me, or in any other creature. Onely this is my comfort (O heavenly Father), that thou diddest not spare thy onely deare beloved sonne, but diddest give him up unto the most bitter, and most vile and slaunderous death of the Crosse for

me, that hee might so pay the ransome for my sinnes, satisfie thy judgement, still and pacifie thy wrath, reconcile me againe unto thee, and purchase me thy grace and thy favour, and everlasting life. Wherefore, through the merite of his most bitter death and passion, and through his innocent bloodshedding, I beseech the, O heavenly Father, that thou wilt vouchsafe to bee gracious and mercifull unto me, to forgive and pardon me al my sinnes, to lighten my harte with thy holy Spirit, to renue, confirme, and strengthen me with a right and a perfecte faith, and to inflame mee in love toward thee and my neighbour, that I may hencefurth with a willing and a glad harte, walke as becommeth me, in thy most godly commaundements, and so glorifie and praise the everlastingly. And also that I may with a free conscience and quiet hert, in all manner of temptations, afflictions, or necessities, and even in the verie pangs of death, crie boldly and merily unto thee, and say : *I beleve in God the Father Almighty, maker of heaven and earth, and in Jesus Christ, &c.* But, O Lord God heavenly father, to comfort myselfe in affliction and temptation with these articles of the Christian faith, it is not in my power, for faith is thy gift: and forasmuch as thou wilt bee prayed unto, and called upon for it, I come unto thee, to pray and beseech the, both for that and for all my other necessities, even as thy desre beloved Sonne our Sauour Iesus Christ himselfe hath taught us. And from the very bottome of my heart I cry, and say: Our Father, which art in heaven. &c.

1567, 1599, 1634

¶ *Prayers to be said in the Morning.*

O MERCIFULL Lord God, heavenly Father, I render most high laudes, praise, and thanks unto thee, that thou hast preserved me both this night, and all the time and daies of my life hitherto, under thy protection, and hast suffered mee to live untill this present houre. And I beseech thee hartily, that thou wilt vouchsaufe to receive me this day, and the residue of my whole life, from hencefurth into thy tuition [=protection], ruling and governing me with thy holie Spirit, that all maner of darknes, of misbeleefe, infidelitie, and of carnall lusts and affections, may be utterly chased and driven out of my harte, and that I may be justified and saved both bodie and soule through a right and a perfect faith, and so walke in the light of thy most godly trueth, to thy glorie and praise, and to the profite and furtherance of my neighbour, through Jesus Christ our Lord and Saviour. Amen.

1567, 1599, 1634

ALL possible thanks that wee are able, wee render unto thee, O Lord Jesus Christ, for that thou hast willed this night past to bee prosperous unto us; and we beseech thee likewise to prosper all this same day unto us for thy glorie, and for the helth of our soule: and that thou which art the true light, not knowing any going downe, and which art the Sunne eternall, giving life, foode, and gladnes unto all things, vouchsaufe to shine into our minds, that we may not any where stumble to fall into any sin, but may thorow [through] thy good guiding and conducting, come to the life everlasting. Amen.

1567, 1599

O LORD Jesus Christ, which art the true Sun of the world, evermore arising, and never going downe, which by thy most wholesome appearing and sight, doest bring forth, preserve, nourish, and refresh all things, as well that are in heaven, as also that are on earth : we beseech thee mercifully and favourably to shine into our hearts, that the night and darknesse of sins, and the mists of errors on every side driven away, thou brightly shining within our harts, we may all our life space go without any stumbling or offence, and may decently and seemely walk, (as in the day time,) being pure and cleane from the works of darknes, and abounding in all good works which God hath prepared for us to walk in: which with the Father and with the holie Ghost livest and

reignest for ever and ever. Amen.

1567, 1599, 1634;

also found in the 1545 Primer

O GOD and Lord Iesus Christ, thou knowest, yea, and hast also taught us, how great the infirmitie and weakenesse of man is, and how certaine a thing it is that it can nothing doe without thy godly helpe. If man trust to himselfe, it cannot bee avoyded, but that hee must headlong runne and fall into a thousand undoings and mischiefs. O our Father, have thou pitie and compassion upon the weakenesse of us thy children, bee thou prest [=willing] and readie to helpe us, alwaies shewing thy mercie upon us, and prospering whatsoever we godly go about: so that, thou giving us light, wee may see what things are truely good in deede; thou encouraging us, wee may have an earnest desire to the same; and thou being our guide, wee may come where to obtaine them : for wee having nothing but mistrust in our selves, doe yeeld and commit our selves full and whole unto thee alone, which workest all things in al creatures, to thy honour and glorie. So be it.

1567, 1599

A prayer against temptation.

O LORD Iesus Christ, the only stay and fence of our mortall state, our onely hope, our onely salvation, our glorie, and our triumph, who in the flesh (which thou hadst for our only cause taken upon thee) diddest suffer thy selfe to be tempted of Sathan, and who onely and alone of all men diddest utterly overcome and vanquish sinne, death, the world, the divell, and all the kingdome of hell : and whatsoever thou hast so overcommed, for our behoofe [behalf] it is that thou hast overcommed it : neither hath it been thy will to have any of thy servants to keepe battel or fight with any of the foresaid evils, but of purpose to rewarde us with a crowne of the more glorie for it. And to the intent that thou mightest likewise overthrow Sathan in thy members, as thou haddest afore done in thine owne person, give thou (wee beseech thee) unto us thy souldiers (O Lion most victorious of the tribe of Juda) strength against the roring Lion, which continually wandreth to and fro, seeking whom he may devoure. Thou being that same Serpent, the true giver of health and life, that were nailed on high upon a tree, give unto us, thy little seelie ones, wilinesse against the deceitfull awayting of the most subtile serpent. Thou being a Lambe as white as snow, the vanquisher of Satans tyranie, give unto us thy little sheep the strength and vertue of thy spirit, that being in our owne selves weake and feeble, and in thee strong and valiant, wee may withstand and overcome all assaults of the divell, so that our ghostly enemie may not glorie on us, but being conquered through thee, we may give thanks to thy mercie, which never leaveth them destitute that put their trust in thee : who livest and reignest God for ever without end. Amen.

1567, 1599

A prayer for the obtaining of wisdom.

O GOD of our fathers, and Lord of mercie, thou that hast made all things with thy word, and ordeined man through thy wisdom, that he should have dominion over the creatures which thou hast made, that he should order the world according to equitie and righteousness, and execute judgement with a true heart : give me wisdom, which is ever about thy state, and put me not out from among thy children : for I thy servant and sonne of thy handmaid am a feeble person, of a short time, and too young to the understanding of thy judgements and lawes : yea, though a man be never so perfect among the children of men, yet if thy wisdom be not with him, he shall be nothing worth. O send thy wisdom out of thy holie heavens, and from the throne of thy majestie, that she may be with me and labour with me, that I may know what is acceptable in thy sight; for she knoweth and understandeth all things, and she shall conduct me right soberly in thy workes,

and preserve me in her power: so shall my workes be acceptable. Amen.

1567, 1599;

also found in the 1545 Primer

Sapient. ix

A prayer against worldly carefulnesse.

O MOST deare and tender father, our defender and nourisher, endue us with thy grace, that we may cast off the great blindnesse of our mindes, and carefulnesse of worldlie things, and maye put our whole studie and care in keeping of thy holie law ; and that wee may labour and travaile for our necessities in this life, like the birds of the ayre, and the lillies of the field, without care. For thou hast promised to be carefull for us, and hast commaunded that upon thee we should cast al our care : which livest and reignest, world without end. Amen.

1567, 1599;

also found in the 1545 Primer

A prayer necessary for all persons.

O MERCIFULL God, I wretched sinner reknowlege [acknowledge] myselfe bound to keepe thy holie commaundements, but yet unable to performe them, and to bee accepted for just without the righteousnesse of Jesus Christ thy onely Sonne, who hath perfectly fulfilled thy law, to justifie all men that beleve and trust in him. Therefore graunt me grace, I beseech thee, to be occupied in doing of good workes, which thou commaundest in holie scripture, all the daies of my life, to thy glorie, and yet to trust onely in thy mercie, and in Christes merites, to bee purged from my sinnes, and not in my good workes, be they never so many. Give me grace to love thy holie word fervently, to search the Scriptures diligently, to reade them humbly, to understand them truly, to live after them effectually. Order my life so, O Lord, that it be alwaye acceptable unto thee. Give me grace not to rejoyce in any thing that displeaseth thee, but evermore to delight in those things that please thee, be they never so contrary to my desires. Teach me so to pray, that my petitions may be graciously heard of the. Keepe me upright among diversities of opinions and judgements in the worldly that I never swarve [swerve] from thy trueth taught in holie Scripture. In prosperitie, O Lord, save me, that I waxe not proude. In adversitie helpe me, that I never despaire nor blaspheme thy holie name, but taking it patiently, to give thee thankses, and trust to be delivered after thy pleasure. When I happen to falle into sinne through frailtie, I beseech thee to worke true repentance in my heart, that I may bee sorie without desperation, trust in thy mercie without presumption, that I may amend my life, and become truly religious without hypocrisie, lowly in heart without faining, faithfull and trustie without deceit, merie without lightnesse, sad without mistrust, sober without slouthfulnesse, content with mine owne without covetousnesse, to tell my neighbour his faults charitably without dissimulation, to instruct my household in thy lawes truly, to obey our Kyng and all governours under him* unfainedly, to receive all lawes and common ordinances (which disagreeeth not from thy holie word) obediently, to pay every man that which I owe unto him truly, to backbite no man, nor slander my neighbour secretly, and to abhorre all vice, loving all goodnesse earnestly. O Lord, graunt me thus to doe, for the glorie of thy holy name. Amen.

1567, 1599;

also found in the 1545 Primer, excepting the first two sentences

* our Queene and all governours under her ... in 1599

A prayer necessary to be said at all times.

O BOUNTIFUL Jesu, O swete saviour, O Christ the sonne of God, have pitie upon me, mercifully heare me, and despyse not my prayers. Thou hast created me of nothing, thou hast redeemed me

from the bondage of sinne, death, and hel, nether [neither] with golde nor silver, but with thy moste precious body once offred upon the crosse, and thine own bloud shed once for al for my raunsome : therefore cast me not away, whom thou by thy great wisdom haste made : despise me not, whom ye hast redemed with such a precious treasure. Nor let my wickednes destroy that, which thy goodnes hath builded. Nowe whiles I live, O Jesu have mercy on me, for if I dye oute of thy favour, it wil be to late afterward to cal for thy mercy : whiles I have time to repent, loke upon me with thy merciful eyes, as thou diddest vouchsafe to loke upon Peter thine Apostle, that I may bewaile my sinfull lyfe, and obteyne thy favour, and die therin. I reknowledge [acknowledge], that if thou shouldest deale with me according to very justice, I have deserved everlasting death. Therefore I appele to thy high throne of merci trusting to obtaine Gods favoure, not for my merites, but for thy merites, O Jesu, who hast geven thy self an acceptable sacrifice to thy father, to appease his wrath, and to bring all sinners, (truly repenting and amending their evyl lyfe) into his favour again. Accept me, O lord, among the numbere of them that shal be saved, forgeve my sines, geve me grace to leade a godly and innocent life, graunt me thy heavenly wisdom, inspyre my heart with fayth, hope, and charitie ; geve me grace to bee humble in prosperitie, patient in adversitie, obedient to my rulers, faithful unto them that trust me, dealing truely with al men, to live chastely in wedlocke, to abhorre adultery, fornication, and al unclennes, to doe good after my power unto al men, to hurt no man, that thi name may be glorified in me, during this present life, and that I afterward may obtaine everlasting life, thorow [through] thy merci, and ye merites of thi passion. Amen.

1567

¶ *Certaine prayers, taken oute of the service dayly, used in the quenes house.*

ALMIGHTIE God, the Father of mercie, and God of all comfort, the which onely forgivest sinne, forgive unto us our sinnes, good Lorde, forgive unto us our sinnes ; that by the multitude of thy mercies they may be covered, and not imputed unto us, and by the operation of the holy Ghost, we may have power and strength hereafter to resist sin by our Saviour and Lord Jesus Christ. Amen.

The Queen referred to is Catherine Parr, not Elizabeth.

These eight “daily prayers” are found in the 1567 and 1599 Books; the title in the 1599 BCP is:

¶ *Certaine godly prayers for sundry dayes.*

Munday.

O LORD GOD, which despisest not a contrite hart, and forgettest the sins and wickednes of a sinner, in what houre soever hee doth mourne and lament his olde maner of living : graunt unto us (O Lord) true contrition of hart, that we may vehemently despise our sinfull life past, and wholly be converted unto thee, by our Saviour and Lord Jesus Christ. Amen.

Tuesday.

O MERCIFULL FATHER, by whose power and strength wee may overcome our enemies both bodily and ghostly : graunt unto us, O Lord, that, according to our promise made in our baptisme, we may overcome the chief enemies of our soule, that is, the desires of the world, the pleasures of the flesh, and the suggestions of the wicked spirit ; and so after leade our lives in holines and righteousnes, that we may serve thee in spirit and trueth, and that by our Sauour and Lord Jesus Christ. Amen.

Wednesday.

O ALMIGHTY and everlasting God, which not onely givest every good and perfite gift, but also encreaseest those gifts that thou hast given : we most humbly beseech thee, (mercifull God) to increase in us the gift of faith, that we may truely beleieve in thee, and in thy promises made unto us; and that neither by our negligence, nor infirmitie of the flesh, nor by grievousnesse of

temptation, neither by the subtile crafts and assaults of the diuell [devil] wee bee driven from faith in the blood of our Saviour and Lord Iesus Christ. Amen.

Thursday.

GRAUNT unto us, O mercifull God, (wee most heartily beseech thee), knowledge and true understanding of thy word, that all ignorance expelled, we may know what thy will and pleasure is in all things, and how to doe our duties, and truly to walke in our vocation, and that also we may expresse in our living, those things that we doe knowe, that we be not only knowers of thy worde, good Lord, but also bee workers of the same : by our Saviour and Lorde Iesus Christ. Amen.

Friday.

O ALMIGHTY God, which hast prepared everlasting life to all those that be thy faithfull servaunts : graunt unto us, Lord, sure hope of the life everlasting, that we, being in this miserable world, may have some taste and feeling of it in our hearts ; and that not by our deserving, but by the merits and deserving of our Saviour and Lord Iesus Christ. Amen.

O MERCIFULL God, our only aide, succour, and strength at all times; graunt unto us, O Lord, that in the time of prosperitie we be not proude, and so forget thee, but that with our whole power and strength wee may cleave unto thee; and in the time of adversitie, that wee fall not to infidelitie and desperation, but that alwaies with a constant faith we may call for helpe unto thee graunt this, O Lord, for our advocates sake, and Saviour Iesus Christ. Amen.

Saturday.

O ALMIGHTIE and mercifull Lord, which givest unto thy elect people the holy Ghost, as a sure pledge of thy heavenly kingdome : Graunt unto us, O Lord, thy holie spirit, that he may beare witnesse with our spirit, that wee be thy children, and heires of thy kingdome, and that by the operation of this thy spirit we may kill all carnall lusts, unlawfull pleasures, concupiscences, evill affections, contrarie unto thy will, by our Saviour and Lord Iesus Christ. Amen.

Sunday.

A prayer for trust in God.

THE beginning of the fall of man was trust in himselfe. The beginning of the restoring of man, was distrust in himselfe, and trust in God. O most gracious and most wise guide, our Saviour Christ, which doest lead them the right way to immortall blessednesse, which trulie and unfainedlie trusting in thee, commit themselves to thee : Graunt us, that like as we be blind and feeble in deed, so we may take and repute our selves, that we presume not of ourselves, to see to ourselves, but so farre to see, that alway wee may have thee before our eyes, to followe thee, being our guide, to bee readie at thy call most obediently, and to commit our selves wholly unto thee; that thou, which only knowest the way, maist leade us the same way unto our heavenly desires; to thee with the Father and the holie Ghost be glorie for ever. Amen.

1567, 1599;

also found in the 1545 Primer

A prayer for the concorde of Christes church.

ARYSE Lorde, let thine enemies be scattered, thy haters put to flight, the righteous and Christes disciples make pleasaunt and mery, let them sing prayes and pleasaunt songes unto thee, let them blowe abroad thy magnificence, let them moste highly avaunce [advance] thy majestie, let thy glorie grow, let the kingdom of Christ from heaven among the chosen be enlarged : bee thou the father of the fatherles, the judge of the widowes, and the protectour of them, namely [=especially] whom the world forsaketh, whose consciences be troubled, whom the world pursueth for Christes sake, whiche be neddy and wrapped full of misery. In thy house O lord, let us dwel in peace and

concord, geve us al one heart, one minde, one true interpretacion upon thy word. Pluck of the bandes, aswell from the consciences as from the bodies of the miserable captives, and of them also whiche as yet bee hedged in within the lystes [=boundaries] of death, and unadvisedly strive against grace. How drye (lord) is the flocke of thyne heritage! I praye thee, powre [pour] downe largely the showres of thy graces, lette a more plenteous fruitfulness chaunce, let thy people be strengthened with thy spirite : Graunt us lord thy word abundantly, so that there may be many preachers of thy Gospel, which maye within them selves holily conspire and agree. Lette the church, the spouse of Christ, deale large spoyles of the conquered Sathan. All that beleewe in thee, by Christe (O lorde God of health), mought [might] lyft thee up with prayes, might renoume [=bring fame to] thee and extolle thee. We bee entered into the voyage of salvation. Conducte us luckelye unto the porte, that beeynge delyvered by thee from the verye death, we maye escape and come to the verye lyfe. Finishe the thinge that thou hast begon in us, make us to increase from faith to faith, leave us not to our own wil and choise, for it is slippery and redy to fal. To the thunderboltes of thy word put violence, that we may geve the glory to thee alonely. Geve to thy people courage and power to withstande synne, and to obeye thy worde in all thinges : O Lorde God most glorious and excellent over all.

1567

A prayer agaynst the enemies of Christes trueth.

DELYVER me O Lorde, from the ungodly and stiffnecked persons, for thou seest how in theyr hartes they ymagine mischiefe, and have great pleasure to picke quarells, theyr tongues bee more sharpe than any adders sting, and under theyr lippes lurketh poison of adders. But, O merciful Lord, let me not fal into theyr handes, that they handle not me after theyr owne lustes. Thou onely art my God, thou must heare my piteous plaint : Lord, that rulest al together, that art the strength and power of my defence, bee thou as a sallet [=helmet] on my head whensoever the ungodlye shal assault me : neyther suffre thou not the wicked thus to prosper in their matters. Suffre not their croked and malicious stomackes to encrease, and spitefully revyle thee. Loke upon thy porre wretches cause, and ridde me oute of these dayly grevaunces, then shall I with a right up heart and pleasaunt countenance extoll and magnifye thy holye name. Amen.

1567

A prayer for pacience in trouble.

HOW hast thou (O Lord) humbled and plucked me downe. I dare now uneths [=scarcely] make my prayers unto thee, for thou art angrie with me, but not without my deserving. Certainly I have sinned, Lord, I confesse it; I will not deny it; but, oh my God, pardon my trespasses, release my debts, render now thy grace againe unto me, stop my wounds, for I am all to plagued and beaten: yet Lord this notwithstanding I abide patiently, and give mine attendance on thee, continually waiting for reliefe at thy hand, and that not without skill; for I have received a token of thy favour and grace towards me, I meane thy word of promise concerning Christ, who for me was offered on the Crosse for a ransome, a sacrifice and price for my sins : wherefore, according to that thy promise, defend me Lord by thy right hand, and give a gracious eare to my requests, for al mans staies are but vaine. Beate downe therefore mine enemies thine owne selfe with thy power, which art mine onely ayder and protector, O Lord God almightie. Amen.

1567, 1599;

also found in the 1545 Primer

A prayer to be said at night going to bed.

O MERCIFULL Lorde God, heavenly Father, whether we sleepe or wake, live or die, we are

alwaies thine. Wherefore I beseech thee hartily that thou wilt vouchsafe to take care and charge of me, and not to suffer me to perish in the workes of darknesse, but to kindle the light of thy countenance in my heart, that thy godly knowledge may daily increase in mee, through a right and pure faith, and that I may alwayes bee found to wake and live after thy will and pleasure, through Jesus Christ our Lord and Saviour. Amen.

1567, 1599

¶ *A prayer to be said at the houre of death.*

O LORD Jesus, which art the onely health of all men living, and the everlasting life of them which die in faith : I wretched sinner give and commit my self wholly unto thy most blessed will. And I being sure that the thing cannot perish which is committed unto thy mercie, willingly now I leave this fraile and wicked flesh, in hope of the resurrection, which in better wise shal restore it to me againe. I beseech thee, most mercifull Lord Jesus Christ, that thou wilt by thy grace make strong my soule against all temptations, and that thou wilt cover and defend me with the buckler of thy mercie against al the assaults of the divell [devil]. I see and knowledge [acknowledge], that there is in myselfe no helpe of salvation, but all my confidence, hope, and trust, is in thy most mercifull goodnesse. I have no merites, nor good workes, which I may alleage before thee. Of sinnes and evill workes (alas) I see a great heape, but through thy mercie, I trust to bee in the number of them, to whom thou wilt not impute their sinnes, but take and accept me for righteous and just, and to bee the inheritour of everlasting life. Thou, mercifull Lord, was borne for my sake, thou diddest suffer both hunger and thirst for my sake, thou diddest preach and teach, thou diddest pray and fast for my sake, thou diddest all good workes and dedes for my sake, thou sufferedst most grievous paines and tormentes for my sake : And finally thou gavest thy most precious bodie to die, and thy blood to bee shed on the crosse for my sake. Now most mercifull Saviour, let all these things profit me, which thou freely hast given me, that hast given thy selfe for me. Let thy blood cleanse and wash away the spots and foulnesses of my sinnes. Let thy righteousness hide and cover my unrighteousnesse. Let the merites of thy passion and blood, bee the satisfaction for my sinnes. Give me Lord thy grace, that my faith and salvation in thy blood waver not in me, but be ever firme and constant, that the hope of thy mercie and life everlasting never decay in me, that charitie waxe not cold in me. Finally, that the weakenesse of my flesh bee not overcome with the feare of death. Graunt me, mercifull Saviour, that when death hath shut up the eyes of my bodie, yet that the eyes of my soule may still beholde and looke upon thee : that when death hath taken away the use of my tongue and speech, yet that my heart may crie and say unto thee, *In manus tuas, Domine, commendo spiritum meum* (that is to say) O Lord, into thy hands I give and commit my soule : *Domine Iesu, accipe spiritum meum*: Lord Iesu, receive my soule unto thee, Amen. Amen.

1567, 1599

¶ *Another prayer for the Morning*

O Almighty and most gracious God, we heartily thanke thee for the sweet sleepe and comfortable rest which thou hast given us this night : and forasmuch as thou hast commanded by thy holy Word, that no man should be idle, but all occupied in godly and vertuous exercises, every man according to his calling : we most humbly beseech thee, that thine eyes may attend upon us, dayly defend us, cherish, comfort, and governe us and all our counsailes [=deliberations], studies, and labours, in such wise, that wee may spend and bestow this day according to thy most holy will, without the hurting of our neighbours, and that wee may diligently and warily eschew and avoid all things that should displease thee, set thee alwayes before our eyes, live in thy feare, working that which may bee found acceptable before thy divine Majestie, through Christ our Lord. Amen.

¶ *A prayer for the Evening*

O Most mighty Lord our Father, and God everlasting, full of pity and compassion, we acknowledge and confesse, that we be not worthy to lift up our eyes to heaven, much less to present our selves before thy Majestie, with confidence that thou wilt heare our prayers, and grant our requests, if we consider our own deserving : For our consciences doe accuse us, and our sins witnesse against us, and we know that thou art an upright Judge, which doest not justifie the sinners and wicked men, but punishest the faults of such as transgresse thy Commandements. Yet most mercifull Father, sith [=since] it hath pleased thee to command us to call upon thee in all out troubles and adversities, promising even then to helpe us, when we feelee our selves (as it were) swallowed up by death and desperation : wee utterly renounce all wordly confidence, & flee to thy Soveragine bounty, as our onely stay and refuge, beseeching thee not to call to remembrance our manifold sins and wickednesse, whereby we continually provoke thy wrath and indignation against us, neither our negligence & unkindnesse, which have neither worthily esteemed, nor in our lives sufficiently expressed the sweet comfort of thy Gospel revealed unto us, but rather accept the obedience and death of thy Son Jesus Christ, who by offering by his body in sacrifice once for all, hath made sufficient recompence for all our sinnes. Have mercie therefore upon us, O Lord, and forgive us our offences. Teach us by thy holy Spirit, that we may rightly weigh them, and earnestly repent for the same : and so much the rather, O Lord, because that the reprobate, and such as thou hast forsaken, cannot praise thee, nor call upon thy Name : but the repenting heart, the sorrowfull minde, the conscience oppressed, hungring and thirsting for thy grace, shall ever set forth thy praise and glorie. And albeit wee be but worms and dust, yet thou art our Creatour, and wee be the worke of thine hands : yea, thou art our Father, and we thy chidren : thou art our Shepherd, and wee thy flocke : thou art our Redeemer, and we thy people whom thou hast bought : thou art our God, and wee thine inheritance. Correct us not therefore in thy anger, O Lord, neither according to our deserts punish us, but mercifully chastise us with a fatherly affection, that all the world may know that at what time soever a sinner doeth repent him of his sinne from the bottome of his heart, thou wilt put away his wickednesse out of thy remembrance, as thou hast promised by thine holy Prophet.

Finally, forasmuch as it has pleased thee to make the night for man to rest in, as thou hast ordained him the day to travaile [toil] in : Grant, O deare Father, that we may so take our bodily rest, that our soules may continually watch for ye time that our Lord Jesus Christ shall appeare for our deliverance out of this mortall life, and in the meane season, that we, not overcome by any fantasies, dreames, or other temptations, may fully set our mindes upon thee, love thee, feare [=revere] thee, and rest in thee : Furthermore, that our sleepe be not excessive, or overmuch, after the unsatiable desires of our flesh : but onely sufficient to content out weake nature, that wee may bee the better disposed to live in godly conversation [=behaviour], to the glory of thy holy Name, and profit of our brethren. Amen.

¶ *The prayer of Manasseth King of the Jewes.*

O Lord Almighty, God of our fathers, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, and of their righteous seed, which hast made heaven and earth with all their ornament, which hast bound the Sea by the word of thy Commandement, which hast shut up the deepe and sealed it by thy terrible and glorious Name, whom all doe feare, and tremble before thy power : for the Majestie of thy glorie cannot bee borne, and thine angry threatening toward sinners is importable [=unendurable], but thy mercifull promise is unmeasureable and unsearchable. For thou art the most high Lord, of great compassion,

long suffering, and most mercifull and repentest for mans miseries. Thou, O Lord, according to thy great goodness hath promised* repentance and forgiveness to them that sin against thee, and for thine infinite mercies hast appointed repentance unto sinners, that they may bee saved. Thou therefore, O Lord, that art the God of the just, hast not appointed repentance to the just, as to Abraham, and Isaac, and Jacob, which have not* sinned against thee, but thou hast appointed repentance unto me that am a sinner. For I have sinned above the number of the sand of the Sea. My transgressions, O Lord, are multiplyed : my transgressions are exceeding many : and I am not worthy to behold and see the height of the heavens for the multitude of mine unrighteousnesse. I am bowed down with many iron bands, that I cannot lift up mine head, neither have I any release : For I have provoked thy wrath, and done evill before thee. I did not thy will, neither kept I thy Commandements. I have set up abominations, and have multiplyed offences. Now therefore I bow the knee of mine heart, beseeching thee of grace. I have sinned, O Lord, I have sinned, and I acknowledge my transgressions : but I humbly beseech thee, forgive me : O Lord forgive me, & destroy me not with my transgressions. Be not angry with mee for ever, by reserving evill for mee, neither condemne me unto the lower parts of the earth. For thou art the God, even the God of them that repent : and in mee thou wilt shew all thy goodnesse : for thou wilt save me that am unworthy, according to thy great mercy : therefore I will praise thee for ever all the dayes of my life. For all the powers of the heavens praise thee, and thine is the glorie for ever and ever. Amen.

1634

* Thou hast promised that repentance shall be the way for them to return to thee.

* He speaketh this in compassion of himself and those holy Fathers which have their commemorations in the Scriptures, so that in respect of himself, he calleth their sinnes nothing but attributeth unto them righteousness.

¶ *A Prayer containing the duty of every true Christian*

O Most mightie GOD, mercifull and loving Father, I wretched sinner come unto thee in the Name of thy dearely beloved Sonne Jesus Christ my onely Saviour and Redeemer : and I most humbly beseech thee for his sake to bee mercifull unto mee, and to cast all my sinnes out of thy sight and remembrance through the merits of his bloody death and Passion. Powre [Pour] upon me (O Lord) the holy Spirit of wisdom and grace : governe and leade me by thy holy word, that it may be a lanterne unto my feet, and a light unto my steps. Shew thy mercy upon me, and so lighten my naturall blindnes and darknesse of my heart through thy grace, that I may daily be renewed by the same Spirit and grace : By the which (O Lord) purge the grossnesse [=coarseness] of my hearing and understanding, that I may profitably read, heare, and understand the word and heavenly will, beleieve, and practise the same in my life and conversation [=behaviour], and evermore hold fast that blessed hope of everlasting life.

Mortifie and kill all vice in mee, that my life may expresse my faith in thee : mercifully heare the humble suit of thy servant, and grant me thy peace all my dayes : Graciously pardon my infirmities, and defend mee in all dangers of body, goods and name : but most chiefly my soule against all assaults, temptations, accusations, subtil baits, and sleights of that old enemy of mankind, Satan that roaring Lion, ever seeking whom he may devoure.

And here (O Lord) I prostrate with most humble mind, crave of thy divine Majestie, to bee mercifull unto the universall Church of thy Sonne Christ : and specially according to my bounden dutie, beseech thee for his sake to blesse, save, and defend the principall member thereof, thy servant our most deare and Souveraigne Lord King *Charles*, increase in his Royall heart true faith, godly zeale, and love of the same : And grant him victorie over all his enemies, a long, prosperous,

and honourable life upon earth, a blessed end, and life everlasting.

Moreover, O Lord, grant unto his Majesties most honourable Counsailers, and every other member of this Church of England, that they and wee in our severall callings, may truely and godly serve thee : Plant in our hearts true feare and honour of thy Name, obedience to our Prince, and love to our neighbours : Increase in us true Faith and Religion : Replenish our minds with goodnesse, and of thy great mercie keepe us in the same, till the end of our lives : Give unto us a godly zeale in prayer, true humilitie in prosperity, perfect patience in adversity, and continuall joy in the holy Ghost.

And lastly, I commend unto thy Fatherly protection, all that thou hast given me, as wife, children, and servants : Ayd me, O Lord, that I may governe, nourish, and bring them up in thy feare and service. And forasmuch as in this world I must alwayes be at war and strife, not with one sort of enemies, but with an infinite number, not onely with one flesh and blood, but with the devill which is the prince of darknesse, and with which wicked men executors of his most damnable will : Grant me therefore thy grace, that being armed with thy defence, I may stand in the battell with an invincible constancy against all corruption which I am compassed with on every side, untill such time as I having ended the combate, which during this life, I must sustaine, in the end I may attaine to thy heavenly rest, which is prepared for me and all thine Elect, through Christ our Lord and onely Saviour. Amen.

1599, 1634

Final page of the 1634 printing of *Godly Prayers*; clicking on the image will bring up a larger, redable image. First

page of the 1599 printing of *Godly Prayers*; clicking on the image will bring up a larger, redable image.

Return to the 1559 Book of Common Prayer